Players

MANUAL

7th Edition



YOUR GAME

2008

Selborne College U15A Rugby

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1. THE KEY:

——————→	**Run**	*	**Cone**
……→	**Pass**	0	**Ball**
–··–··–··–··–··→	**Kick**		

2. INTRODUCTION:

"Success is not temporary it is permanent."

Coaches' thoughts:

The way rugby has developed over the years is frightening. Teams are forced to keep up with the times and even the rules have been modified to accommodate these changes. The game of rugby has become quicker and it is now all about retaining ball possession. The defence of the teams have improved and fewer tries are being scored off set phases. Rucking, which is the best ball to attack from, has become even more vital for a winning side. Huge emphasis is now on the support play of a side. I believe that every team should have a set attacking structure. The days of forwards running aimlessly from ruck to ruck are gone. In today's game the forwards have to know exactly where they are going, to create more phases while retaining ball possession. This means they will sometimes run unnatural angles or lines totally different to what they have been taught before. Sides have to work harder as a team and everything has to be done for a reason. A side that can combine their forwards and backs successfully into an attacking unit becomes a brilliant side. Therefore support play must be improved while the phases are built up and the ball retained.

A big question is whether kicking is still as important in the game as it was. I think it is, but now when a ball is kicked it has to be kicked even more cleverly. Kicking a ball back at opposition aimlessly means giving away possession. It is a fact that you can't win a game if you play it in your half or if you don't have the ball. Possession and position (territory) are needed to be a successful side. A winning side has to have a good pole kicker, which has been proven time and time again.

From all the rugby knowledge that I have accumulated over the years the following attacking options, game plan and supporting calls are what I believe a side in today's game need to use to win.

I have compiled the following manual to assist you in achieving whatever rugby aspirations you may have. Who knows we might see you in the first team one day.

3. COACHES' INDIVIDUAL AND TEAM GOALS:

"A fit side is not a good side, but the best side!"

- Be the best coach that I can
- Help the team achieve its goals
- Improve on Communication Skills
- Commitment
- Improve the players skills and fitness levels
- Be fair and honest
- Do everything I can to make the team be the best that they can
- Improve on discipline and approachability
- Create a winning and happy side
- Teach each player how much they can achieve together with hard work
- Expose the team to as many new and innovated coaching methods as possible
- Let the players learn what playing rugby with a structure is all about
- Strive to be one of the best coaches that you have had
- Earn respect and treat everyone with respect
- Achieve goal of getting team to follow out instructions
- Improve the quality of Selborne rugby

4. WHAT DO WE NEED TO ACHIEVE OUR GOALS:

"If better is possible, good is never enough."

- Commitment
- Confidence
- Communication
- Control
- Leadership
- Determination
- Dedication
- Discipline
- Aggression
- Attitude
- Self Belief
- Enthusiasm / Passion
- Courage / Bravery
- Teamwork / Team spirit
- Brilliant Defence
- Fitness
- Ball Skills
- Punctuality
- Cleaning out
- Support play
- No criticism
- Encouragement
- Big match temperament
- Right game plan
- Precision / Execution

5. HOW TO BE A BETTER RUGBY PLAYER:

"Motivation gets us going, but discipline gets us there."

Be helpful; don't assume that someone else will do the job for you. Be aware of your environment and be on the look out for ways to assist others.
By being aware of your environment and what is going on around you; it will allow you to best position yourself to help the team, whether on attack or defence.

Be polite and well mannered, especially in public places. No one lives in a vacuum and everything that you say and do is noticed by someone. A good impression must be made at all times.
Be disciplined in what you say and do on the field. Team-mates will return the kind of respect that you show towards them, be it positive or negative.

Be courteous to those around you. Get out of the habit of thinking of your own needs first and realise that your actions impact directly on those around you. Be aware of their needs and try and accommodate them as far as possible.
Don't be selfish on the field. Remember that the team's needs come first and sometimes that means sacrificing personal glory for the good of the team.

Speak positively. Try and build up individual players and the team at every opportunity. Often the characteristics that you ascribe to others are reflected on you, whether they are positive or negative.
Be constructive in your communication on the field. Don't shout at and criticise your team-mates - instead, encourage and motivate.

Live healthily. Excessive consumption of alcohol, smoking, poor sleeping patterns and poor diet have a detrimental effect on your health and seriously impacts on your lifespan. Ensure that you follow the lifestyle guidelines for elite sportspeople. A large part of hard work that is done during training is undone by excessive drinking, smoking and poor diet. Your body needs at least 8 hours of sleep to recover. Why bother to fight for every extra edge when you lose ground through your lifestyle choices? After all it is against the school rules!

Be proud of your values and principles. They define who you are as a person. Remember the characteristics of good sportsmanship and try to always apply them.

Be empathetic of others (be aware of what and how they are feeling).
By knowing how others feel and react to various situations you will be able to read them on the field better. You will be able to pick up if they are feeling motivated, nervous, lethargic or over-confident and be able to adjust your behaviour to try and change, influence or add to theirs.

6. PLAYER CONDUCT:

"Discipline is the key to success!"

Every player will treat the referee with respect and there will be no back chatting. All decisions made by the ref will be accepted without any disappointment. Failure to do so could result in a match suspension.

Carded players will be suspended for a game depending on the seriousness of the offence.

Walking away from a practice will result in a permanent exclusion from the team.

As a player you will listen to the coach and do what you are told. Failure to do so could result in exclusion from the team.

You will arrive on time for training. Repeated offences of being late could result in being dropped.

Dress on the field. Jerseys must be tucked in and socks up at all times.

No fighting, on the field or amongst players at practice. This is a serious offence and will not be tolerated.

Confidentiality is important. No one needs to know about the happenings of the team other than the team members themselves.

Absenteeism and injuries. Players are to notify the coach as soon as possible, if they are not able to take part in any team activities. The coach needs an up to date record of any injuries.

7. CONTACT DETAILS OF YOUR COACH:

Cell Number: (073)0223990

School Number: (043)7221822

School Fax: (043)7437746

E-Mail: bigal@selborne.co.za

8. THE TEAM:

Props:
- Big and strong
- Good lifter
- Mobile and good rucking skills (power plays)
- Great scrumming technique

Hooker:
- Mobile and skilful (fulfils the role of an extra loose forward)
- Good throwing and hooking skills. Controls the scrums.

Locks:
- Tall, mobile, strong and good jumpers
- Good ball carriers
- Solid cleaning out skills and extra defenders

Blindside Flank:
- Best ball carrier of the loose forwards
- Must be able to catch and kick when dropping back in support of the back three
- Solid rucking skills

Open-side and Eighth-man:
- They playing the 'fetching' role in the team
- Outstanding rucking skills (turnovers / contesting / slowing opposition ball down)
- Fast and fit
- Great defenders

Scrum-half:
- Great passing and distributing skills
- Must be able to kick (Box kick)
- Good communicator and solid defender (playing cross covering role)

Fly-half:
- Brilliant distributor
- Must have great kicking skills and be a solid defender

Left wing:
- Bigger and stronger of the two
- Better ball carrier (runs hard)
- Good defender and quick

Inside Centre:
- Bigger of the two, and better ball carrier
- Good passing and kicking skills (relieve pressure off fly-half)
- Solid passing skills
- Better defender of the two

Outside Centre:
- Faster of the two
- Great distributing skills at pace
- Solid defender

Right wing:
- Great finisher and very fast
- Solid defender and kicking skills

Fullback:
- Brilliant under the high ball
- Outstanding defender
- Pace and vision to hit the line and must have good kicking skills (drop kick, up and under)

9. WEEKLY PRACTICES, MEETINGS AND MATCH DAY ROUTINE:

Monday		
1st Break	Captain and Vice Captain Meeting in G12	Injury assessment, absentees, selections and match discussion
14:45	3km	Run out lactic acid / loosen up / aerobic fitness
15:00 to 16:15	A / B Team Practice	Skills / Tight (contact session)
Tuesday		
14:30 to 15:30	Meeting in G12	Rugby Theory / Video analysis
15:30 to 16:30	Team Gym Session	
Wednesday		
13:45 to 15:30	Team Practice	Unit Skills
Thursday		
14:45 to 16:00	Backs or Forwards Practice	Dependant on match preparation (not every week)
Friday		
14:45 to 16:00	Practice	Shadow / Captains run
Saturday		
1hr 15 minutes before game	Meet on grandstand	Full school uniform
1hr before game	Change room	
45 minutes before game	Warm up	
Halftime	Middle of field	First 2 minutes unit meetings and liquid replacement followed by team meeting chaired by coach with feedback provided by unit captains
Straight after game	Warm down	Home game: Swim / stretch Away game: Light jog / stretch
Sunday		
	Recovery	

WEEKLY PRACTICES AND MEETINGS

MATCH DAY ROUTINE

10. TEAM ROLES AND DUTIES:

"Communication opens the door to success"

During the week	On Match Day
Captain	
Monday meeting at first break: Finds out the status of the injured players and checks who is absent before the meeting.	Meets with coach to discuss final tactics i.e. coin toss. Decides on the back / forward plays with support from the vice captain during the match.
Warm up the forwards / backs before unit training	Keeps the team together (calm, focused, inspired and motivated)
Takes the team warming up session	Gets the team to stick to game plan / structure / plays
Direct link between players and coach and must communicate any relevant information	If necessary he must use his own initiative to change something if the need arises
Unit leader backs / forwards	Makes the final decisions and is the only person who talks to the ref
	Chairs the unit meeting at halftime with the forwards / backs (Team leaders report to them). Reports to the full team during final meeting at halftime.
	Thanks ref and opposite coach after game
Vice Captain	
Monday meeting at first break: Helps find out the status of the injured players and who is absent	1hr 15minutes before the game find a place for the team to meet (in the shade)
Warm up the forwards / backs before unit training	Decides on the back / forward plays with support from the captain
Provides support to the captain and the team	Provides support for the captain and the team
Unit leader backs / forwards	Chairs the unit meeting at halftime with the forwards / backs (Team leaders report to them)
Help aide team spirit / morale	Reports to the full team during final meeting at halftime
Team Leader 1: Front Row	
Make sure that the front row's timing is right and binding	Controls the scrums (forwards only engage if he is happy)
When on duty will be in charge of equipment i.e. setting up and returning	
Team Leader 2: Jumper	
Controls the timing of the lifters	Controls the lineouts and contesting
Watches for correct jumping techniques	Provides support to the unit captain
When on duty will be in charge of equipment i.e. setting up and returning	Reports to unit captain at halftime
Team Leader 3: Loose Forward	
Takes the lead at practice	Looks for any strengths and weaknesses
When on duty will be in charge of equipment i.e. setting up and returning	Makes sure that the loose forwards are working as a unit
	Reports to unit captain at halftime

Team Leader 4: Halfback	
Takes the lead at practice	Looks for any strengths and weaknesses
	Communicates defensive patterns
When on duty will be in charge of equipment i.e. setting up and returning	Reports to unit captain at halftime
Team Leader 5: Centre	
Makes sure that the backs are running straight / the right lines	Looks for any strengths and weaknesses
	Communicates any information to the team leaders and unit captain
When on duty will be in charge of equipment i.e. setting up and returning	Reports to unit captain at halftime
Team Leader 6: Back Three	
Leads the back three at practice	Looks for where the space is and lets the team leaders know
Provides support	Controls the back three's defence, including the blind side flanker
When on duty will be in charge of equipment i.e. setting up and returning	Reports to unit captain at halftime
Unit 1: Forwards	
When one of their team leaders are on duty they will help set up / pack up	Provide the team with good ball
Support the team leaders	Play to the structure decided on and fulfil your roles
Maintain discipline and fitness standards	Maintain discipline standards
Listen to your unit and team captain	Commitment
Must communicate injury status or absenteeism to the unit captain or coach	Thank your opposition
Unit 2: Backs	
When one of their team leaders are on duty they will help set up / pack up	Keep the forwards going forward
Support the team leaders	Play to the structure decided on and fulfil your roles
Maintain discipline and fitness standards	Maintain discipline standards
Listen to your unit and team captain	Commitment
Must communicate injury status or absenteeism to the unit captain or coach	Thank your opposition
Coach	
Plans practices in accordance to the teams requirements	Overseas the warm up
Aligns the team's goals	Provides final support before the game
Provides support	Chairs the final meeting at halftime and realigns the team's strategy
Selects the team	Overseas the warm down and attends to injured players
Decides on the team strategy with support from the unit captains	

11. THE ATTACKING OPTIONS

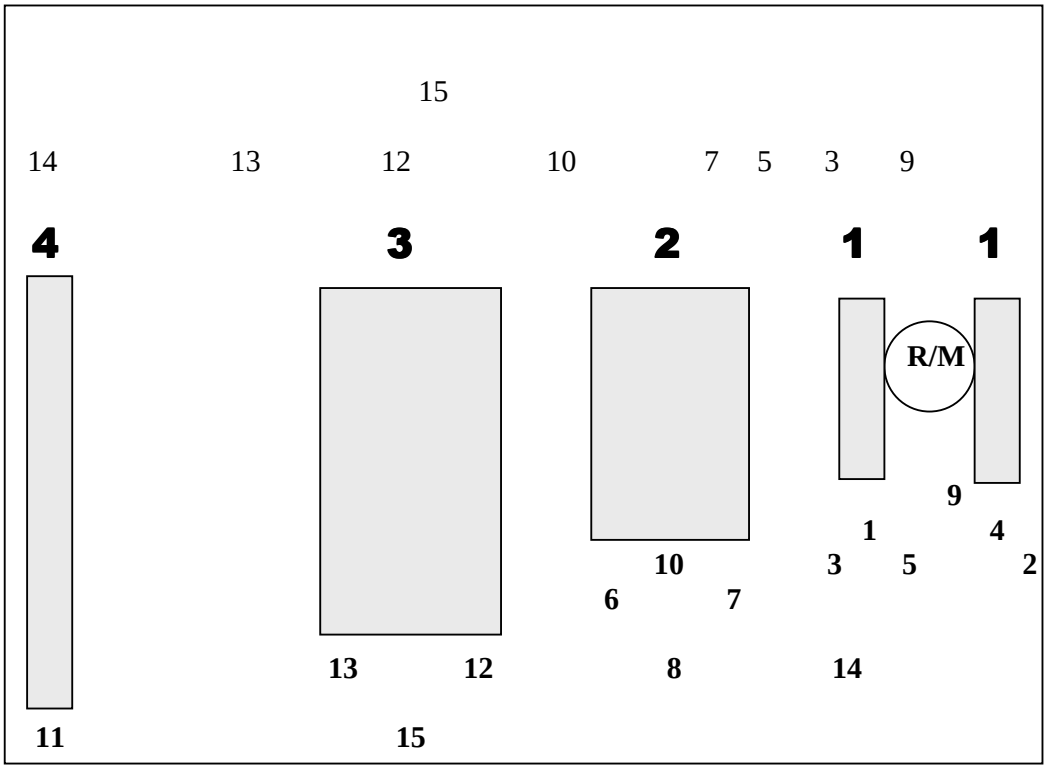
There are four attacking options on the field:

1 – The forwards take the ball up in the first channel of the ruck or maul, between the scrumhalf and flyhalf.
This option is to suck in their defences to create the overlap on the opposite side of the field and in so doing weakening their defences by creating forward momentum. It is extremely important that it is done via quick ruck ball and in the same direction. The forwards taking the ball up, must be running onto the ball at pace and their angles of running must be straight with their intensions to get over the advantage line. When taking the ball up we must go to ground in control; so we can retain ball possession (put yourself down). Your body positions must be low intending to score 'mini tries'. Don't let the defender ride the tackle!
Refer to the calling structures further on.

2 – The flyhalf puts a loose forward into the gap on his inside or outside shoulder while running onto the ball or standing flat. The inside pass from the flyhalf to a player running at pace is also very effective.
Their intentions are to suck in the defending backline's midfield defences and to set up the next phase via a quick ruck or maul.
Remember that we never try and run over a man but always run into the gap.
Once again they must go to ground in control and get over the advantage line.
Refer to the calling structures further on.

3 – The ball is played to the centres to set up the ruck or maul in the midfield. Any backline moves can be used for this option as long as the ruck is formed more or less in this area. This option is mostly used off set pieces.
Once again it is vital to get over the advantage line and to retain ball possession by going to ground in control, popping or flipping.

4 - Here the ball is swung out wide to the wings where the overlap should be formed.
The forwards must stay out of it and get out of the way.
The opposite wing will come around with the fullback to create the overlap.
Again any backline moves can be used to move the ball out wide where the try should be scored or the next phase formed.
If you are the closest player you need to clean/seal (regardless of whether you are a back or forward)



All our tries should be scored off options 3 and 4. Options 1 and 2 are used for slowing the game down, weakening their defences, creating forward momentum and as a platform for the other two options. Option 1 and 2 should preferably be done in the same direction. At the beginning of every half option 1 and 2 are used all the time for about 10 to 15 minutes and option 3 off set phases. The game can then be opened up with options 3 and 4. Hopefully by the late second half 10 and 9 should be able to make brilliant breaks.

The faster the ball is recycled, the quicker the game will be. To retain ball possession we will play with a split pack. This split will be the base of all the attacking options. For a split pack to be effective fast and fit forwards with a good understanding about the concepts behind split will be needed. If you are a forward hanging off to run with the ball, means that if you don't receive it you will be cleaning out at the next ruck.

Here is an example of how we could play:

<u>During the first bit of each half</u>:
Option 3 will be used off set phases to keep the ball closer to the forwards and then 1 or 2 a couple of times in the same direction until the ball has been worked to the touchline.
The ball can then be moved back inside with a 1 or 2.
This is repeated until the first ten or so minutes are over.
<u>During the last bit of each half</u>:
Option 3 or 4 can be used off set phases, followed by 1 or 2 a couple of times in the same direction until the ball has been worked towards the touchline.
During this the left or right wing will move to the opposite side and wait for the ball to be moved quickly down the line to him from an option 4.

The key men in these options are the halfbacks, who will be in control through out the game. They must be communicating all the time on the field, letting everyone know what the options are at all times. Both these players will be playing a distributing role where every option will go through the scrumhalf and only option 1 will not go through the flyhalf. It is important that both these players try and avoid contact with the ball in hand and have the skill to put players through gaps running off their shoulders. This means that the halfbacks should never be tackled with the ball.

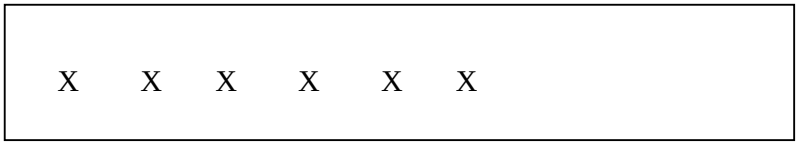
This game plan in a nutshell enables the forwards and backs to work together to form a winning combination. It also creates situations where our forwards run onto their backline, which is ideally what every team wants to try and do. Everyone on the field will know what they are working towards. The forwards will be linking with the backline under the control of the scrumhalf and flyhalf, while the backline will be receiving good ball from the forwards via the flyhalf who is constantly controlling them. The game will be fast because most of the ball will be received from quick rucks, which is the best ball to attack with. This altogether will formulate an attractive, exciting and expansive game plan.

Important things to remember about our game plan for it to be effective:

- Everyone needs to work together and be the fittest they have ever been.
- Forwards need to know all the backline moves; so they know where to go from the scrum or lineout.
- Your support must be quick and the ball must be recycled quickly.
- Forwards must sprint the first five metres from a set piece and then look.
- Forwards must stay in their groups.
- Ruck when going forward and maul when there are less numbers or when we are unorganised.
- The supporting calls must be known very well and everyone on the field must be able to perform them.
- Always try and carry the ball across the advantage line and pump the legs in contact.
- Everyone must go to ground in control to retain ball possession.
- Let the ball do the moving and keep it in hand. Depending on our opposition we might want to avoid setting up the ruck.
- Be patient and keep attacking.
- Never be afraid to try something and be creative.
- After a match you should be more mentally exhausted than physically.
- THINK!

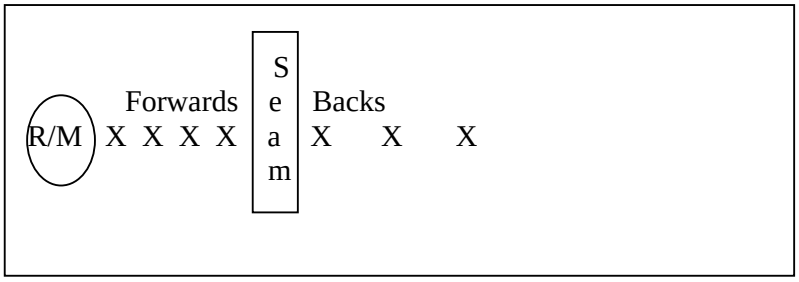
12. DEFENDING TEAM'S DEFENSIVE LINES WHEN WE ARE ON ATTACK:

Static Ball:



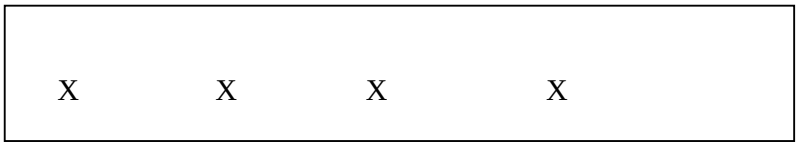
Static ball is found off set pieces.
You can never make this quick ball.
Backs must remember to not run laterally (attacking channels).
Set it up and play from there.

Slow Ball:



This situation is found in open play.
We need to attack the seam e.g. Runners off 10 ("Blade 1" etc.)
A "Bonsai" can be used to turn it into quick ball.

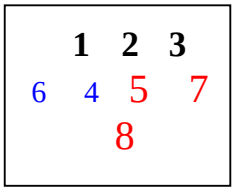
Quick Ball:



Usually found when we have broken their defensive line.
The ball must go to the distributors ie. 10 and 12.
The forwards must stay out of the line.
If there is an overlap "Flash" must be called.

13. SPLIT PACK:

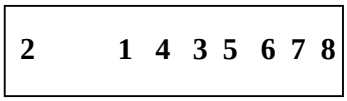
From a Scrum:



RED: 7, 8, 5
BLUE: 6, 4
BLACK: **1, 2, 3**

Before the scrum the forwards must know where the next phase will be set up eg. option 3 or 4. The first phase from the scrum 5, 7, 8, and 12/13 (the closest) must cleanout/seal. The next group will then take it up in the same direction off an option 1.

From the Lineout:



If the ball goes to the back it will be the tight five cleaning out first. When the ball goes to the middle it will be the forwards who are not lifting.
Off short lineouts it would be whoever is standing off or not lifting. Stay in that group until the next set piece. If we drive, the first four forwards to get to the ruck clean out. The last four form in their positions for options 1 and 2.

The whole idea behind the split is to conserve the forward's energy by preventing them from running aimlessly from ruck to ruck and maul to maul. In achieving this the support play will be better and the ball will be recycled quicker, speeding up the game, while retaining ball possession. The reason behind this is because the forwards won't be getting as tired as they would normally and they will be used in the game much more effectively. A number of the coaches that have coached me have used this concept and there was great difficulty and confusion after a couple of phases amongst the players. I still feel that it is worth using and I think with a little more persistent coaching it can work extremely well.

Split pack in this game plan will allow all the forwards an opportunity to run with the ball during the course of the game. This in return will make a match more enjoyable for the forwards, while creating a perfect combination between the forwards and the backs.

It is important to remember that the group from a set piece must get to the ruck to cleanout as quickly as possible. After cleaning out they must stay in that group until the next set phase. The next group must form up in their positions for options 1 and 2 and if the ball goes to their group they must be there to support in the diamond formation. Hopefully there can be interplaying between them, while taking the ball even further up the field. This is where our supporting calls are used.

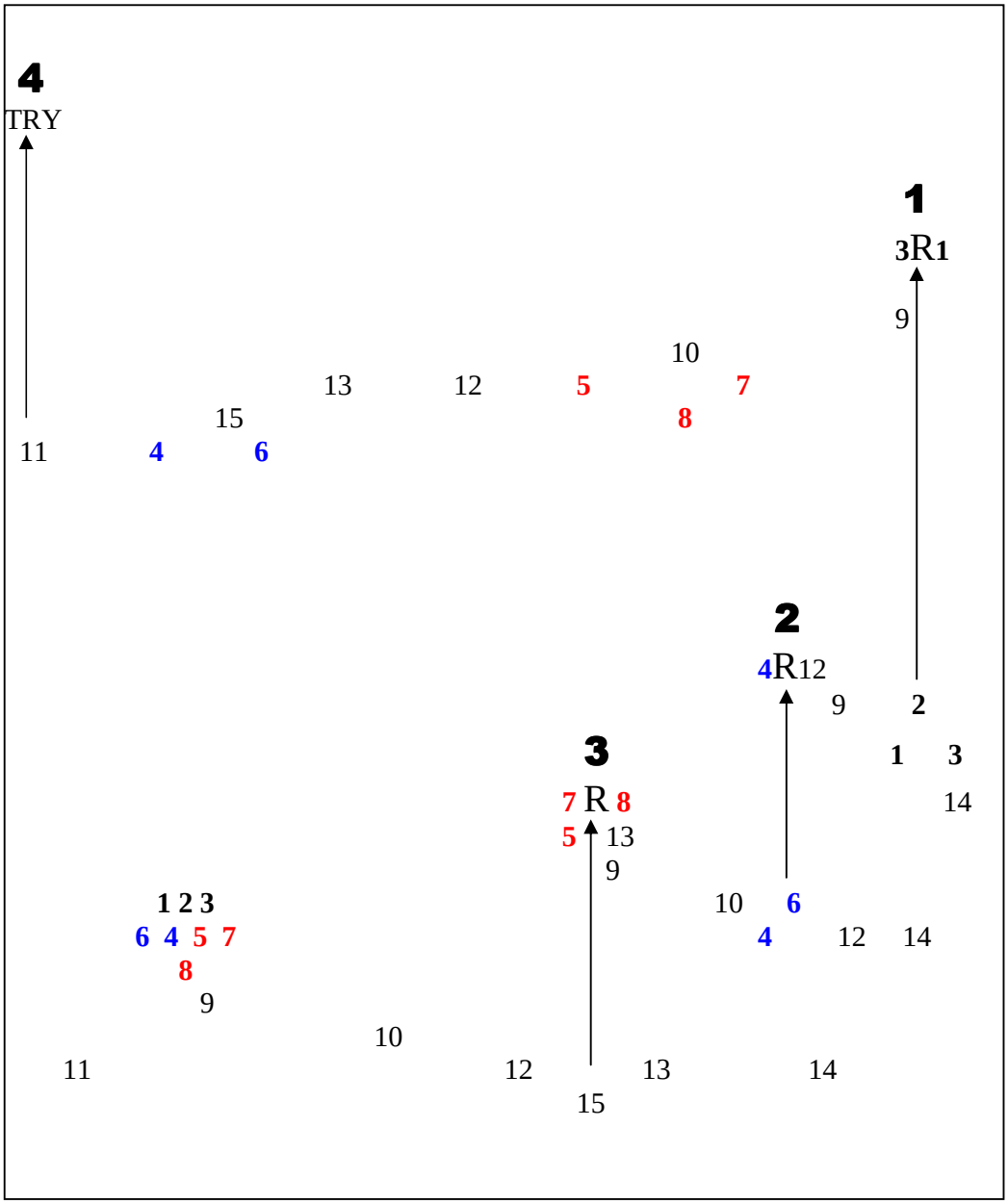
REMEMBER TO STAY IN YOUR GROUP!

14. AN EXAMPLE OF THE GAME PLAN:

This is an example from a left scrum:

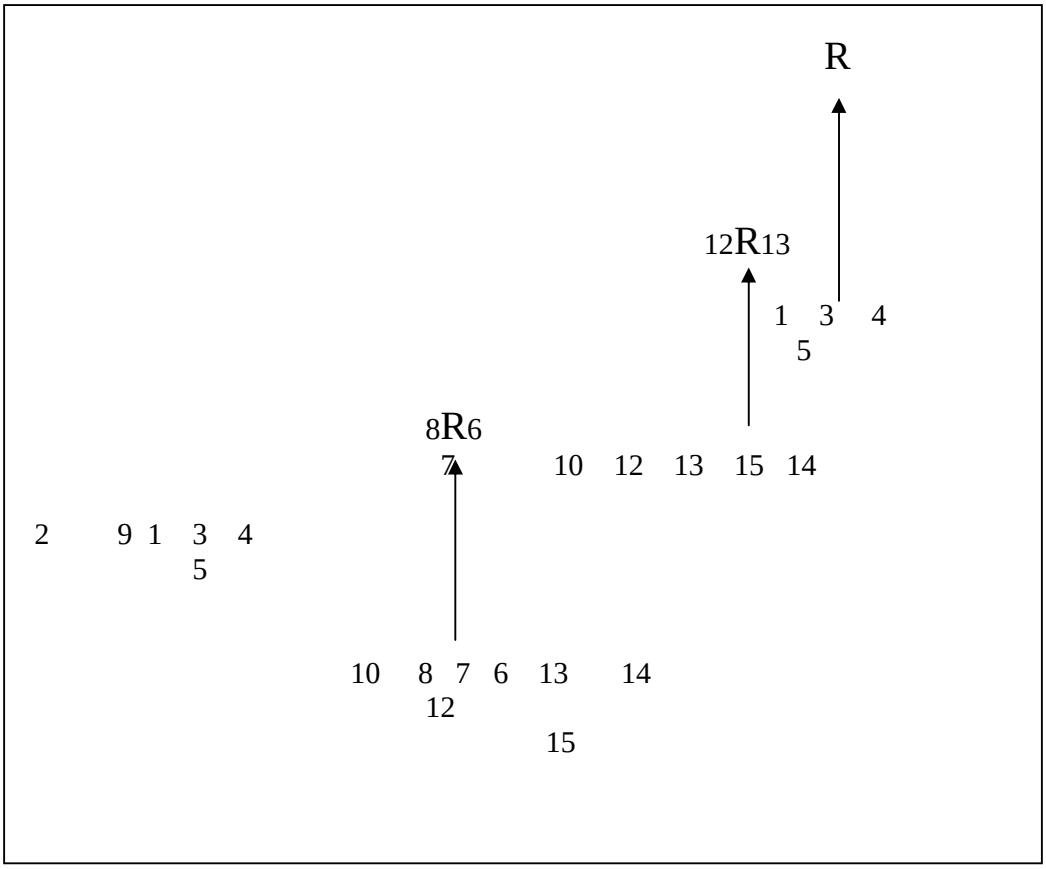
R= Ruck

Off a set piece we should keep the ball closer to our forwards with an option 3. The loose forwards must get there quickly to secure possession. These forwards must slow it down while the tight forwards get into position to take it up via an option 1. They then secure possession for the loose forwards for an option 2, this process is repeated until the ball has been moved to the opposite touchline. Here, option 1 is used until all the backs are in place. The ball is then moved via an option 4 to the other side where the overlap is exploited and the try is scored.



SEQUENCING: "2-4-1"

From the Short Lineout



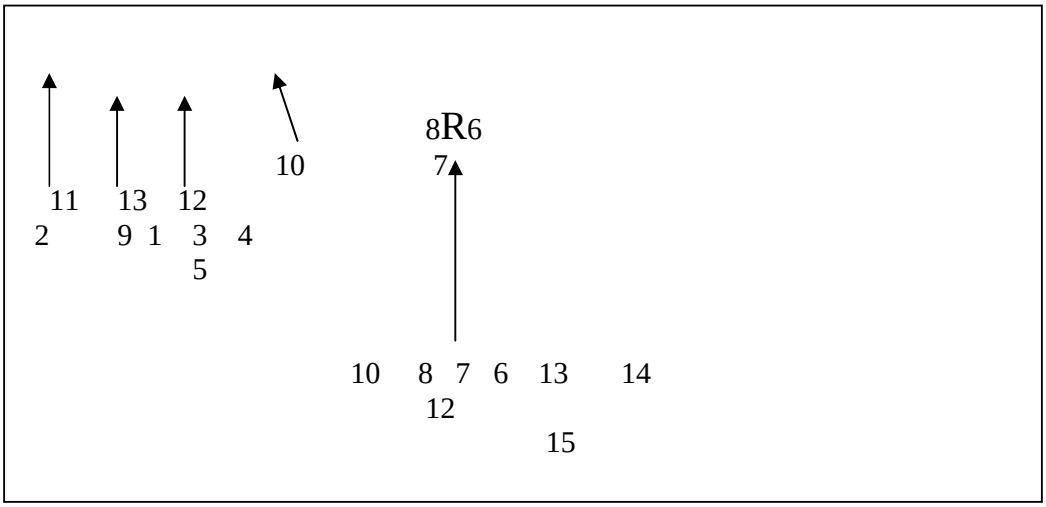
1ST RUCK:
The loose forwards use the starter moves to take it up. It is important that it is quick ruck ball. If the closest centre is needed he must go in.

2ND RUCK:
We then play the same side out wide with our backs who take on their defences.

3RD RUCK:
The tight forwards then slow things down by taking the ball up the next phase. Preferably with a BONSAI, ZULU or P-BALL. This will give the rest of the team time to get ready to swing the ball out wide FLASH.

“2-4(blind)”

From the Short Lineout

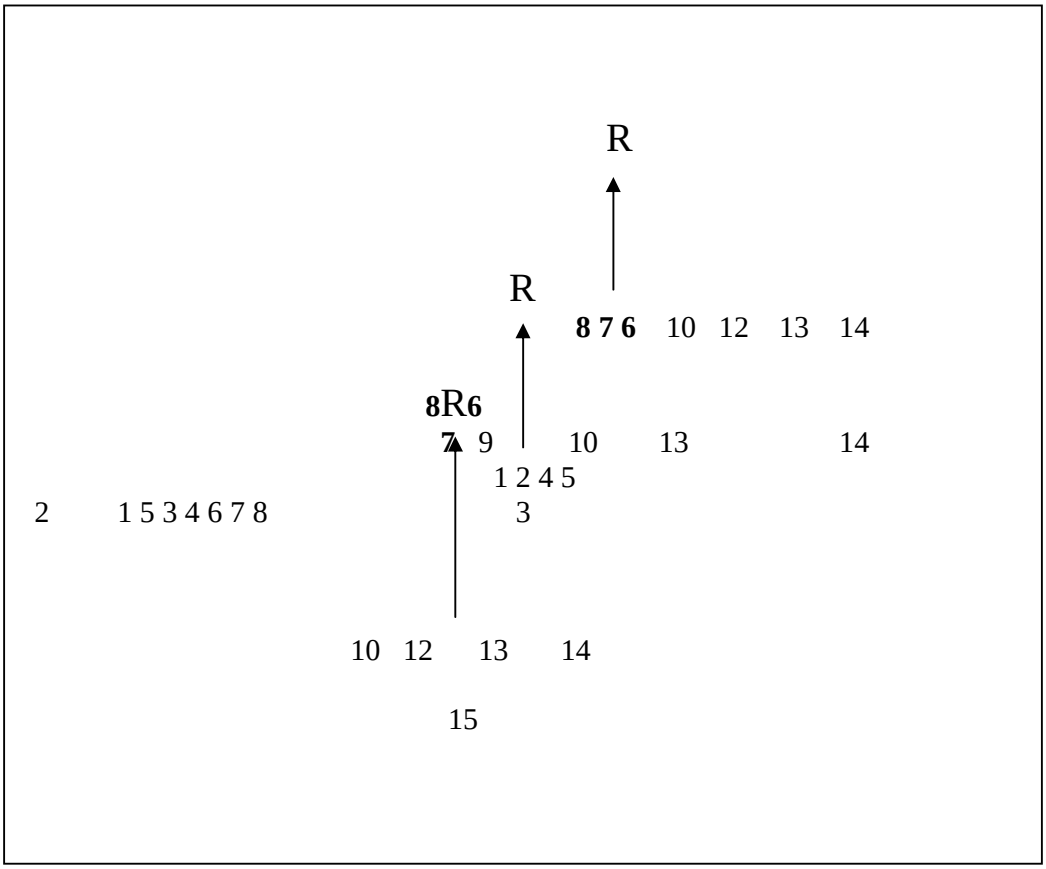


1ST RUCK:
The loose forwards take it up. (This has to be quick ball)

2ND RUCK:
Backs attack the blind side. (Remember to draw, straighten and pass)

3RD RUCK:
Tight forwards take it up (using supporting calls) and we play from there.

NORMAL FULL LINEOUT: “2-1-1”



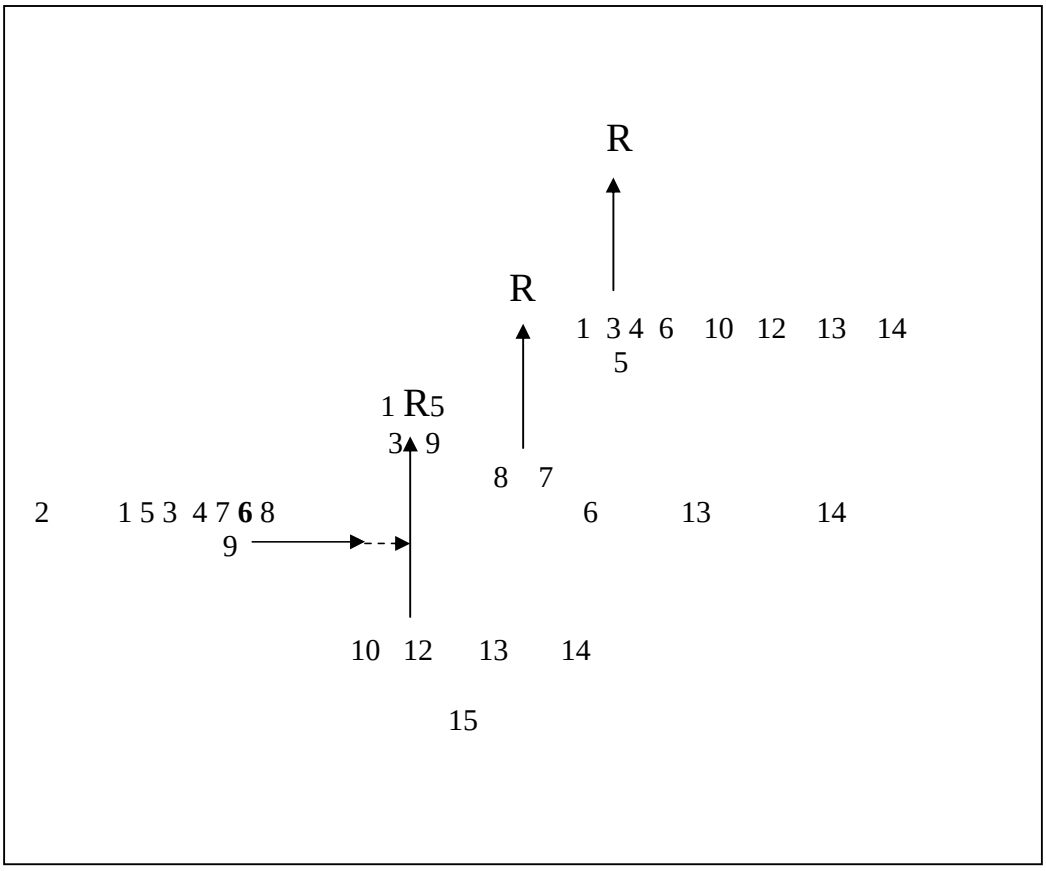
1ST RUCK:
The backs take it up. They can use any move if they want to. The loose forwards help secure possession. If the closest centre is needed he must go in.

2ND RUCK:
The tight forwards take it up using the SUPPORTING CALLS. (Option 1)

3RD RUCK:
The loose forwards take it up using either the SUPPORTING CALLS or STARTER MOVES ie. Blade. (Option 1 or 2)

"2-2-1"

From the Full Lineout



1ST RUCK:
9 runs across the field and plays 12 short on the advantage line. If 10 is needed he must go in.

2ND RUCK:
The loose forwards take it up using either the SUPPORTING CALLS or STARTER MOVES ie. Blade. (Option 1 or 2)

3RD RUCK:
The tight forwards take it up using the SUPPORTING CALLS. (Option 1)
We play from there.

OTHER GAME PLAN IDEAS:

The whole idea about this game plan is to keep the possession of the ball and to let the ball do the moving, by playing a fast and expansive game, taking the game to the opposition. In doing this we want to use the overlap to score tries and set up quick ruck ball.

On attack 1, 4, 6 stay on the left of the field and 3, 5, 7 stay on the right of the field. This doesn't mean that on attack they don't cross over if their help is needed. They must still cleanout and make sure the ball comes back quickly (hanging out on the wings and doing nothing is not the game plan). They must get involved in the game on their sides of the field, which is right to the middle. If the ball does get held up 1, 4 or 3, 5 must be the first to go in. It is important that there is still someone to take the ball up for the next phase and that he has the support with him.

The reason for this split:

- Is to always create the overlap and the support out wide
- To give the forwards direction in the game and not running around aimlessly from ruck to ruck
- To always retain the possession of the ball by having the support all over the field
- To preserve the forwards energy so they can pick up their work rates and in so doing lifting the tempo of the game
- In doing all of this to win all our games by playing an expansive, attractive, positive and exciting game.

The ball must be moved either up the midfield or on the outside where quick second phase ball via a ruck can be formed or kept alive!
There will always be an overlap on either side, after the quick ruck; so the ball must be swung straight to where the overlap is.
Try and avoid taking the contact up close on 3rd phase ball, let's play the game out wide, where we want to score the tries. We should score off 3rd phase ball.

Remember to not go to far on your own and be in control when going to ground in the tackle situation. It is better to gain 10m on the field with 3 phases than gain the same distance in a single phase, but loose possession. Always run into the half gap, never into a one on one confrontation.

The supporting players must always be in support quickly and the ball must be set up again and again. Keep the ball alive, give it air and let it do the moving.

The Attacking Options:

B - forwards move the ball to suck in defence in their diamonds

M - the ball goes up the midfield with the backline launching an attack

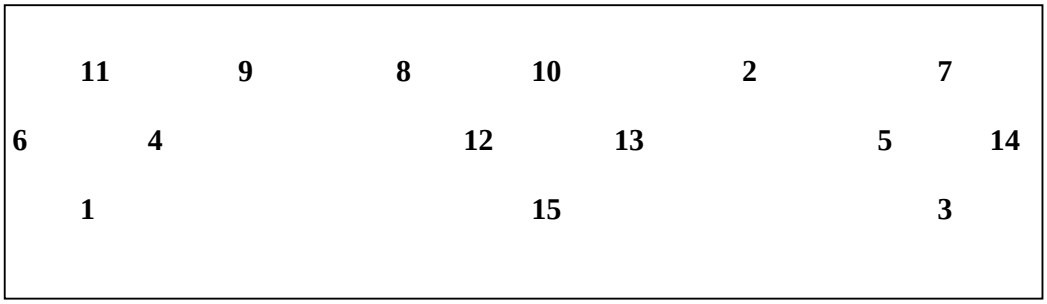
X - the ball is swung out wide to the wings to exploit the overlap and then to link up

It is vital that we all communicate and let each other know what the options are at all times. Remember that the supporting player shouts the support call and that the ball carrier must listen to his supporters.
10 must call the options.

Off Set Pieces:

The ball is taken up for a **M** by **10, 12, 13,** and **15** with them cleaning out. During the attack from the lineout situation **8** and **2** can clean along with **10, 12, 13,** and **15**.
Off the scrum **7** and **8** must help.
The next phase will be from a **B** by the forwards on the left or right of the field. The **B** must be out wide on the blind side. Take it up that channel.
After that the ball must be swung out wide by the backline for an **X**.
If the try is not scored, the forward group on that side must form a **B**.

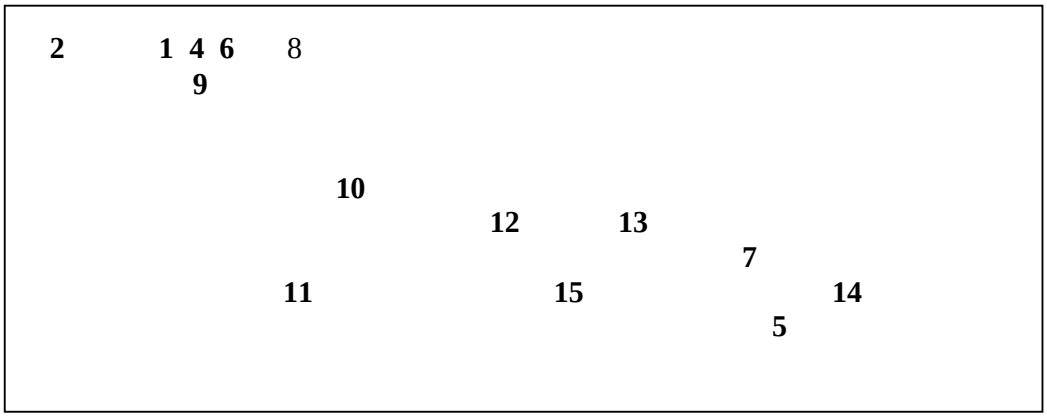
An Idea about Diamond Support:



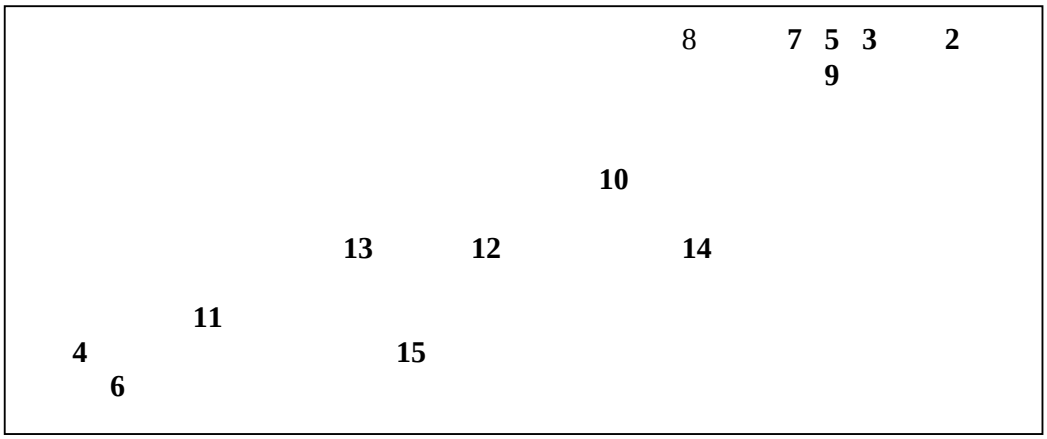
2, 8 and **9** are used to distribute ball from diamond to diamond.
2 and **8** must make sure the ball comes back quickly.
During supporting drills we will be in these groups.
Ideally during the game these groups should be supporting and cleaning out together.
In a match an 'Aussie' will be very effective out wide or in the midfield.

On Attack from our Lineouts:

On the left of the field:



On the right of the field:



This is the way we are going to form up for our attack from the lineout situation. During the game we will always have 3-man lineouts with the ball usually off the top. Our aim is to have quick ball and the support out wide to set up the next phase via a quick ruck.

The first phase from the lineout will either be set up in the midfield or preferably out wide; so the overlap is created on the opposite side.
It is important that the players on the field cleanout, when the ruck is formed in their area. The ball must be swung quickly to the overlap.

Off our lineout I want the backline to always try a move to break the midfield defence (a flat pass is effective). If the defence is broken the ball must be swung out wide for the next phase.

From the lineout we want an **M** or **X** and then a **B** going in the same direction. After this the ball must go out wide for an **X** on the opposite side and then a **B** again etc.

Attack from the Scrum:



Off the scrum the ball must go up the midfield where the 2nd phase must be formed via a quick ruck. 10, 12, 13, 15 and 7 must cleanout. Then 3, 5, 8 and 14 take the 3rd phase. During this 1, 2, 4, 6 and 11 must fan out wide on the opposite side, where the overlap will be formed. The ball must then go out wide quickly, to exploit the overlap. If the try is not scored the 4th phase will be formed by the forwards on that side. It is very important that we change the direction quickly and that we follow our pass to support.

Off the scrum we want an **M** and then a **B** out wide on the blind side.
After the **B** option out wide the backline must be quick in getting into position to move the ball to the opposite side of the field for the **X** and then the **B** with the forwards on that side. It is important that the ball is distributed as quickly as possible with long passes to the opposite side of the field and that contact in the midfield is avoided; so the next ruck can be formed out wide. The reason for this is to draw all their defence across and then change the direction again. This will catch them on the wrong foot and there will be an overlap on the opposite side.

Important things to remember about this Game Plan:

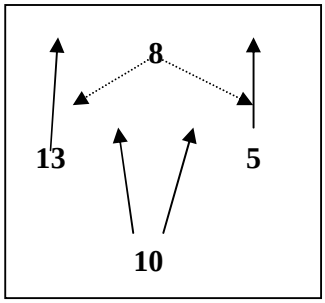
For us to retain the ball our support play must be quick and the ball must be recycled quickly for the game plan to be effective.
The cross kick will be effective but try not to just kick the ball away.
We all need to know the supporting calls well and to have the skill to perform them (remember to follow your pass!).
It is very important that we go to ground ourselves in the tackle and that we are in control.
Never go too far on your own and always look for your support.
Avoid running for the man and always run for the half gap.
Avoid contact and keep the ball alive.
The ball must do the moving.
Don't be afraid to change the direction or to use the long pass.
Play with confidence and be creative!

15. SUPPORTING CALLS, CALLING STRUCTURES AND STARTER MOVES:

"Fail to prepare and prepare to fail."

As practices:
Team split into groups of five or four (diamond support).
This will be used as a warm up and fitness drill during the season.
These supporting techniques are used in game situations. LEARN THEM!
Communication is vital.
Remember that the first supporter shouts the call and that the ball carrier listens!
The name of the player in possession and 'yes' means nothing!

Diamond Support:



This is an example on the way we should form up during our supporting drills or in the same formation but with five.

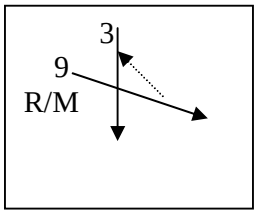
Normal Passing:

In your groups passing the ball up and down the field.
The call is 'pass left or pass right!'

Popping Left or Right:

In your groups running one behind each other, calling 'pop left or right!'
Player in possession stops and pops the ball to the next player who takes the ball at pace.
A pop is when the man in possession can touch his supporter with the ball.

Cut:

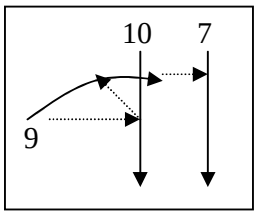


This is normally done off the scrumhalf during an option 1 on attack.
Man in possession runs towards his supporter and pops back to him running straight or at an angel. The supporting call would be 'cut left or right!'

Angles: (scissors)

The player in possession runs at an angle towards the supporter and pops to him running in the opposite angle.
'Angles left or right!' would be the call.

Pivot:



The supporter calls ‘pivot!’ receives the ball and then returns it to the original player in possession.
He then passes behind him to another supporting player.

Zulu:

Player goes to ground and places the ball after hearing the call ‘up!’ (Recoil)
The next player picks up.

Flip:

Player goes to ground and flips to the next player left or right after hearing the call ‘flip left or right!’

Aussie-aussie:

The player in possession turns after hearing, ‘Aussie-aussie!’
The next man shouts ‘ripping!’ and rips the ball. (Close the ‘V’)
He then pops off to the next man taking it at pace.

Bonsai:

Player in possession turns after hearing ‘Bonsai!’
The first supporter rips the ball while shouting ‘ripping!’
The next two supporters bind left and right and start a mini drive.

Kopper-kopper:

First man places ball and turns to defend (this is only in the practice situation).
The next man picks up and goes to ground.
Supporter seals and then cleans out. (Put the man on the ground, lift the leg and twist)
Last man picks up and passes to the next player etc.

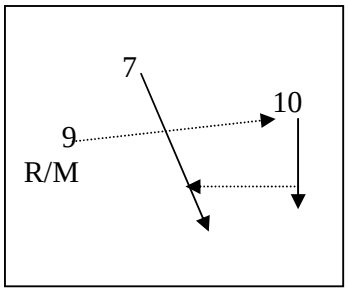
Power Ball:

Player takes the ball up and the supporting players drive in onto him from behind.
This is very effective close to the try line.

Flash:

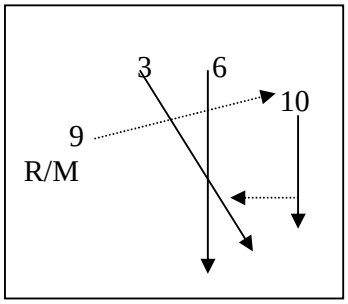
This is called if there is an overlap.
The ball is moved down the line by the backline as quickly as possible.
Every forward will stay out of it.

Blade 1:



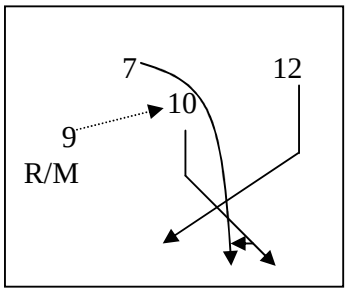
It is important that the player running off comes from behind the ruck or maul.
This can also be used off a scrum with the left wing.

Blade 2:



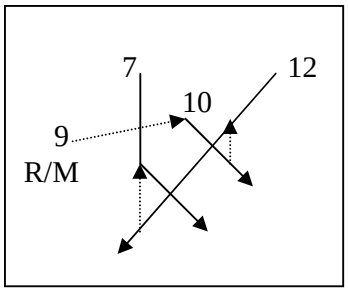
Here a player goes on a dummy run on the inside of 10.
The runner runs into the space that has been created.
Be careful for the obstruction.

Sniper:



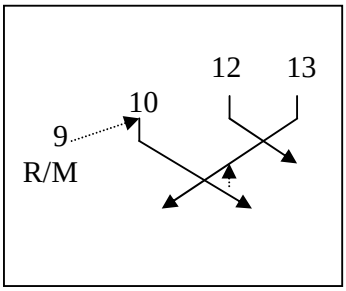
10 and 12 do a dummy ANGLES.
The runner gets the ball from 10.

Double:



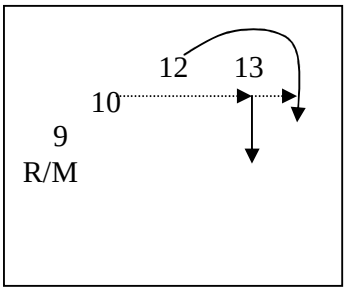
10 does an ANGLES with 12.
12 then does an ANGLES with a runner.

Slice:



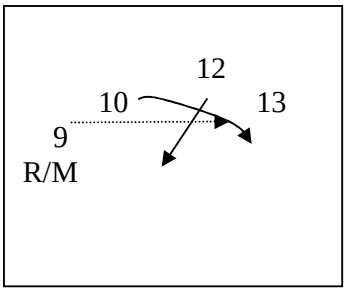
10 and 12 run across at slight angle.
13 does an ANGLES with 10.

Fruit loop:



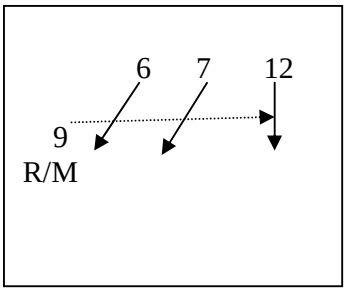
10 skips 12 to 13
13 plays 12 on the loop around

Rivot:



12 stops defence
9 passes behind 12 to 10 on the loop/drift or 13
Flat (in open play e.g. off a ruck)

Bubble:



6 and 7 go on dummy runs (stop the defence)
9 passes behind them to 12

Hundred:

This is a double skip. Players being skipped must hold up there hands.

Mole:

This is a grubber kick.

Flags:

This is a box kick. It is very effective with a wing chasing preferably from a ruck. Remember that anyone who was behind the kicker can put you on sides. You can't move forward until you have been put on sides.

Moon raicker:

Cross kick.

3- point stance:

Bending down with one hand on the ground (low body position). Used in defence e.g. lineout drive etc.

Sealing:

In support at the ruck. One hand holding the player's jersey on the ground and the other his shorts.

Recoil:

Placing the ball away from your body (using your core). Remember that something as simple as this can improve the recycling of the ball.

Trigger:

"Trigger" is called when the ref is playing advantage. This is the key word to have a go. The ball must be moved out of the "Red Zone" i.e. where the knock took place. We seldom kick the ball away when we have advantage. Remember to always play to the whistle!

Apache:

Sometimes in a game everyone needs to get into the zone at the same time. "Apache" is called by the captain, when he sees the need. Everyone gives it their all at the same time e.g. when we must score or dig even deeper to prevent a try etc.

16. FIELD SPLIT:

"Practice doesn't make perfect, perfect practice makes perfect."

H

Points Zone

Patience
Concentration
Play special zone moves
Composure and BMT

Expression Zone

Starter moves
Play options
Work the blind
Short lineouts with runners
Drives and peels
Quick ball



Percentage Zone

Kick for territory (Must play in their half)
Position and possession
Box kicks
Kick for corners
Up and unders
No mistakes

Safety zone

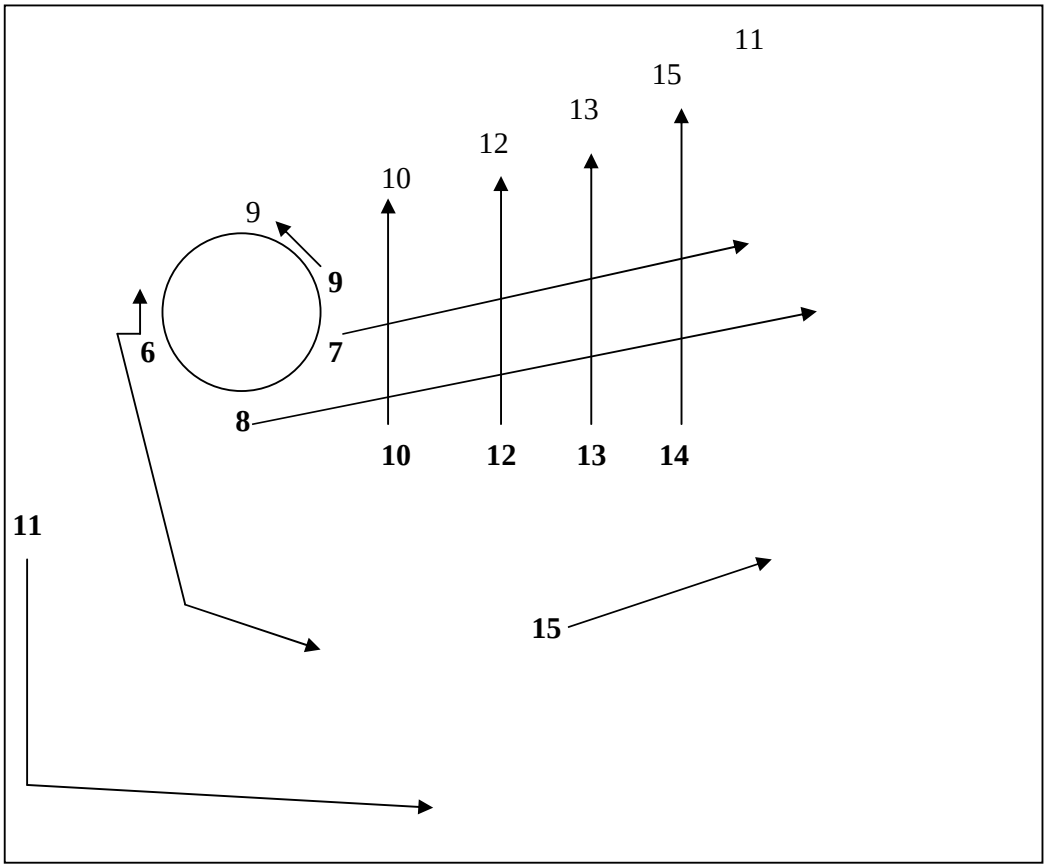
Only run it when it is on and be adventurous
Drives
Kick and chase
No contesting 10m out
Man on man defence
Defensive lineout 5m out

H

17. DEFENSIVE PATTERNS:

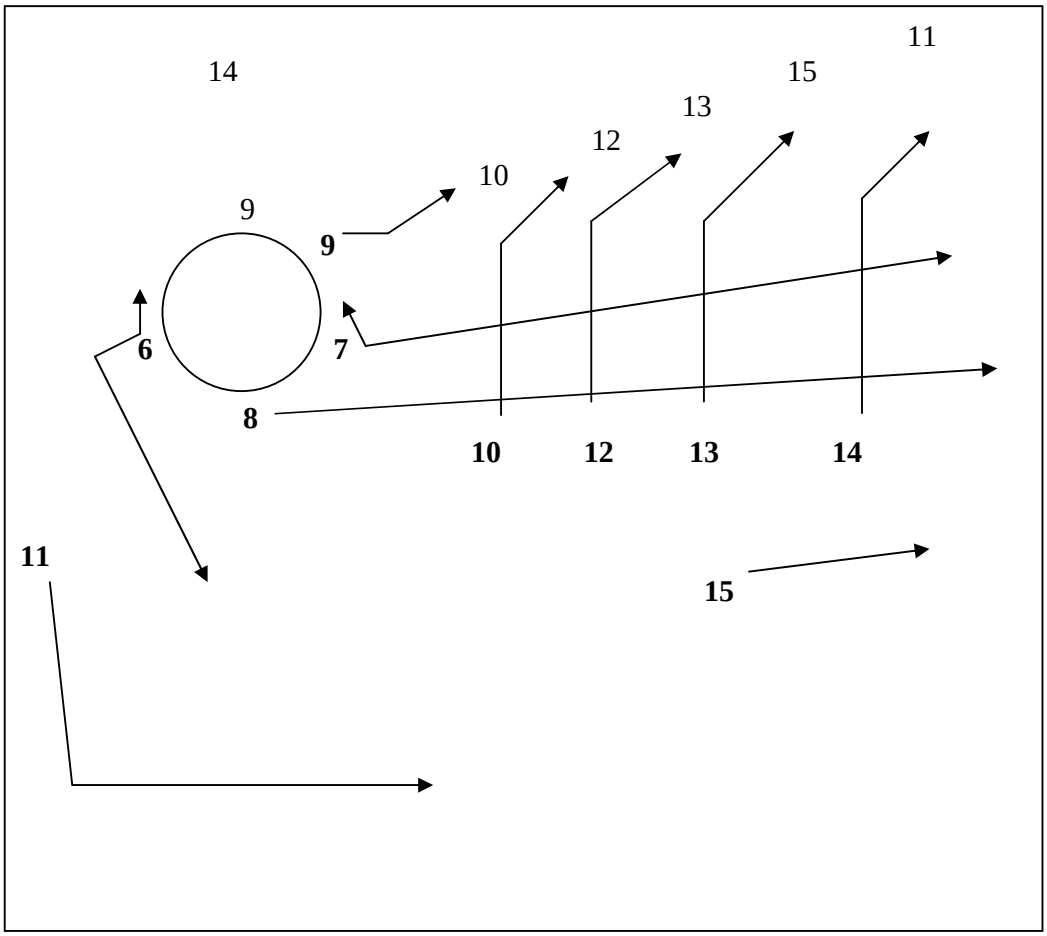
Defence from a Left Scrum:

A. *Man on Man*:



9 goes for his opposite number first and then moves behind his backline covering any missed tackles.
7 first covers the inside of 10 and then moves across the field behind his backs. He must always stay in the inside of the ball, so he can cover the inside gaps.
8 moves straight across the field behind the backs, watching for any missed tackles.
6 must first check if they are going blind. He must support 11 if they kick or cross cover.
11 falls back deep for the box kick and then moves across the field after their flyhalf has passed.
Backline must tackle man on man from the inside. They must come up together.
Tight Forwards 3, **2** and **5** take the shortest route and **1** and **4** take a slightly deeper route to the ball.

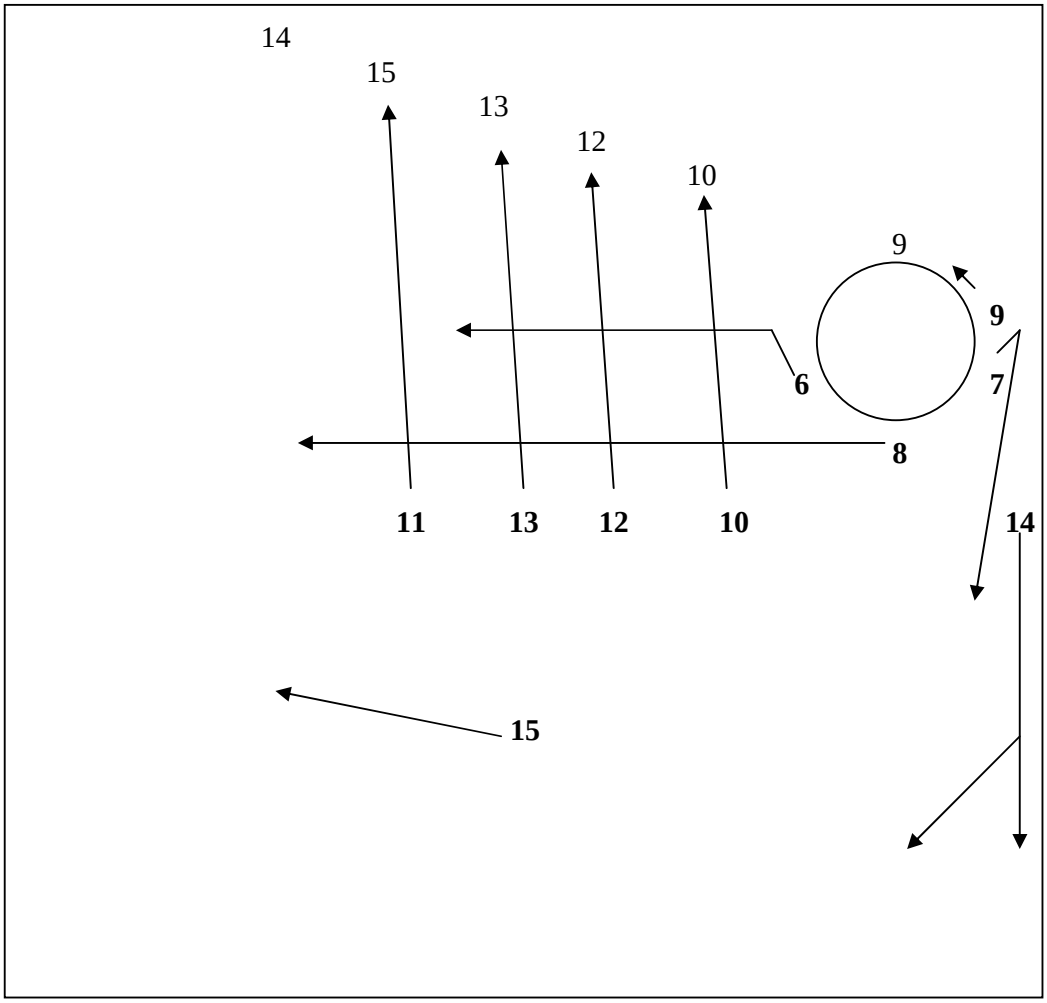
B. *Drift Defence*:



9 moves away from the scrum and takes their 10 and then puts the rest of their backline under pressure (he is only allowed to move 1m away, but play the ref).
Backline shifts one down and comes up together. They must stay in their channels.
7 watches their 9 and then moves across the field closing all inside gaps behind his backline.
8 also moves across the field watching for inside gaps and staying on the inside of the ball.
6 watches the blind and then falls back deep. If there is no kick he cross covers.
11 still watches for the box kick and then moves across the field watching for missed tackles or kicks.
15 always covers 2/3 of the field and the other 1/3 is covered by the wing.
Tight Forwards the same.

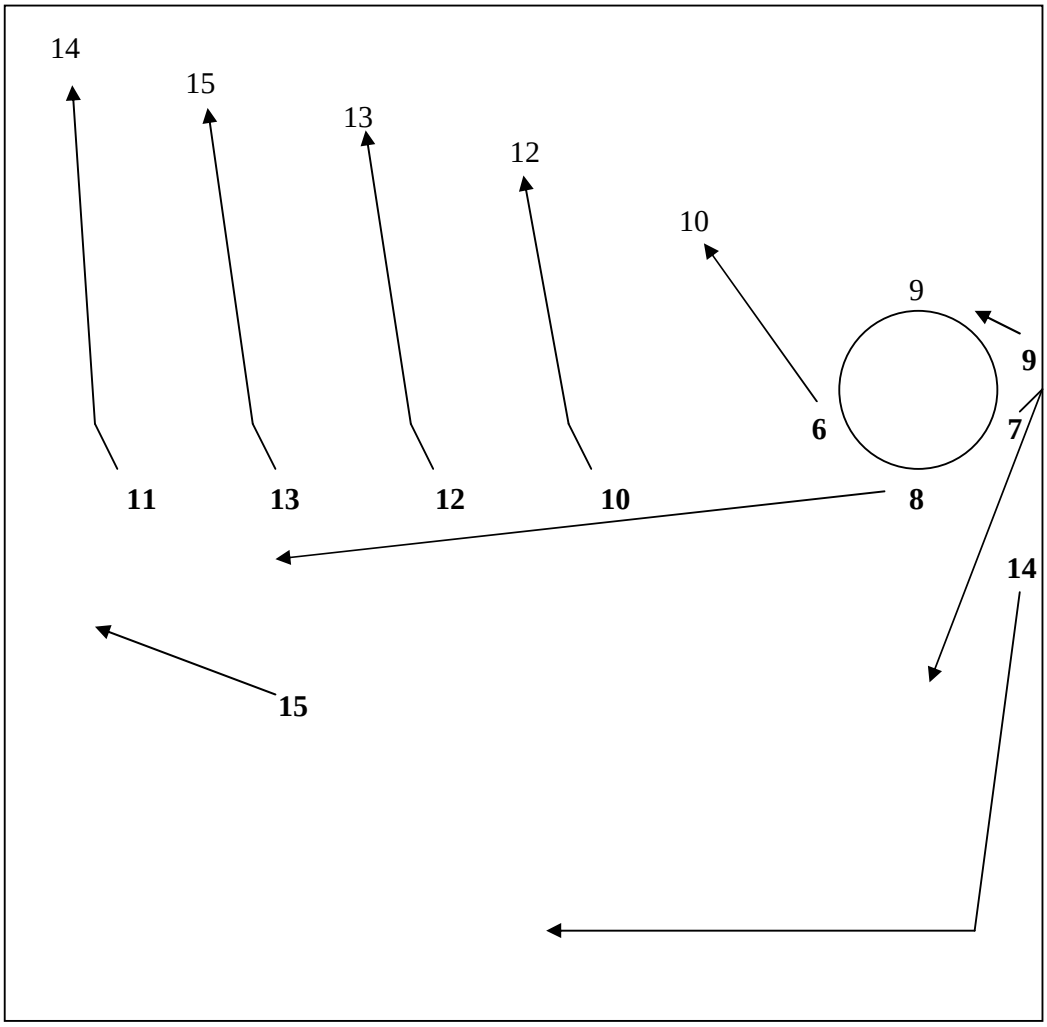
Defence from a Right Scrum:

A. *Man on Man*:



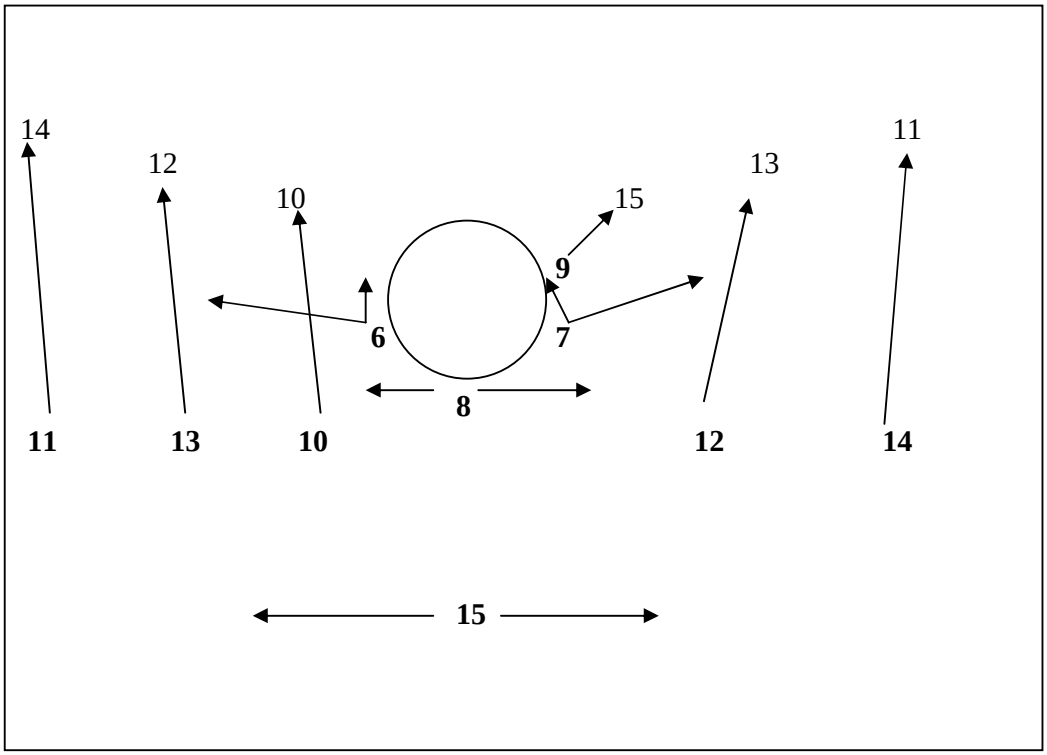
9 applies pressure on his opposite number and also on their 10 if he is standing deep or he moves around the back of his scrum and cover defends.
6 watches for a break around the scrum and then stays on the inside of his 10, until their 10 has passed. He then stays on the inside of the ball covering behind his backline.
Backline takes man on man from the inside and stay in their channels.
8 comes across the field (not over running the ball) watching for any breaks or kicks.
14 falls back deep watching for a box kick. After their 10 has passed he moves across the field.
7 makes sure that they are not going blind and then falls back deep. If there is no kick he cross covers.
Tight Forwards on the left **1**, **2** and **4** take the shortest root and the right **3** and **5** take deeper root.

B. *Drift Defence*:



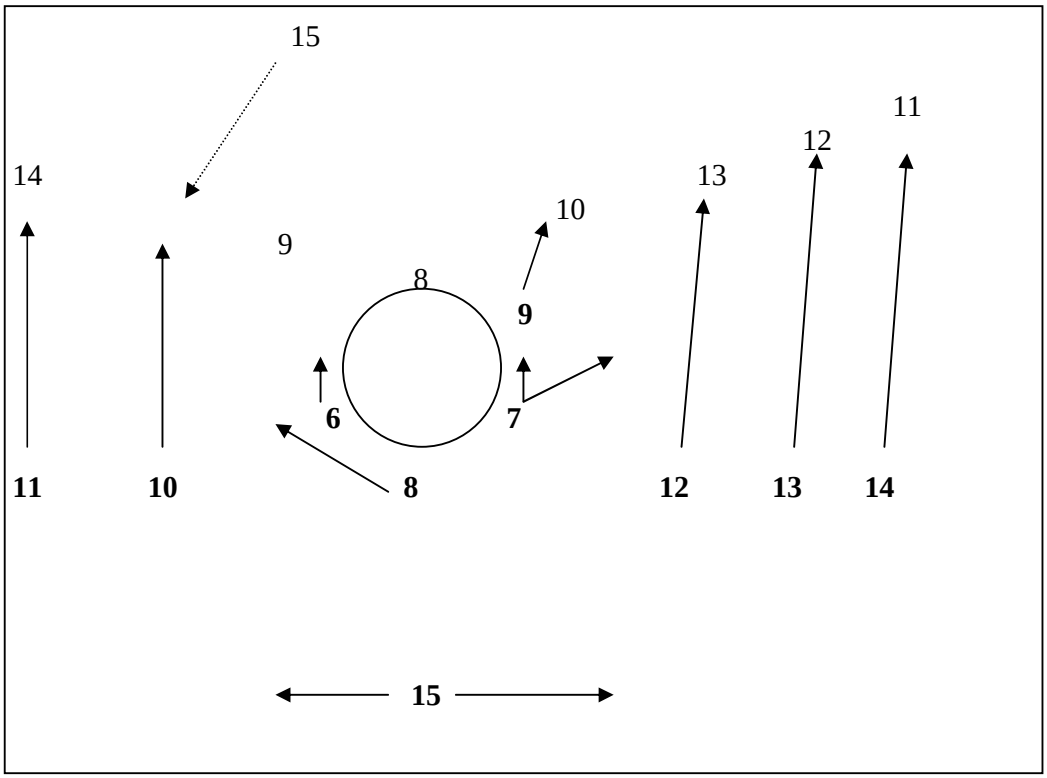
9 does the same as man on man defence from a right scrum.
10 moves across the field and takes their inside centre from the inside.
Backline also moves across the field. They take their men from the inside and stay in their channels.
6 takes their 10 and then moves across the field covering the inside gaps.
8 first covers the inside gap between their 9 and 10 and then cross covers.
7 and **14** do the same as above.
Tight Forwards do the same.

Defence from a Midfield Scrum:



9 will always takes the first man on the right.
10 will always take 10 on the left.
Backline always takes their man.
15 covers either side.
Flankers will always watch for the pick up and then cover the first channel to the scrum or fall back deep. They then move across the field covering the inside gaps.
Wings will either be taking their man or falling back a bit for the box kick before cross covering. The outside man is always his man.
Tight Forwards: the three closest to the ball take the shortest route and the other two take a deeper route.

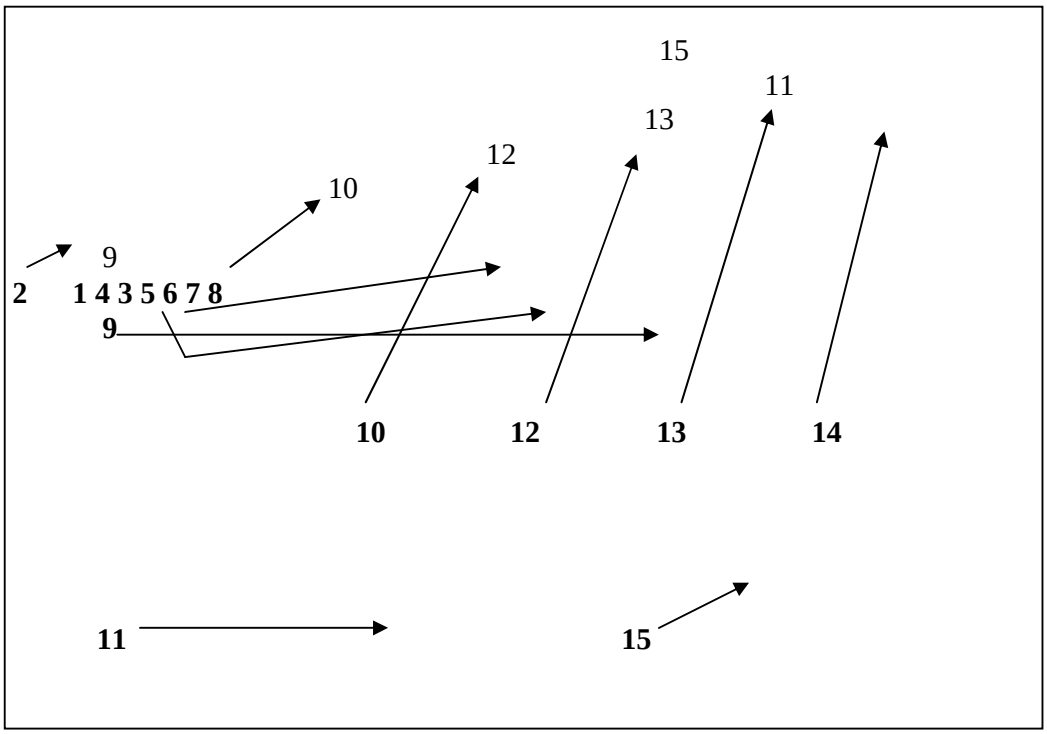
Big blind on the Left:



10 will leave 9 for **8** and take 15.
8 take 9.

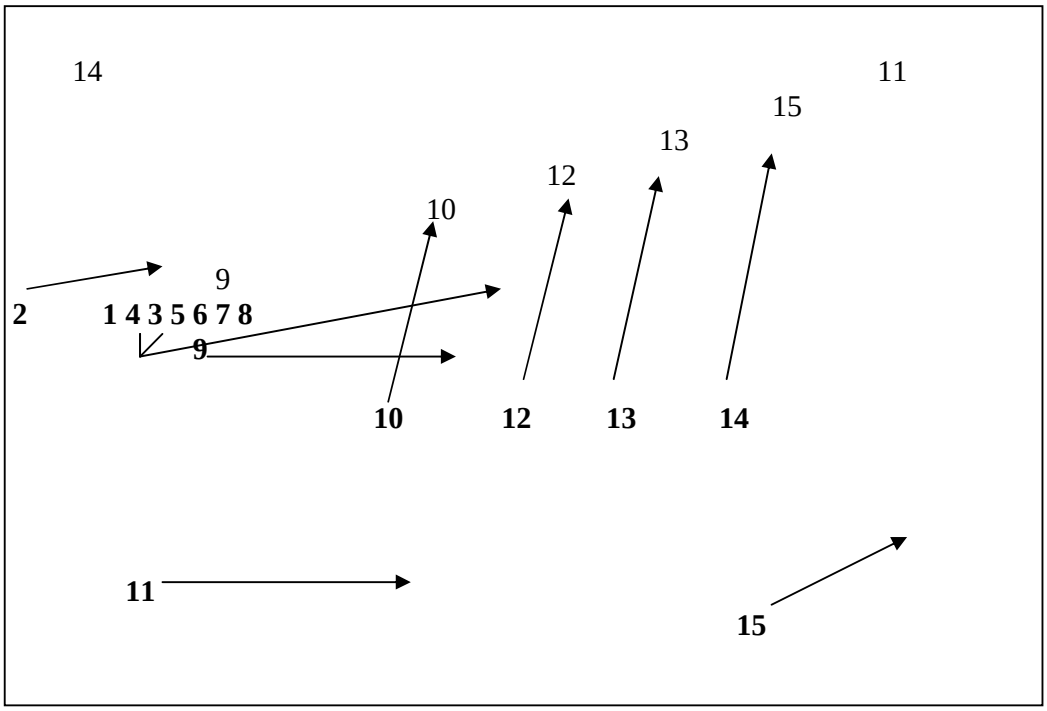
Defence from the Lineout:

A. *When the ball goes to 2 or 4*:



Loose Forwards are in the game so they can defend.
8 takes 10 and then covers the inside gaps.
7 moves across the field staying on the inside of the ball watching for any inside breaks just in front of the advantage line.
6 moves across the field along the advantage line, staying on the inside of the ball.
9 also moves across the field behind the advantage line, watching for any chips.
11 checks for the box kick and then cross covers.
2 applies pressure on 9 and then comes across. If they drive he stands off on the blind.
Tight Forwards take the shortest root to the ball while covering the blind together.

B. *When the ball goes to the back*:



Loose forwards are out of it, but must work hard to get back into the game.
Backline tackles man on man.
Tight Forwards must try and watch the inside gaps while cross covering.
11 does the same as above.
2 also does the same as above.

If there is a short lineout our forwards must defend against their forwards standing off.

Obviously the same defensive patterns off the left lineout apply to the right lineout.

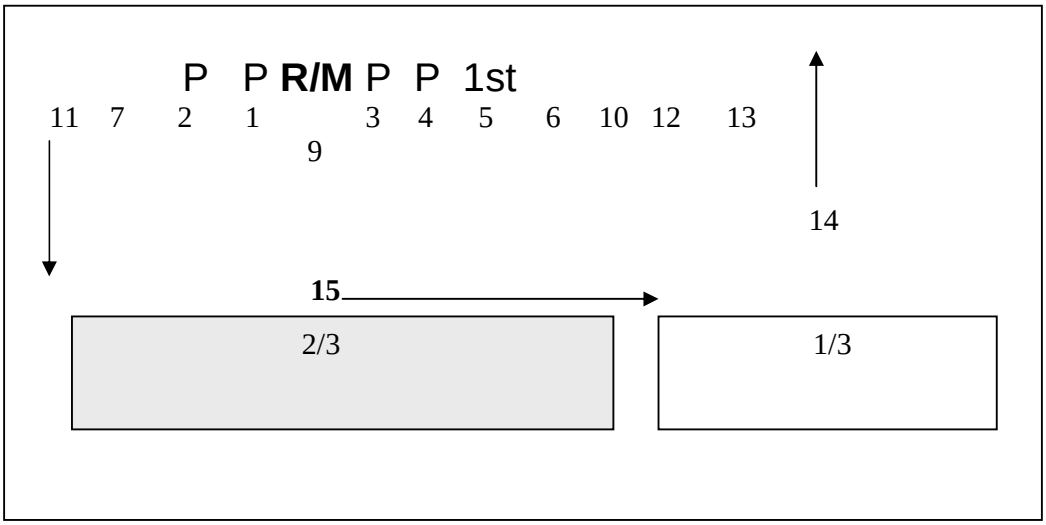
Special Lineout Defence:

Put the fastest loose forward in the backline. He gets used to rush/pressurise their 10 or centre. As soon as the ball is tapped, he goes as fast as he can. The backs defend as usual behind him.

Or play this loose forward at scrumhalf and let him stand at the back of the lineout. He will then have less distance to cover.

'Sacking' can be used to defend a drive.

Defence in Open Play:



Pillars: 1 and 3
Must watch for a pick and go and then cover inside of the Post.
Pillar must make sure that everyone is behind the last mans feet at the ruck.

Posts: 2 and 4
Watch for a break by the scrumhalf and then cover the inside of the 1st defender.
The Post man shouts "Hold, hold, …" while watching the scrumhalf and the ball.
Once the ball is in play he shouts "Press!" or "Rush!" and the rest of the defensive line comes up together, while making sure that their inside defender is slightly in front of them.

1st Defender: The 1st Defender tackles the first receiver. If the 1st receiver passes the ball he then covers the inside of the next defender.

The tight forwards must always work their way in, to defend around the ruck or maul. We can't have tight forwards defending the opposition's backs.
The "Pillar" and "Post" must take up their positions as soon as possible. They always go up and shut out the inside gaps.
Players must be behind the last mans feet at the ruck.
New defenders file in on the outside of the 1st defender.
The inside defender must always watch for the inside step by the next attacking player after his man has passed.
Remember that to be beaten on the outside the attacker has to be really quick, this is why they often step back inside.

REMEMBER TO COMMUNICATE!

Defence in General:

It is obvious that rugby players prefer attack to defense, but by putting in extra work on defense, your attack can actually improve.

The tackling technique you use on the field depends on the situation that you are in.

- Always keep your opponent on your outside. This way you will have less distance to cover and will need less speed. Tackle inside hip.
- Tackle the ball. It is an easier target than his legs and can't mislead you, but watch out for the hand off.
- Keep your eyes open at all times!
- Never give your opponent time or space. Go to him don't let him come to you.
- No studs showing and get close to the attacker, arms up, hit with the shoulder, clamp arms and lift opposite leg and twist.
- If you are tackling head on. Tackle him in an upward movement to counter his forward movement. This tackle should put him back. Or just take him low.
- If your opponent is running at you and you are stationery and have little momentum you can grab his jersey and pull him down (this is known as riding the tackle) or take him around the ankles. His momentum should bring himself down. This tackle will stop the movement but won't take him backwards (get on your feet and steal the ball or slow it down).
- When tackling side on you can go for his mid rib area, hips, thighs or ankles. Remember to get your head out of the way to avoid injury.
- You will always put your man down if you take him low.
- Commitment is the key in tackling. How committed are you?

It is important to prevent the wing from coming in and leaving a gap out wide, and also for communication to take place constantly.

If you are ever in a 1 on 2 situation, never rush up (delay your commitment to an attacker). This will give your team mates time to get back and help.

You have to constantly be on your toes to react when defending. You must also have the correct stance on defence as well as the fact that once a pass has been made, the defender who was not on cue is not off the hook. You need to work! Still come up and watch the inside.

After making a tackle get back onto your feet as quickly as possible.

The roles and responsibilities at the breakdown are important, and a team needs to be technically astute and aggressive at the tackle ball area. If we dominate the collision area, it will buy time for the defense to dominate the next collision area. The majority of the game is spent in this area and if we can dominate here we will win any game.

Where was Henry Honibal's point of contact when his shoulders crashed into his opponents? It was just above the waist. This is the softest and most vulnerable area of your opponent. Why go for a hard, moving target like his legs, if you can go for a soft stationery target.
The most important part in tackling is the contact with the shoulder, the clamping of the arms and then driving him back with leg power. (Eyes open, Shoulder and Arms)

Backline:

- In our 22m we always defend man on man
- Stay in your channels and come up together
- Vary the speed that you come up. This will confuse your opponents.
- Offensive defence (be aggressive)
- Communication
- Commitment

Forwards:

- 10m from our line we never contest their lineout and watch for the drive or peel.
- If they drive or maul remember low body positions and lift their legs or sack. Work together and try to isolate their ball carrier. Hit them hard and fast, drive them back and split them. Remember the 3 point stance.
- Tight forwards need to watch the first channel of the rucks.
- Loose forwards must stand out and mark their loose forwards. They must watch for the overlaps and work hard cross covering. Remember to watch the outside and inside channel of your flyhalf and to cover all the inside gaps.
- Offensive defence
- Communication
- Commitment

18. SOME GENERAL ATTACKING POINTS:

The last thing you want to do is go to ground on good attacking ball, especially if there is a lack of support.

Keep the ball alive and offload to a supporting player.

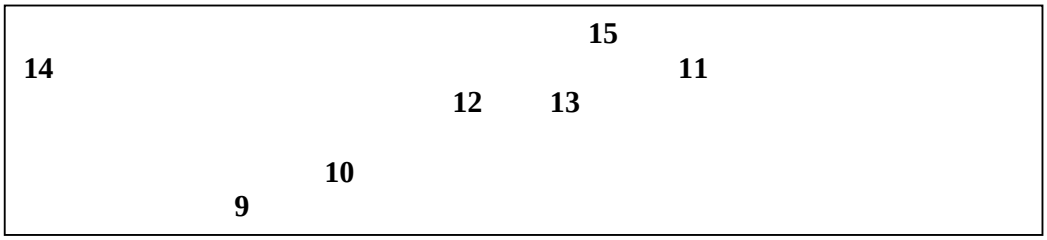
Getting slow ball at the breakdown often means that the team isn't dictating.

Ball presentation and winning the contact will determine if you get good attacking ball. You need to concentrate on doing the small things correctly in training because they then become second nature in the game situation.

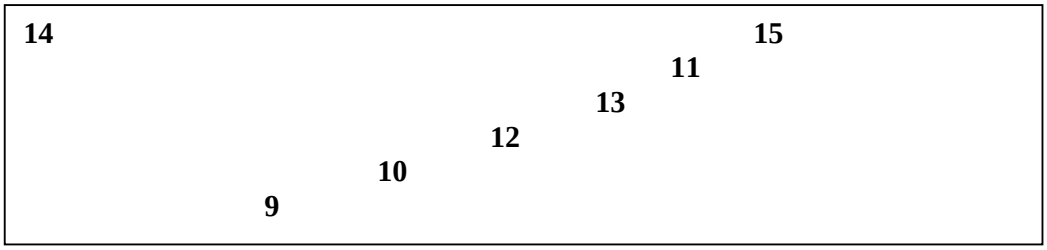
The more 'live' the contact is in training, the better prepared players are for the game situation.

Use the area out wide e.g. 5m to touchline. If we put 3 players in this area and can offload it is almost certain that we will get through.

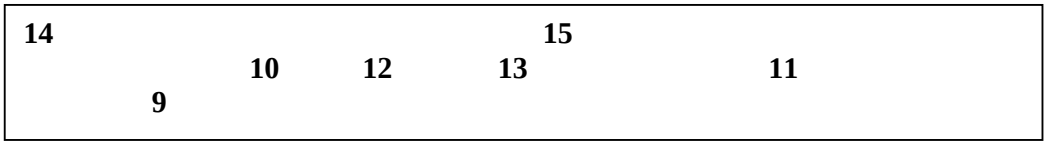
19. ANTICIPATING WHAT COULD HAPPEN FROM A LINEOUT OR SCRUM BY YOUR OPPONENT'S FORMATION:



10 *is shallow,* **12** *and blindside wing are deep*:
12 and **10** could be planning a move or
14 may be joining the line.



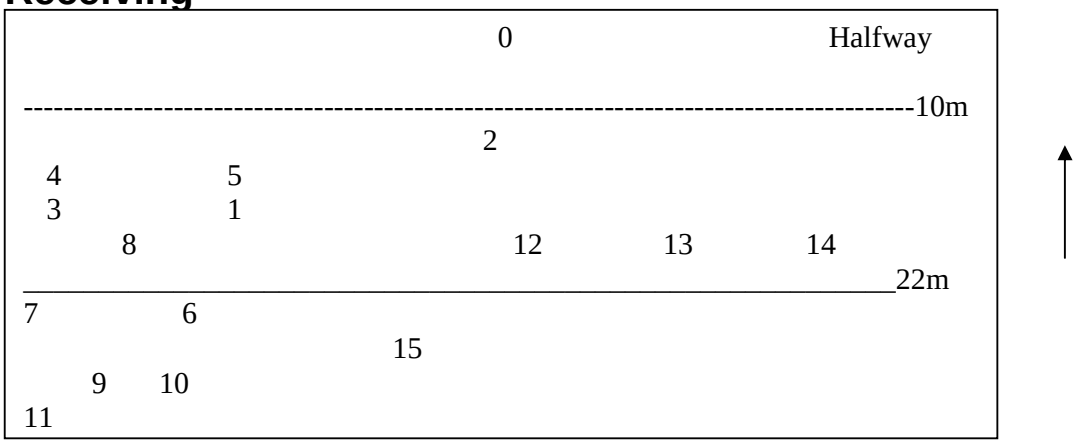
Backline is standing deep and **15** *is wide*:
Ball must be going wide.



The backline is standing shallow:
10 might kick or the forwards might pick up or drive.

20. KICK OFFS:

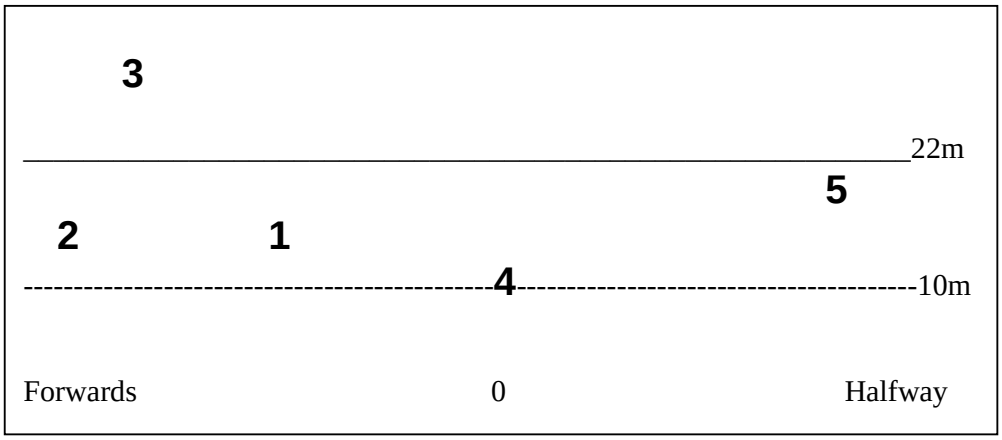
Receiving



If they kick short always form the drive. There are then the options to either play the box kick “Flags” by 9 or play 10 to kick for position. If the blind is open go blind.

If they kick deep a loose forward must take it up and then we play from there.
Only if it is really on do we run it! We kick to get it out (kicker stay in 22m) and must kick for the closet touchline (get it out).

When we kick off:



There are four options. The kicker must let the team know where he is kicking.
If we kick deep, option 3 the winger on that side chase. 9 falls back to watch for the kick.
Forwards always go up in first wave and second wave.
The backs must come up together to shut them out. Remember to get back if there is a counter on.
We should always kick left if the opposition don’t have a left footed kicker.

21. BACKLINE MOVES:

Moves in General:

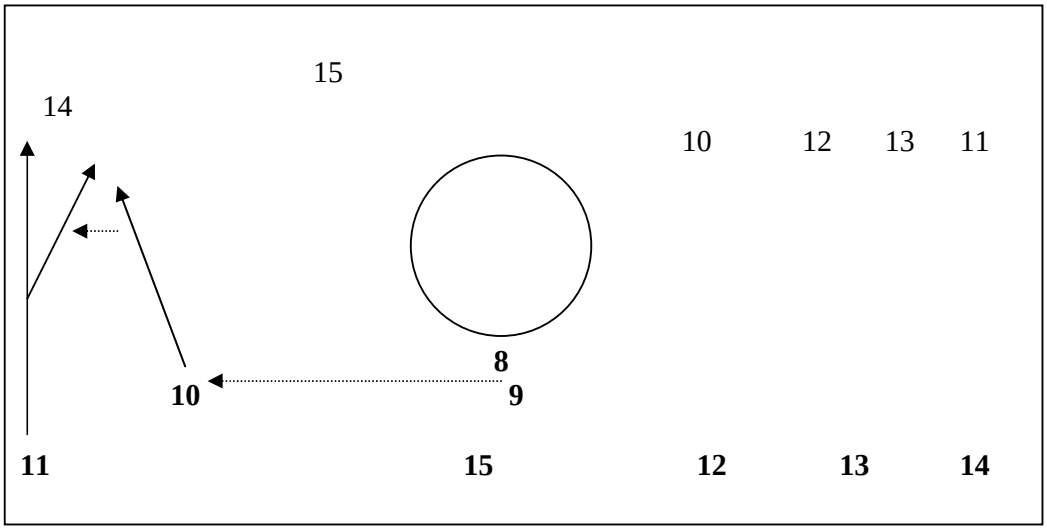
We don't do moves to look fancy. A move is there to create space; so we can score a try or set up the next play. It is very important that during a move, we never get caught behind the advantage line. When a move is called and during it, space opens somewhere else, move the ball there and exploit it. This means that we must cancel a move if something else occurs. We need to communicate and look at what the defence is doing. The fly half must vary the distance and pace that he receives the ball.

I am personally not in favour of backline moves, because I feel that a backline should have enough vision and skill to create something without them. For this to be possible, communication would be even more important. Often moves are called and followed through when at the time there are other opportunities on the field. Players have to develop the skill of looking at the defence in front of them and creating something after assessing the situation. Moves don't help this skill and make the players think less and rely on them to be creative on the field.

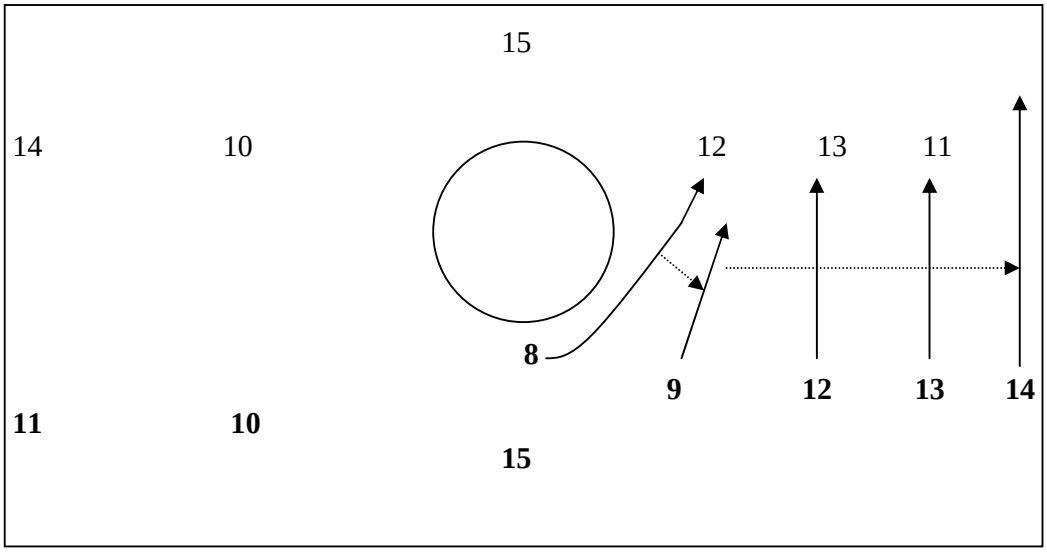
I feel this is a major problem in SA rugby, players lack creativity. The reason behind this is the way that they have been coached. It is frightening when comparing our skill levels to those of the New Zealanders and Aussies. We need to learn to play it the way we see it!

The following are Situations from a midfield scrum:

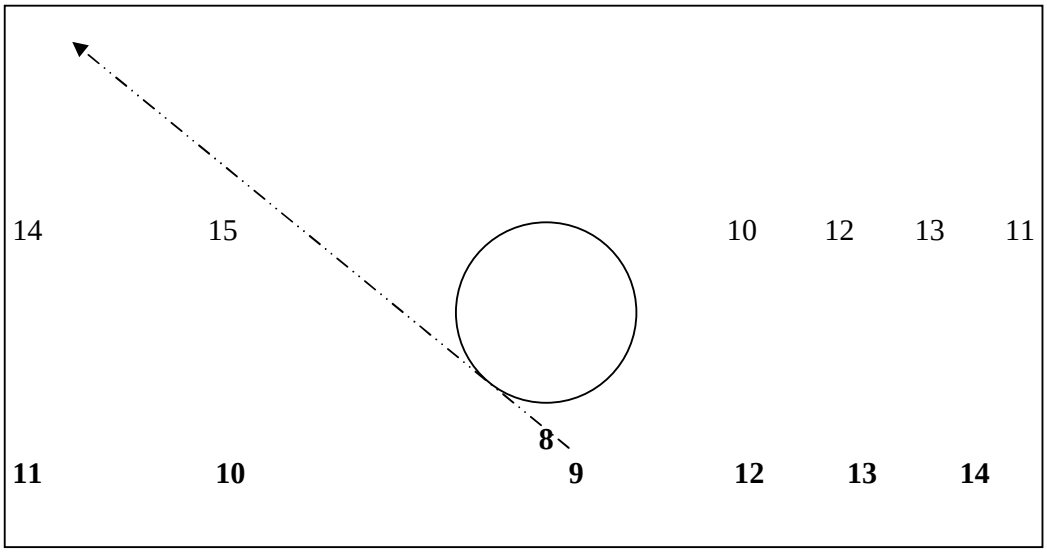
Option's 10, 8 or 9 are called by **10** after checking the defence



Option 10:
14 and 15 standing deep
Attack the blind, **10** stands wide and flat
10 runs at oppositions **14**
10 then links with **11**

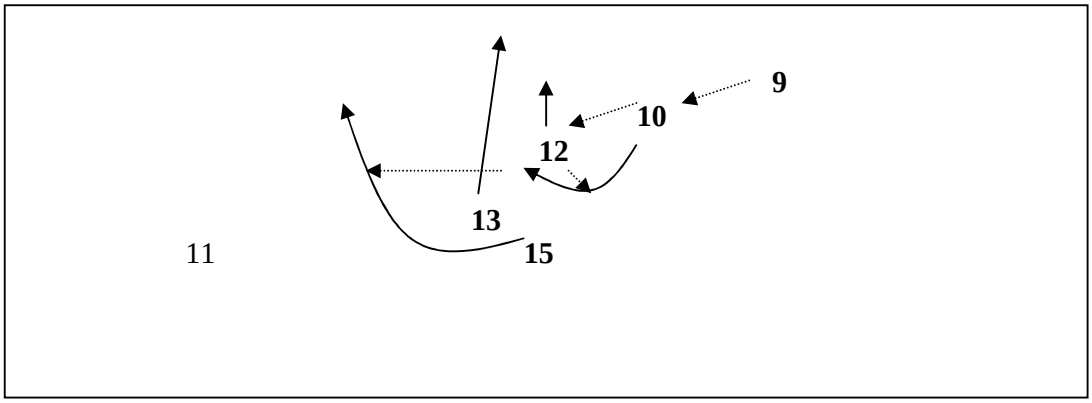


Option 8:
8 picks up and draws defence then passes to **9**
9 to **12** to **13** who plays **14**
15 and **10** come around



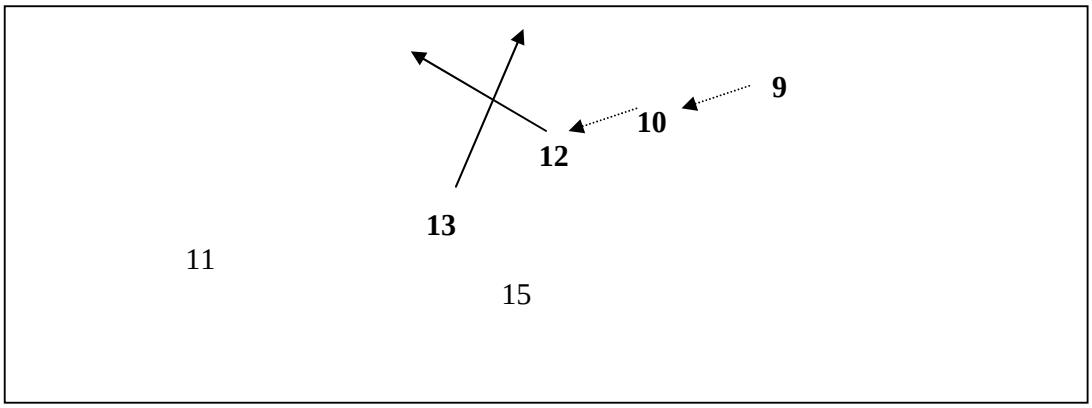
Option 9:
When opposition backs are all flat
8 pops to **9** who box kicks (FLAGS) for **11** who chases

“Loopy”



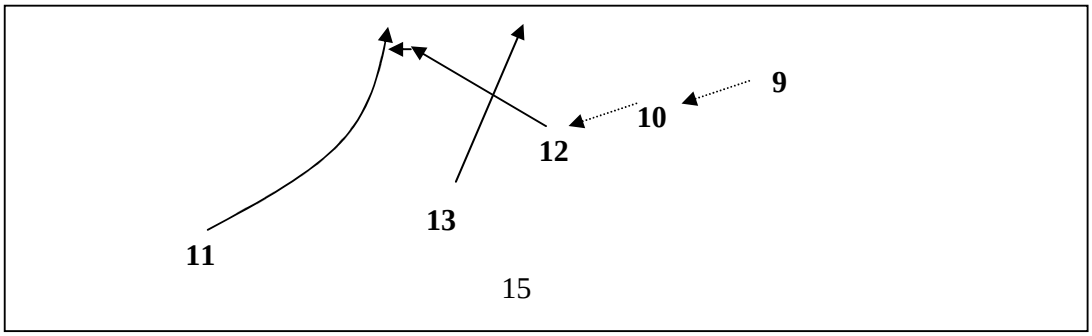
9 to **10**
10 to **12**
12 back to **10** (“Pivot”)
10 passes to **15** coming into the line behind **13’s** back

“Pepsi 1”



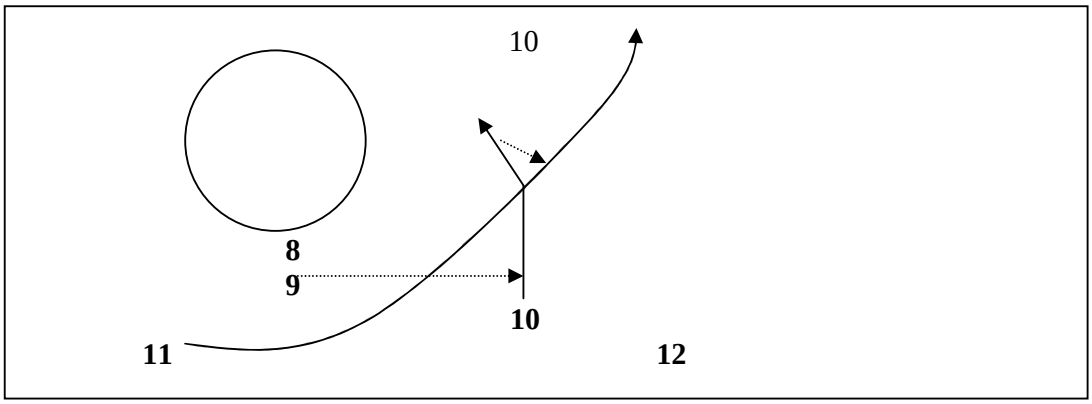
9 to **10**
10 to **12**
12 and **13** switch (“angles”)

“Pepsi 2”



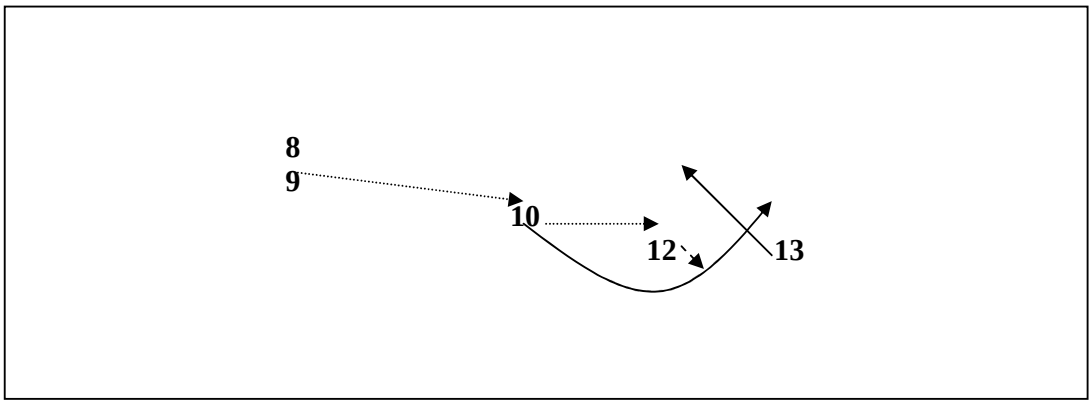
9 to **10**
10 to **12**
12 and **13** go on dummy switch (“Angles”)
13 plays **11** (short ball i.e. “Pop”)

“Beefy 10”



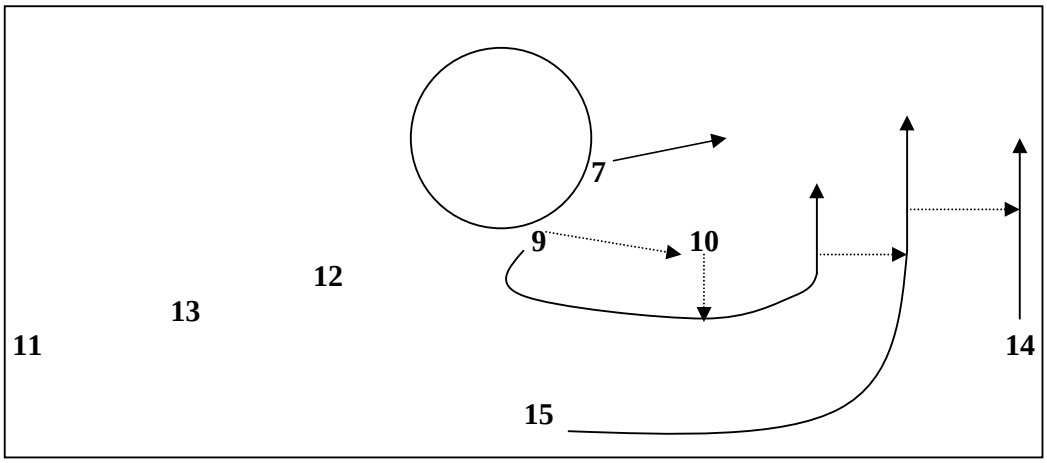
9 to **10**
10 draws opposite 10 in and pops to **11** coming around

“Twister”

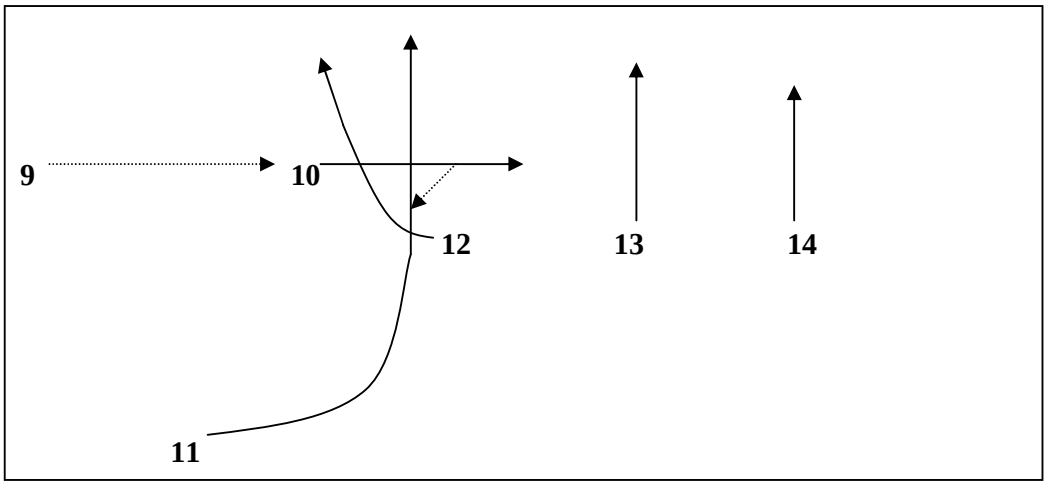


9 to **10**
10 plays **12** in and pops to **11** coming around
13 goes on dummie short ball while **10** loops and is played by **12**

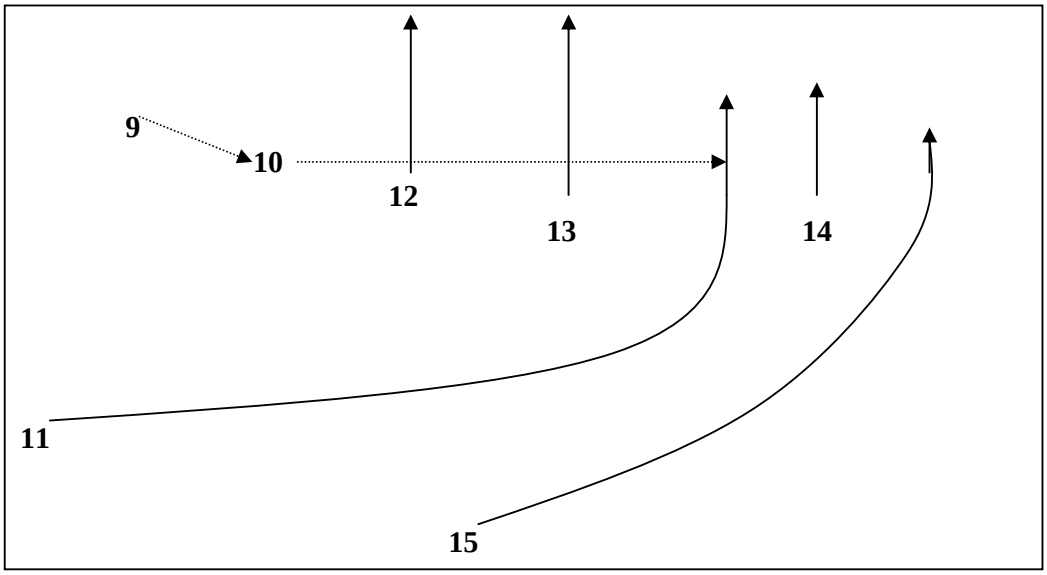
SOME GENERAL MOVES:



9 passes to **10** standing flat
9 loops around **10** and receives the ball again
9 then passes to **15** coming into the line
15 can then pass to **14** or supporting loose forward
14 could also do an 'angles left' with **15**



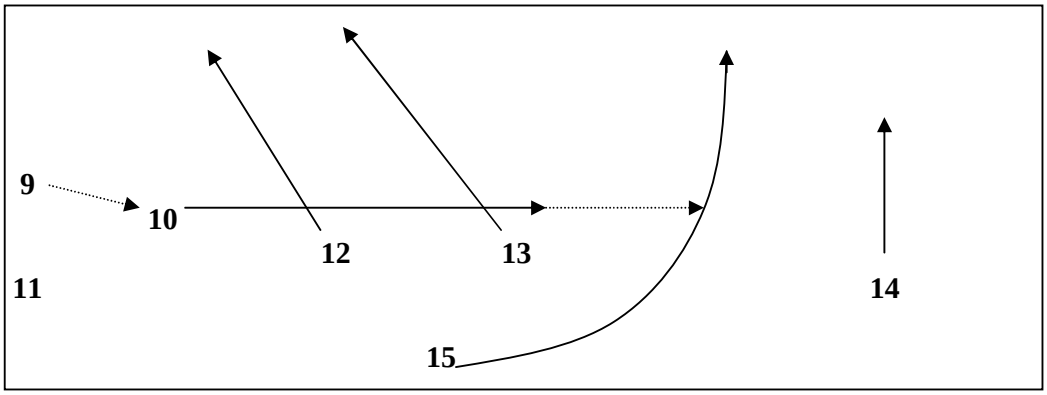
9 passes to **10** (standing flat)
10 then runs diagonally across the field
12 go on the dummy scissors with **10**
10 then pops inside to **11** running through the gap



Option 1:
9 to **10** running onto the ball
10 passes to the opposite wing coming into the line
12 and **13** go on dummy runs.
11 and **15** join the line out wide with **14** in support

Option 2:
10 passes to **12** going crash ball

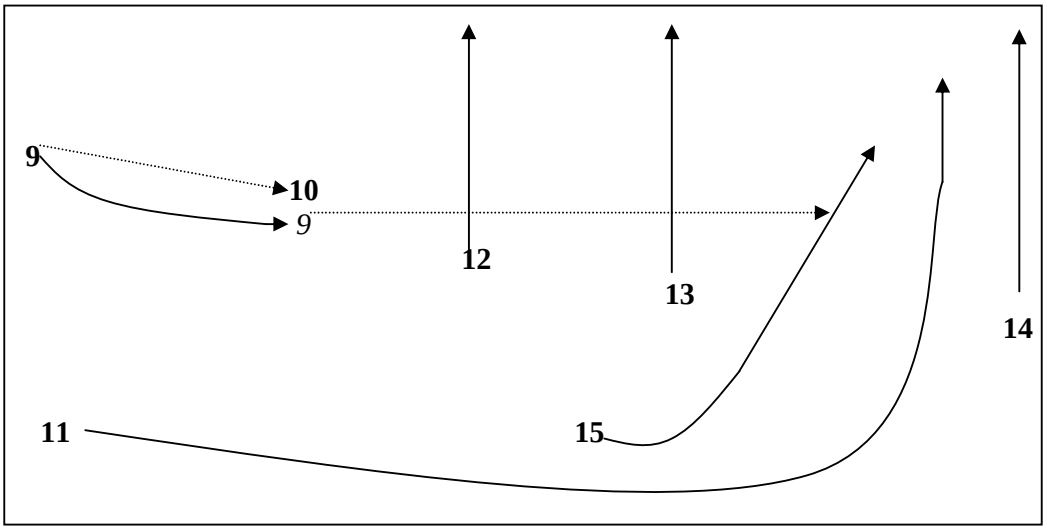
Option 3:
10 passes behind **12** to **13** going on crash ball



Option 1:
9 to **10**
10 runs across the field dummying **12** and **13**
10 passes to **15** coming into the line at pace

Option 2:
10 gives the ball to **12** to go on the crash

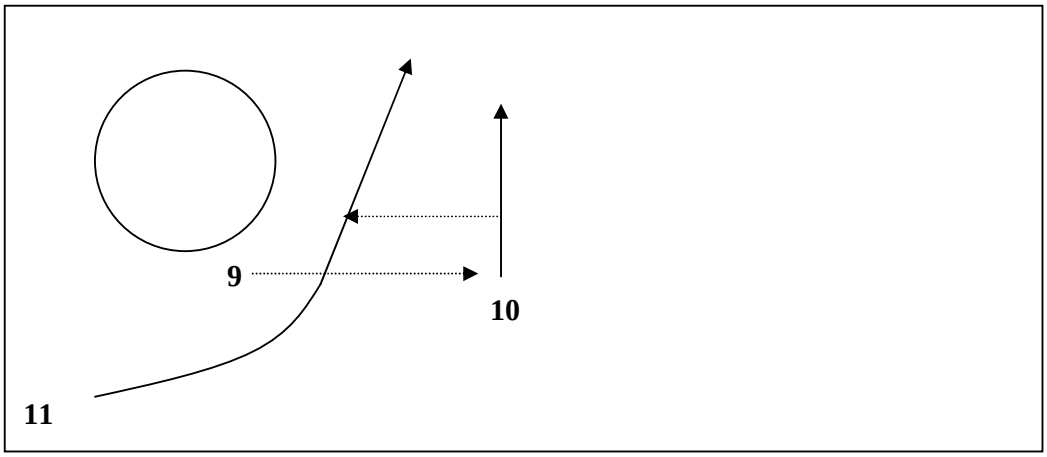
Option 3:
10 dummies **12** and gives to **13**



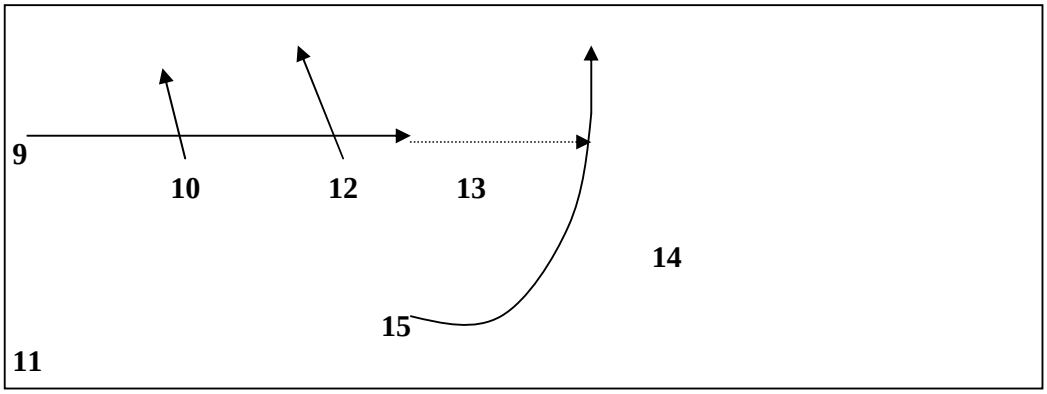
Option 1:
9 to **10**
10 back to **9** on the loop
9 passes behind **12** and **13** to **15**
11 also coming across

Option 2:
9 passes to **12** to go crash

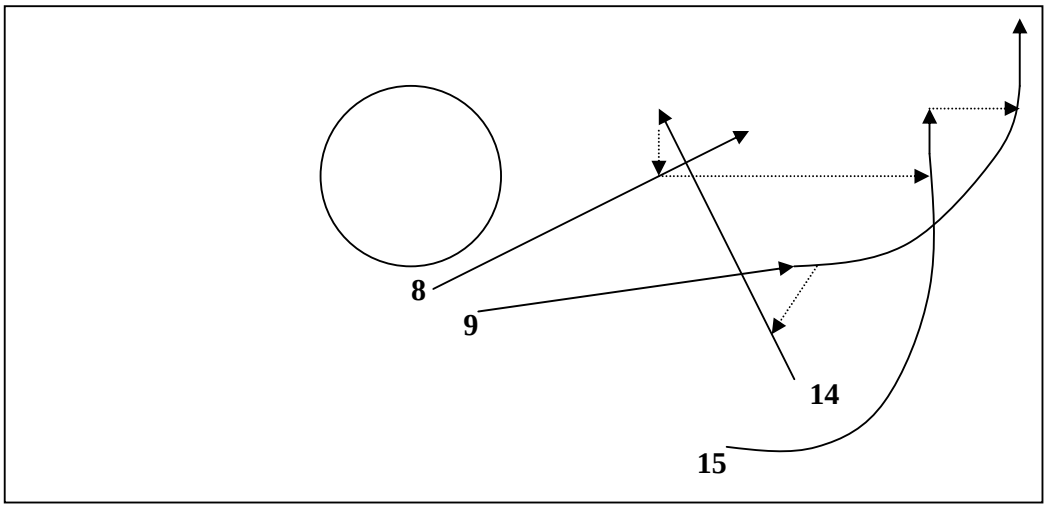
Option 3:
9 passes behind **12** to **13** for the crash



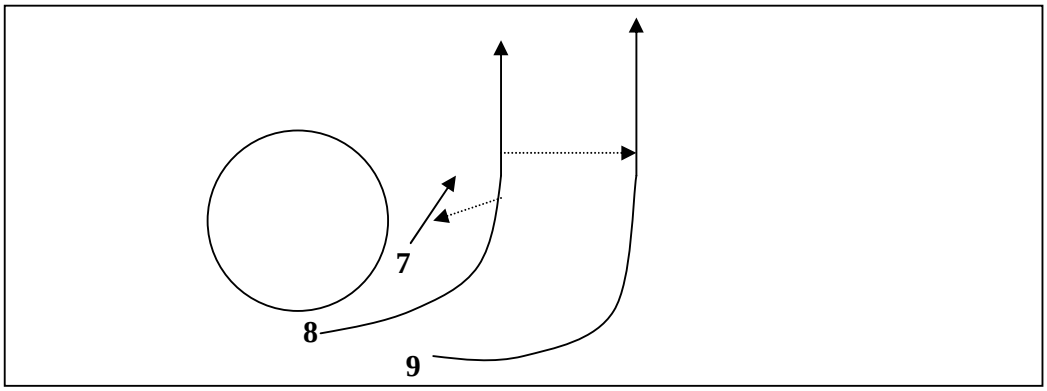
Scrum gets a right shoulder and **9** passes flat pass to **10** running onto it
10 then passes an inside pass back to **11** on the angle



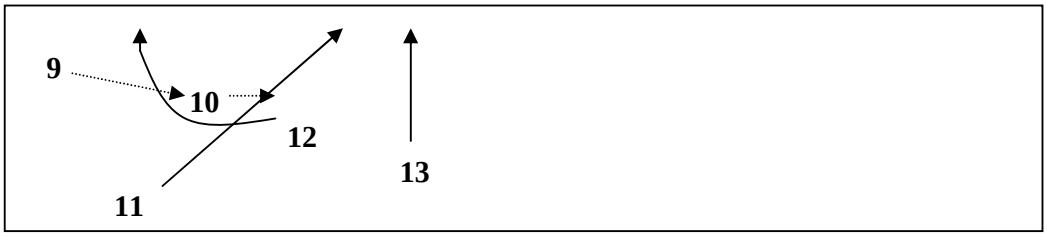
9 runs across the field and dummies **10** and **12**
9 passes in front of **13** to **15** coming into the line



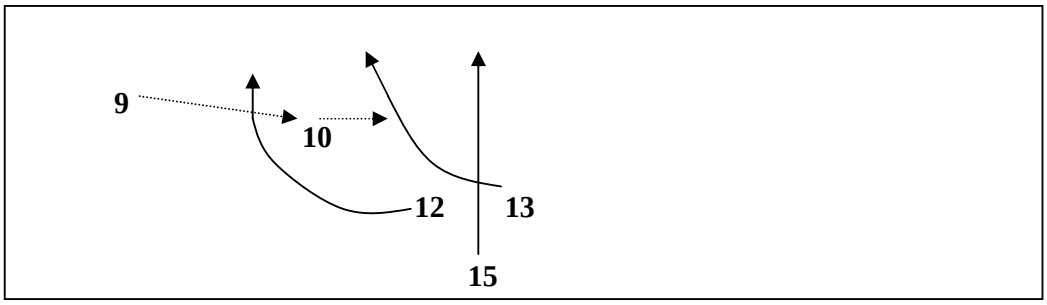
9 runs across the field and does scissors with **14**
14 passes to **8**
8 passes to **15** coming into the line
9 goes wide and receives pass from **15**



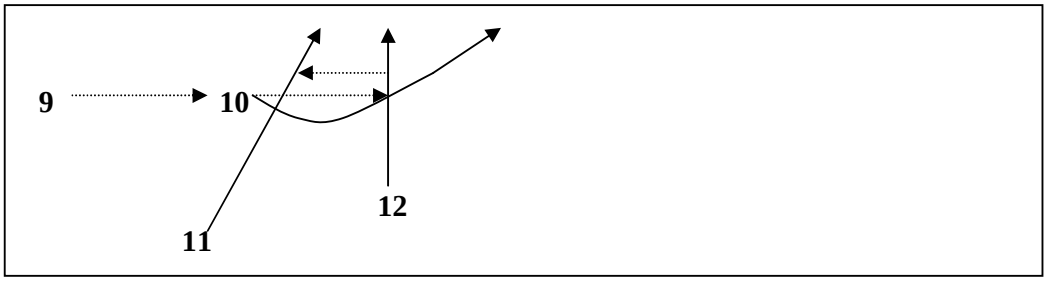
8 picks up and goes on break
8 passes back inside to **7** or **9** going wide



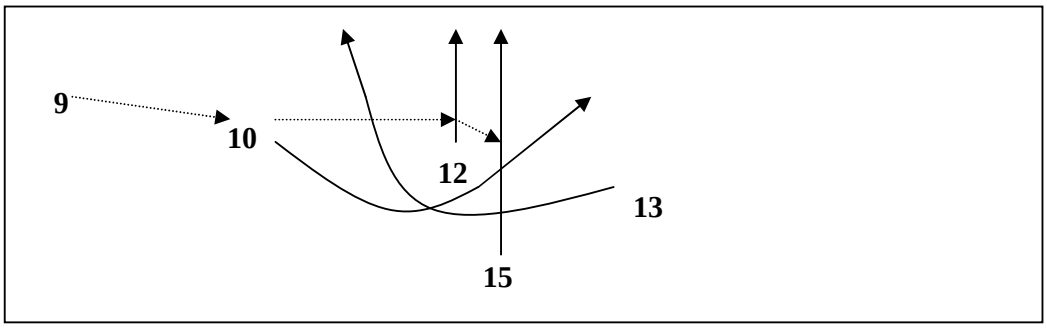
9 to **10**
10 dummies **12** and passes to **11** at angle



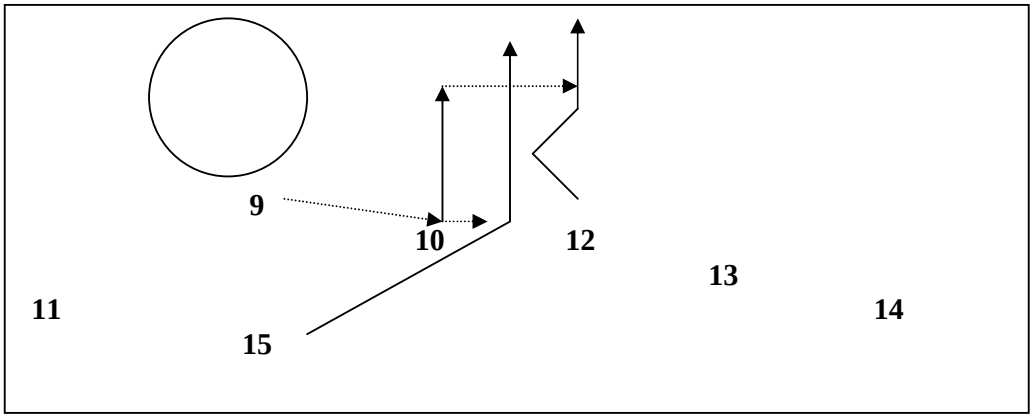
9 to **10**
10 dummies **12** and passes to **13** (13 can also be dummied and 15 could receive the ball)
15 hits the line in support



9 to **10** standing flat
10 passes to **12** running onto the ball
10 then loops around **12** who dummies him
12 then pops to **11** running at pace



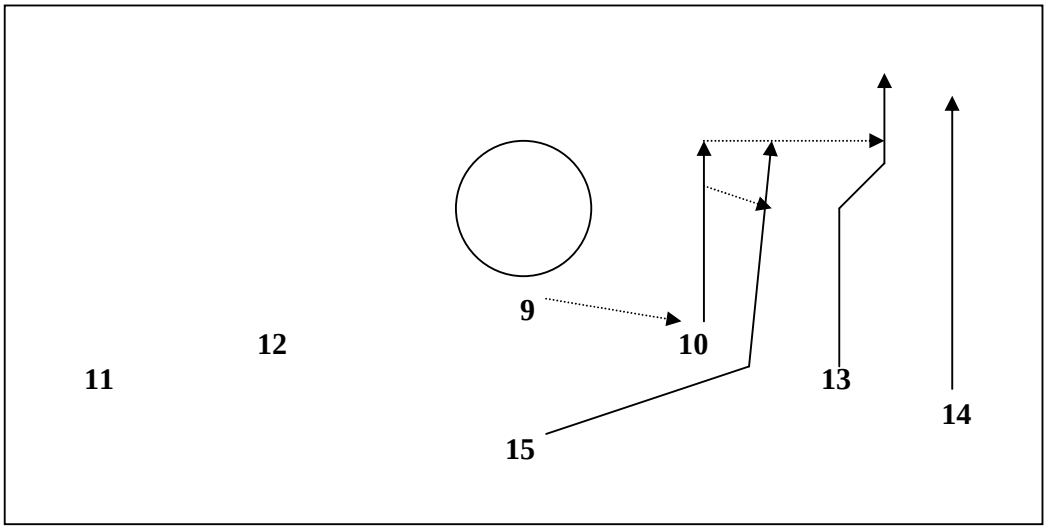
9 to **10**
10 passes a flat pass to **12** running onto the ball
10 and **13** loop around **12** who dummies both and pops to **15** hitting the line at pace



Left Scrum

Option 1:
9 to **10**
10 plays flat to **15** short off his shoulder

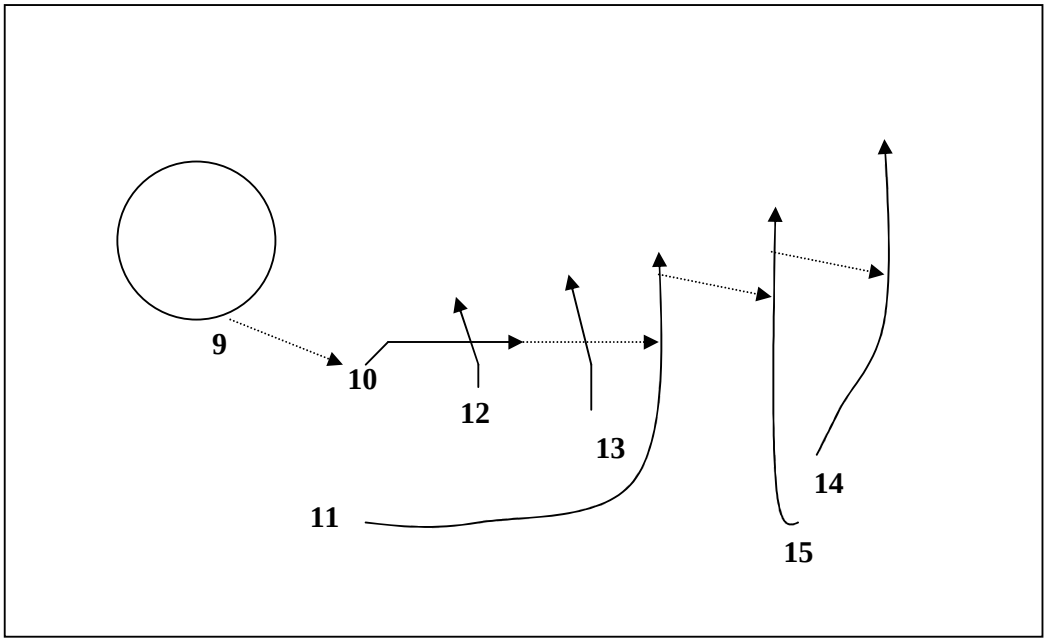
Option 2:
skips **15** to **12** on slight drift



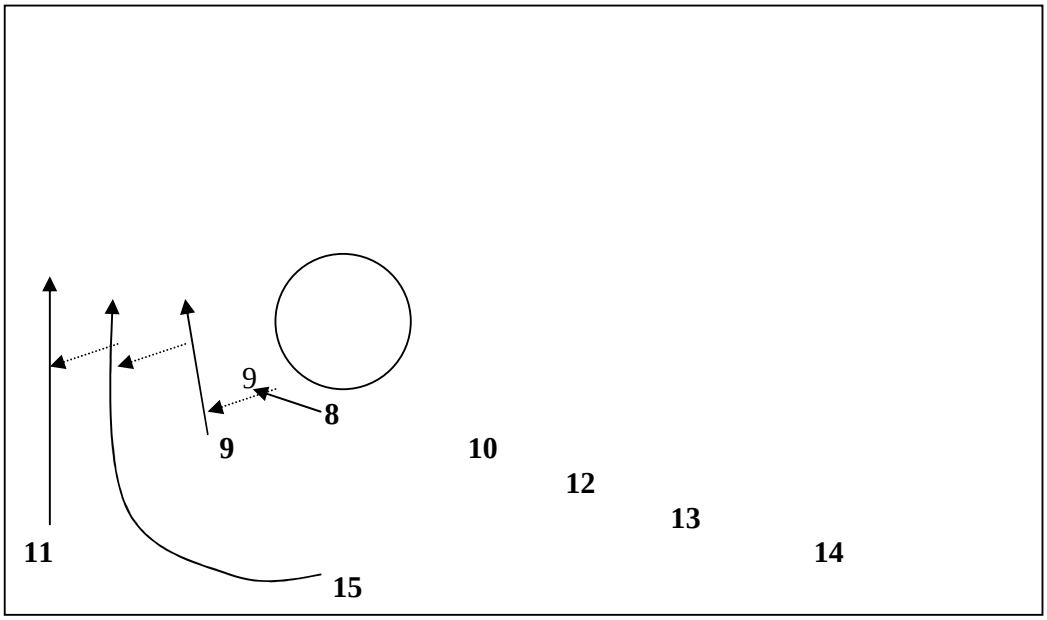
Middle Scrum

Option 1:
9 to **10**
10 plays flat to **15** off his shoulder

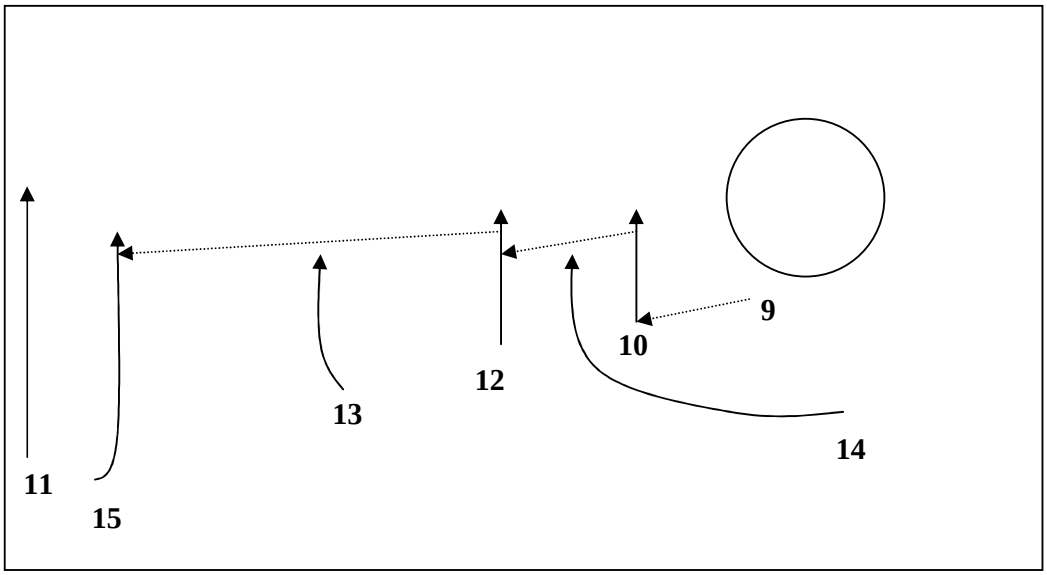
Option 2:
10 plays **13** on the drift skipping **15**



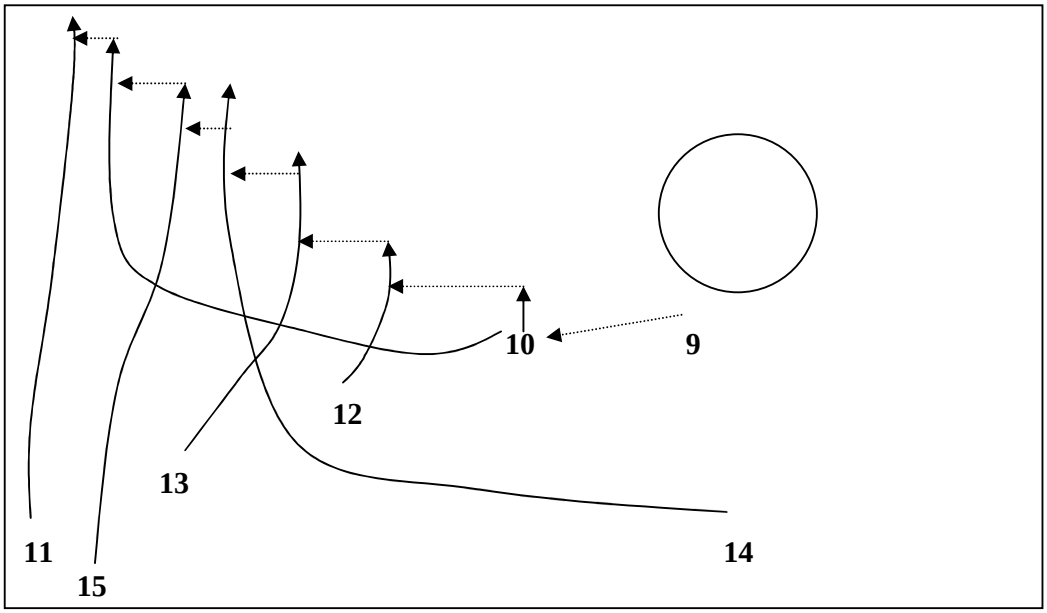
9 plays **10**
10 dummy scissors **12**
13 comes short off **10**
10 plays **11** behind **13's** back with **15** and **14** supporting



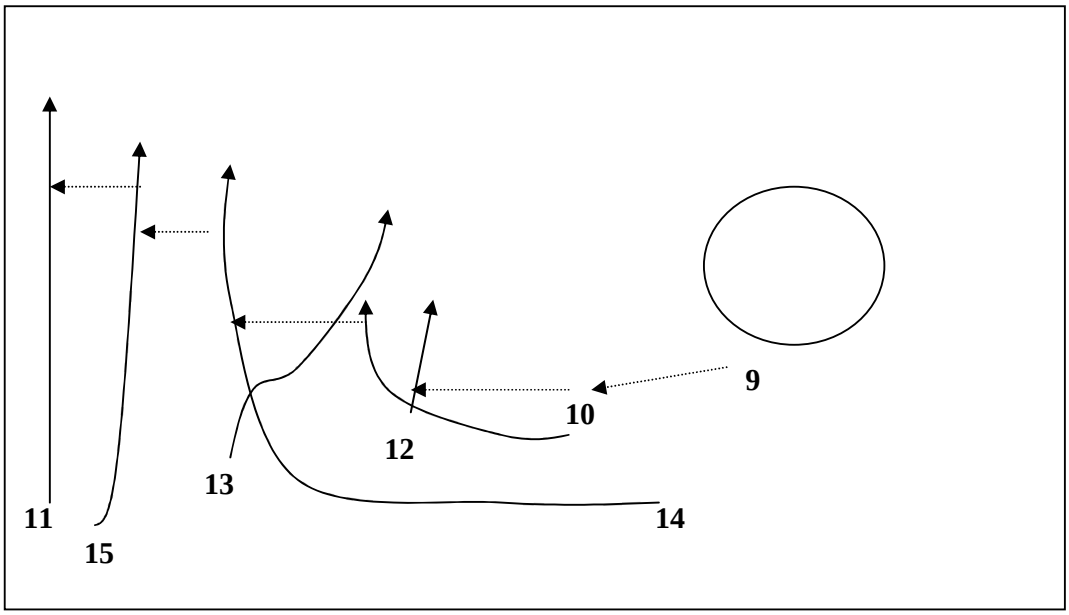
8 picks up ball goes into or plays before going into opposition 9
8 then plays **9** with **15** coming round and **11** outside



9 plays **10**
10 skips **14** to **12**
12 skips **13** to **15** with **11** in support



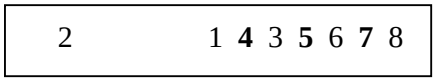
9 plays **10**
10 then plays **12**
12 plays **13** short, **10** decoy run
13 then plays **14** coming around
14 plays **15**
15 plays **10** with **11** in support



9 plays **10**
10 plays **12**, **10** pivots **12**
12 plays **10**
13 comes short but **10** plays behind **13's** back to **14** with **15** in support

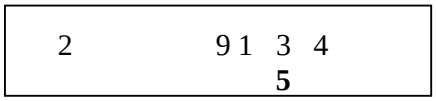
22. THE LINEOUT:

The Full Lineout:



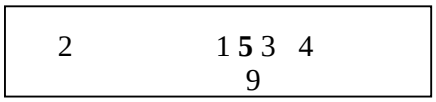
4, **5**, and **7** do the jumping
Ball in **LEFT HAND** goes to 2 and if it is in the **RIGHT HAND** it goes to 4.
Ball in **BOTH HANDS** it goes to the back.
We can drive off either jumper, which is any **BRAND/LOGO** e.g. "Nike", "Adidas"
If the drive is not called it is **BALL OFF THE TOP**.

Short Lineout 1: "Cookie"



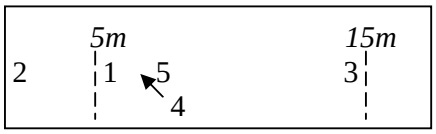
5 comes into the lineout and does the jumping. **9** goes scrum half.
"**1**" In the front
"**2**" In the middle
"**3**" At the back
"**Cancel**" 9 to 2

The Short Lineout 2: "Vip"



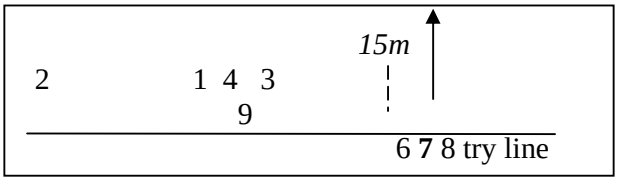
Done off a penalty, when going forward, it is a quick lineout.
2 gets the ball quickly and **5** jumps as the lifters arrive with 4

The Short Lineout 3: "Hammer"



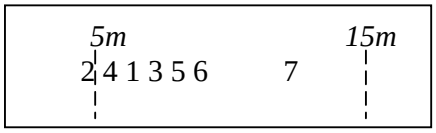
4 comes in and jumps in the front.
2 comes around as scrum half draws their defender and puts 3 away.

The Defensive Lineout: 5m from our try line



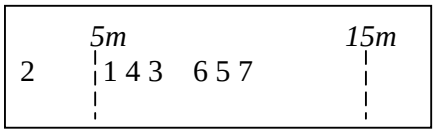
Ball goes over the 15m to lock or loosie taking it up with a BONSAI.
The ball is then kicked out (closest touchline) Remember to block! If they read it 4 jumps, drive etc.

Contesting: Full Lineout



2 lifts in the front.
Jumpers must always get in front of their jumper.
No contesting 5m from our own line!

Contesting: Short Lineout

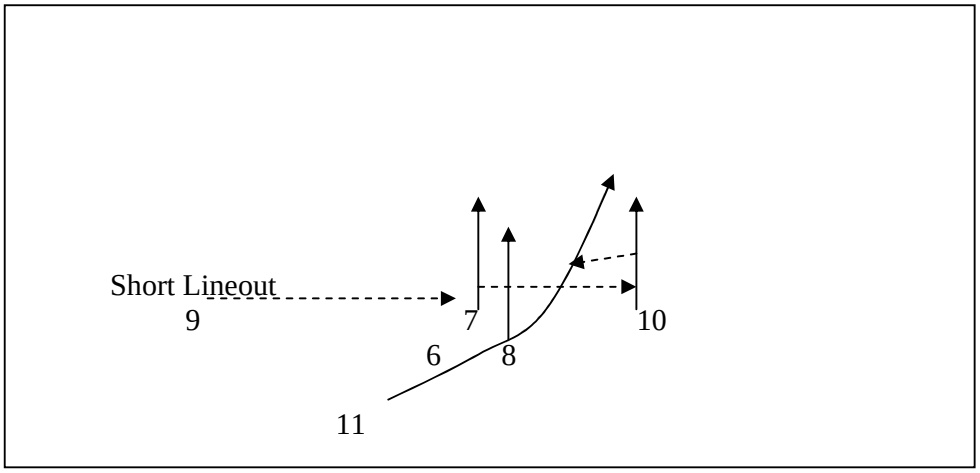


Set up pods and work together (Awareness).
Remember to communicate and be competitive off the ground.

Sacking:

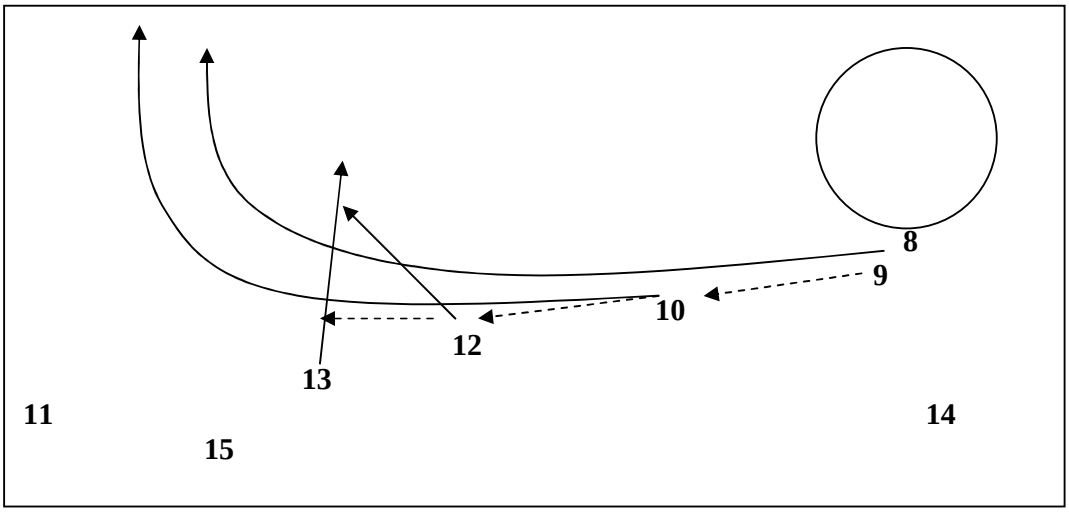
Wait for jumper to land and pull him down and off his feet by the jersey before the drive is formed.

Special Lineout Move:

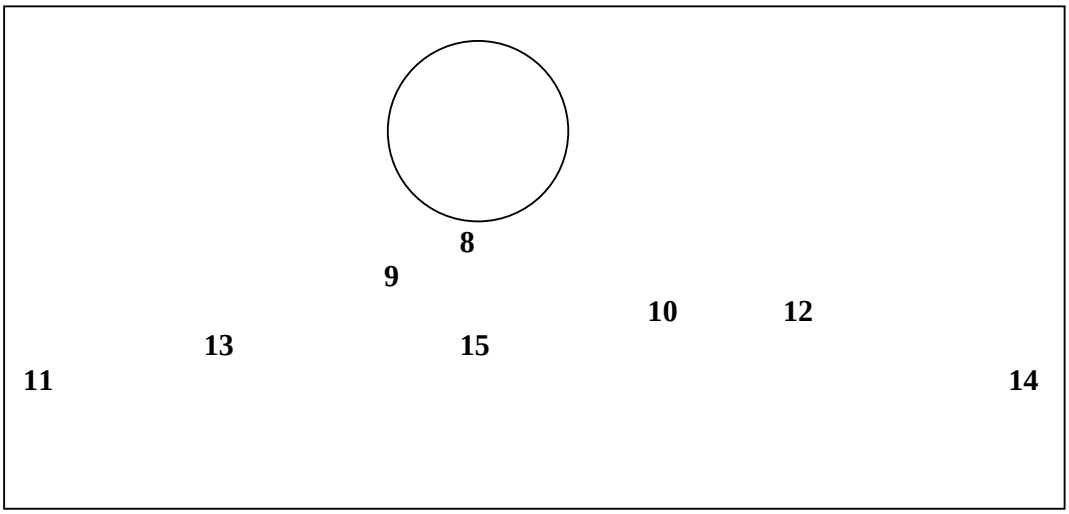


9 plays runner flat who skips supporting player to **10**
10 plays back inside to **11**

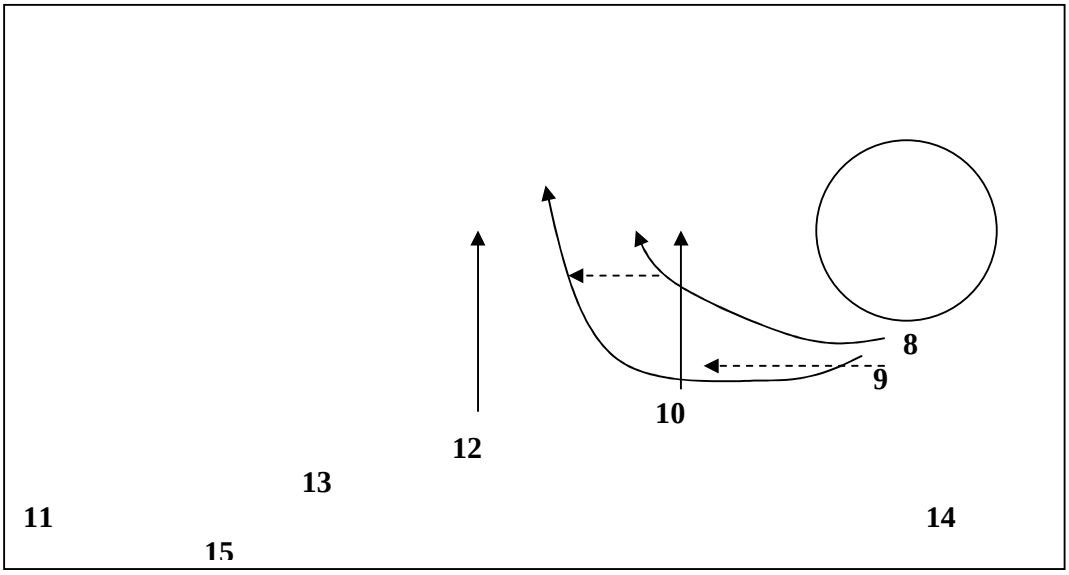
23. SPECIAL PLAYS OFF THE SCRUM:



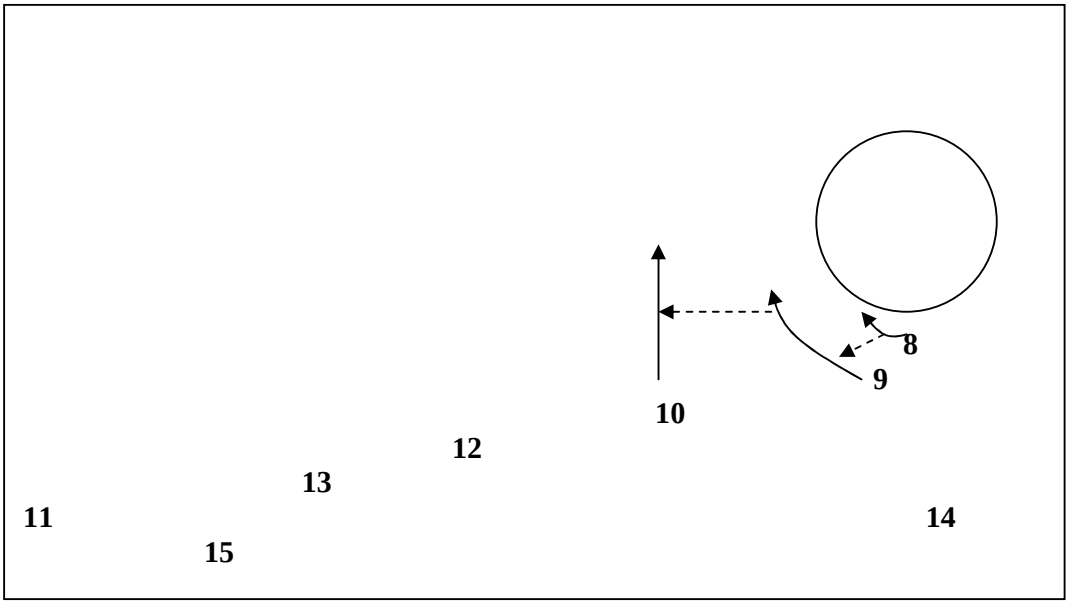
9 to **10** with **12** and **13** in backline formation off a scrum
10 passes to **12** who in turn passes to **13**
13 takes the ball to the advantage line, stops and turns as if in a standing tackle (might need to take contact) and looks for support.
12 primary supports **13**, receiving a "pop" or performs an "aussie-aussie"
12 plays **8** who has **10** in support



8 picks up and turns **loose forwards** help form drive and we drive it over. **Locks** join as well.



9 to **10** flat
8 loops around **10**
8 plays **9**



8 turns into their 9 and pops to **9**
OR
8 breaks wide from scrum and plays runner coming short or **9**

24. PENALTY MOVES:

I feel that there is no need for any fancy penalty moves in today's game. If we are in a situation to run it from a penalty, the ball is given to a group of the forwards who have formed in split pack formation. This group takes it up and we play our game plan from there. We will very seldom run it from a long arm penalty because we should either be kicking for poles or for touch.

It is important to remember that in a penalty situation we get the ball to our scrumhalf as quickly as possible. The scrumhalf should try and get the extra 10m. When a short arm is awarded we always take it quickly. It is also important to remember that the laws have changed. As long as the ref has made the mark a side can take as many quick taps as they like. Remember not to take it behind the refs' back! It does not have to be on the mark, it can be anywhere behind it as long as it is in line with it.

25. SEVEN KEYS TO WINNING A GAME:

"Winning is a habit and so is losing."

- Communication
- Determination
- Discipline
- Commitment
- Attitude
- Self Belief
- Aggression

The above seven keys can be used to evaluate the performance of a team.

26. MATCH EVALUATION:

Match:	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**
Score:												
Points Scored:												
Aggression												
Attitude												
Belief												
Determination												
Discipline												
Communication												
Commitment												

Players must score their own individual performance after a match, between 1 and 5.

27. GENERAL:

"The difference between ordinary and extra-ordinary is that little bit extra."

Kicking the ball:

Kicking the ball gives away possession and without possession you can't win.
Our game plan is to retain possession and to set up as many phases as possible, but we need position.
This can't be done if we spend the whole game kicking the ball away.
There are only specific cases in today's game for kicking the ball.
If you do kick, kick for the touchline, this limits their options.
If the opposition doesn't have the ball they can't win!
Only kick the ball away for a good reason:
If we need to find touch when we are under pressure in our 22.
If their backline is standing flat and there is no one covering behind their line of defence. A cross kick or a grubber is very effective in this situation.
A kick is only a bad kick when you don't come up and close down their space.

Taking the ball up:

Always go to ground yourself, never let the tackler be in control.
Don't go too far on your own.
Avoid the ball from being held up at all costs and go to ground.
Good ball is quick ruck ball!
If the ball is held up this means a change in possession.
Never run at the man, run for the half gap or arms at pace and pump your legs in contact.
Look for the offload (Keep the ball alive).

Getting a break:

Don't go too far, look for your support, there will always be a man in a better position.
Keep the ball alive and listen for the supporting calls. Offload!

Supporting:

It is no good calling the guys name or yes.
Let the ball carrier know what to do and where you are.
'Short, long, on your outside, on your inside, pop left, pop right, flip right, flip left, up, kopper-kopper, aussie, sealing and barring up!'

Turnover ball:

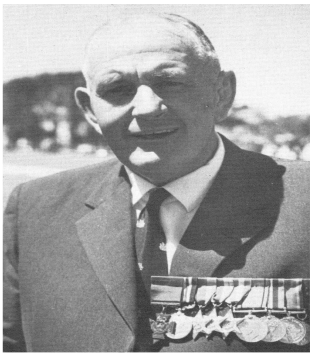
The best attacking ball in the game is turnover ball or when advantage is being played from a knock on. The ball is seldom kicked away off advantage ball.
The first three players must swing the ball out of the "red zone" as quickly as possible. The option for the counter attack is then greater. Players must also be aware of the advantage that is being played. Have a go!

Defence:

We need to defend the advantage line like our tryline! (With the same commitment)

28. SOME INSPIRATION:

"You will be surprised how much you can achieve by doing your best!"



Captain "Toys" Norton, V.C. , M.M.

Royal Hampshire Regiment

Citation for the award of the Victoria Cross

In Italy, on 31st August 1944 Lieut. Norton was commanding a platoon during the attack on the Monte Gridolfo feature, one of the strong points of the Gothic Line defences, and one which contained well-sited concrete gun emplacements. The leading platoon of his Company was pinned down by heavy enemy fire from the valley on the right flank of the advance.

On his own initiative and with complete disregard for his personal safety, Lieut. Norton at once engaged a series of emplacements in this valley. Single-handed he attacked the first machine gun position with a grenade, killing the crew of three. Still alone, he then worked his way forward to a second position, containing two machine guns and 15 riflemen. After a fight lasting 10 minutes, he wiped out both machine gun nests with his Tommy gun, and killed or took prisoner the remainder of the enemy.
Through out these attacks Lieut. Norton came under direct fire from an enemy self-propelled gun and, whilst still under fire from

this gun, he went on to clear the cellar and the upper rooms of a house, taking several more prisoners and putting many of the enemy to flight. Although by this time wounded and weak from loss of blood, he continued calmly and resolutely to lead his platoon up the valley to capture the remaining enemy positions.

Throughout the attack Lieut. Norton displayed matchless courage, outstanding initiative and inspiring leadership. By his supreme gallantry, fearless example and determined aggression he assured the successful breach of the Gothic Line at this point.

29. QUOTES:

"Far better is it to dare mighty things, to win glorious triumphs even through failure… than to rank with those poor spirits who neither enjoy much nor suffer much because they live in a grey twilight that knows not victory nor defeat".

Theodore Roosevelt

"What lies behind you and what lies before do not matter, what matters is what lays within you!"

Unknown

"Winners never quit and quitters never win!"

Unknown

"If you imagine that you are feeling tied, heavy and drained, you'll soon start to feel exactly that way. If you imagine that you're feeling energetic and confident, you'll quickly start to truly feel like a champion"

Unknown

"Skin grows back, but reputations don't"

Unknown

"Pain is temporary, quitting is **forever!**"

Lance Armstrong

What is the point of aiming if you never pull the trigger!

30. WINNERS:

Winners **take chances**;
like everyone else they fear failing but refuse to let it rule them.

Winners **don't give up**;
when life gets rough they hang in until the going gets better.

Winners **are flexible**;
they realize there is more than one way and are willing to try others.

Winners **know they are not perfect**.
they respect their weaknesses while making the most of their strengths.

Winners **fall but don't stay down**;
they stubbornly refuse to let a fall keep them from climbing.

Winners **don't blame fate for their failures**, nor luck for their success.

Winners **accept responsibility for their lives**.

Winners **are positive thinkers**, who see good in all things, from the ordinary to the extra ordinary.

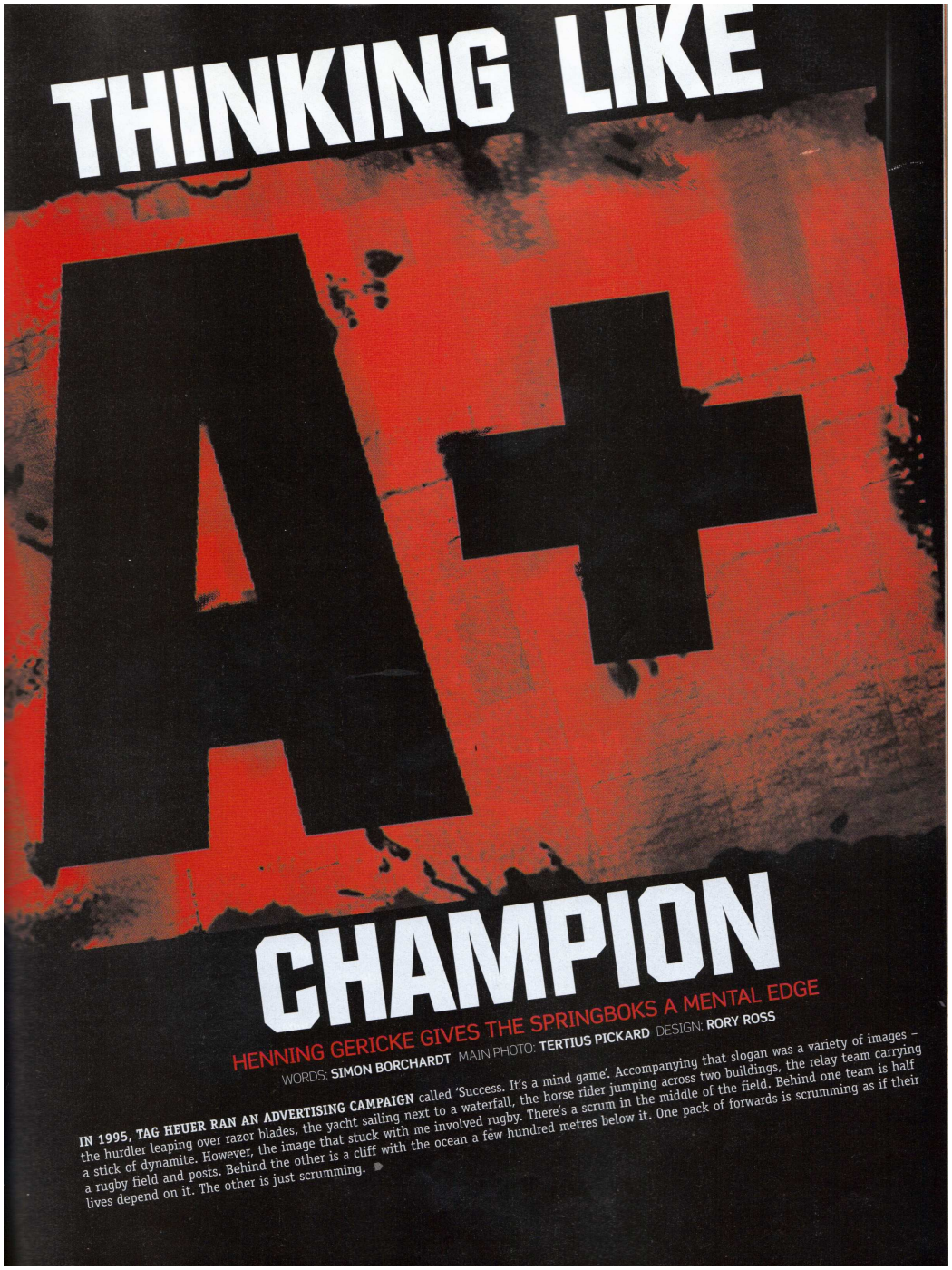
Winners **believe in the path they have chosen**;
even when it is hard, even when others can't see where they are going.

Winners **are patient**;
they know that the goal is only as worthy as the effort required to achieve it.

Winners **are people like you**;
they make this world a better place to be.

The best time to hold on is when you reach the place where the average person gives up!

31. THINKING LIKE A CHAMPION:



THINKING LIKE A+ CHAMPION

HENNING GERICKE GIVES THE SPRINGBOKS A MENTAL EDGE

WORDS: **SIMON BORCHARDT** MAIN PHOTO: **TERTIUS PICKARD** DESIGN: **RORY ROSS**

IN 1995, TAG HEUER RAN AN ADVERTISING CAMPAIGN called 'Success. It's a mind game'. Accompanying that slogan was a variety of images – the hurdler leaping over razor blades, the yacht sailing next to a waterfall, the horse rider jumping across two buildings, the relay team carrying a stick of dynamite. However, the image that stuck with me involved rugby. There's a scrum in the middle of the field. Behind one team is half a rugby field and posts. Behind the other is a cliff with the ocean a few hundred metres below it. One pack of forwards is scrumming as if their lives depend on it. The other is just scrumming.

Reference:

Borchart, S. (2007). THINKING LIKE A+ CHAMPION. SA Rugby Magazine (2007)

Henning Gericke, the Springboks mental and speed coach, firmly believes success is a mind game. He has a doctorate in psychology and has broken new ground in the field of mental coaching. When he was an elite athlete, he ran 10 sub-four-minute miles – a feat that requires great physical and mental strength.

When Gericke joined the Boks in 2004, the beginning of the Jake White era, he found a group of players still carrying mental scars from the Rudolf Straeuli regime. The first thing he did to repair the damage was to create a family environment, where players care for each other. Unlike Straeuli, he also got the players' families involved wherever possible.

Gericke then set about restoring the Boks' focus on the game. Over the last four years, he has held weekly sessions with the squad and regularly meets each player on an individual basis.

'In our weekly group sessions, I look at the mental challenges that we face in the upcoming Test,' he tells *SA Rugby* magazine. 'For example, we may need to be aggressive but relaxed enough to make good decisions on the field. We may have a poor record at the stadium at which we're going to play and need to make that negative mindset positive.

'The individual sessions are equally important,' he adds. 'Every player is different mentally, so I find out what motivates each one. Where does he get his inner strength? Where does he get his calmness? Where does he get his focus? What's the best mental frame I can put him in?'

Gericke's approach to mental training varies according to the needs of the player. 'Someone like JP [Pietersen] needs to feel confident and needs constant encouragement to help build and maintain that confidence,' he says. 'Despite playing 70-plus Tests, Os [du Randt] always feels the need to prove himself and show his team-mates he deserves to be in the squad. Os needs to set goals. He always wants to challenge himself and get better. Butch [James], on the other hand, plays by the three Cs – cool, calm and confident. When he was too aggressive in the past, his decision-making suffered, so the three Cs remind him of the way he wants to play. Basically, you have to find the right mental triggers to get the player into the zone that works for him.'

Few of us who admit being average sportsmen have ever been in the zone. Perhaps we entered it briefly by scoring a try or hitting a six at school or club level, but we haven't stayed there for long. The best in the business not only play in the zone for lengthy periods, they know how to get there regularly.

'The zone is a state of being when things just happen for a player,' explains Gericke. 'You feel you're always in the right place at the right time. You make the right decisions. You don't overanalyse your game. When you are in the zone, the mind trusts the body and the body trusts the mind. You enjoy the here and now, you don't worry about the outcome. The zone is a state of mind where you're calm, relaxed and focused.'

One Springbok who has successfully entered the zone this season is Frans Steyn. Having taken massive flak for missing a conversion that would have won the Sharks the Super 14 final and then failing to find touch after the hooter, the 20-year-old made amends against the Wallabies at Newlands. Steyn came off the bench in the final quarter when the Boks were trailing 19-16. The replacement winger levelled the scores with an ambitious drop goal from the right-hand touchline and then won the game with another from an easier position a few minutes from full time. When asked afterwards what had gone through his mind Steyn said, 'Er, nothing. I trusted my instincts.'

'Frans's answer sums up what it's like to be in the zone,' Gericke says. 'People probably weren't expecting a lot from him that day, because he was a substitute, so he could just come on and play his natural game. Another Bok who I always tell to trust his instincts is André Pretorius. André has a kicking routine that works for him, so I try not to get too involved. Before a game, I'll walk up to him and remind him to back himself on the field. That's all I need to say.'

It's the 2007 World Cup final between the Boks and All Blacks at Stade de France. A Dan Carter penalty has just put New Zealand into a one-point lead with two minutes to go. The Bok restart goes deep and bounces into touch after brushing a Kiwi hand. South Africa have one last chance to win the game, and the Webb Ellis Cup, with a line-out 5m from the opposition tryline. This next passage of play will determine whether the Boks spend the next four years as world champions or wondering what might have been. The pressure is suffocating. Or is it?

'My job is to prepare the players for a situation like that,' says Gericke. 'Obviously, this team has never trailed by a point in a World Cup final before, so we can't draw on previous experience. Instead, we create "what if?" scenarios for the players. What if we are in a situation like the one you've just described? Well, we'd want to keep focused and stick to the basics ... do what we'd do in any other Test match. If that means throwing the ball to Bakkies [Botha], setting up the driving maul and going for the pushover try, then so be it. If that means trying to create space and time for a drop goal attempt, then that's what must be done.'

Gericke says the secret to winning those close battles is in keeping composure. 'We have trigger words to help the Boks achieve this. John [Smit], for example, will yell out a word that will put everybody in the same frame of mind. One word can tell the team to slow the pace down, stick to the basics, focus on the small things, stay cool etc ... It's a case of shared thinking in that every player will know what to do.

'We've been involved in a few close games since 2004. Some we've won, others we've lost, but we've learnt a lot from them all. To win those games you need decision-makers, players in key positions – hooker, flyhalf, fullback etc – who can handle the pressure. We have those players.' ▶



Gericke insists the Boks would not choke in a World Cup final.

PHOTO: TERTIUS PICKARD/GALLO IMAGES

Chokers. It's a word that sticks to sports teams and individuals who crack under pressure and lose matches they should have won. In the 1993 Wimbledon women's singles final, Jana Novotna led Steffi Graf 4-1 in the deciding third set and was up 40-15 on her serve. Then the Czechoslovakian lost her nerve, missing simple shots, including an overhead smash that hit the back tarp. Graf won the next five games and a shattered Novotna cried on the Duchess of Kent's shoulder.

In the 1999 Cricket World Cup semi-finals, South Africa needed one run off four balls with one wicket in hand. Lance Klusener, whose big hitting had brought the Proteas back from the dead, called for a quick single. Allan Donald, at the other end, hesitated, dropped his bat and was run out. The match was tied but Australia progressed to the final on a superior run rate.

As far as the Rugby World Cup is concerned, the All Blacks were the best team in 1995 but lost to the Boks in the final. They were red-hot favourites in 1999 but self-imploded against France in the semi-finals. It was a similar case in 2003, when they gifted the Wallabies an intercept try in the semi-finals and went on to lose a match most expected them to win quite comfortably.

'Choking does happen in sport,' says Gericke. 'It comes from high and sometimes unrealistic expectations. The All Blacks, for example, are under huge pressure to win the World Cup this year. Their fans demand it. Their media demand it. Hell, the whole country demands it.'

When delving into the choking phenomenon, Gericke uses an example not listed above. 'I believe a team that is mentally strong will not allow choking to happen. They will take control of the situation. Look at our cricket team at the World Cup this year. A lot of people had a lot to say about them, and they responded by changing their tactics for the semi-final against Australia. They came out attacking Australia's bowlers, taking crazy risks, and lost five wickets for 27 runs. That shows me they weren't in control of what they wanted to do.'

Gericke insists the Boks will not allow outside pressure to change their approach to the game. 'We won't choke at the World Cup because we have a core of experienced players and good, strong leadership. I know our guys will keep their cool, stay focused and do what has worked for them in the past.'

Some players have big-match temperament, some don't. Some players thrive under pressure, some don't.

'Players who have BMT have often been in a pressurised situation before and been successful,' says Gericke. 'That builds confidence and they believe they'll be able to succeed again if they find themselves in a similar situation. Other players have crumbled under the pressure, so when they're under pressure again, they doubt themselves and have negative thoughts. And if your mind's not right, you won't have BMT.'

Whereas Gericke insists everyone who reaches Bok level has BMT, he admits he does have to calm a player down every now and then. 'It's all about anxiety and confidence; you need to get the balance right. If you worry too much, your confidence will go down, but if you don't worry at all and you're overconfident, then you're asking for trouble.

'Self-awareness is crucial in order to have BMT. You must be aware of what works for you. If you can do that, you will be in control of all situations. There will be times when you make mistakes, and you have to know how to calm yourself down and refocus.'

Gericke constantly reminds his players that the way they think about themselves affects how they play.

'We talk about the Law of Attraction, which states you attract what you think. People who think like champions are successful. People often aim not to fail instead of aiming to succeed. They've always been told "Don't do this, don't do that", so they can't be creative and true to themselves. The Springboks are going to think like champions at the World Cup and play like champions. I can promise you that.'

We're nearing the end of our interview when Jake White walks past looking worried. I ask Gericke whether he ever has mental-training sessions with the Bok coach, who is often under more pressure than his players.

'Jake does take strain, so we'll meet two or three times a week and chat about things,' he says. 'It's very informal, perhaps over a couple of drinks. I try to focus his thoughts, and we'll discuss the pressure he's under. He'll go to gym in the morning, so he has his way of dealing with it, and every now and then I'll give him something to read that I think may help him. Sometimes he'll ask me about a player and I'll tell him what I think.

'Mentally, Jake is incredibly focused on winning the World Cup. He knows he's entering the final straight of his Bok coaching career and he can't be sacked.'

Gericke also has a special relationship with the captain. 'John will come up to me and discuss what the team needs and what certain individuals need, so I'm always aware of the vibe in the squad. For example, we arranged a team-building exercise in Durban before the World Cup where the players went on a 10km walk. Along the route there were places to stop and at each place they had to discuss a previous Bok World Cup campaign. At the end of the walk, they arrived at John's house, where every player had a person waiting for them who is an important part of their life. The team gets extra energy from things like that.'

I shake hands with Gericke and am walking away when he calls me back. 'You know, I honestly believe we can win the World Cup. The players believe it too.' From the look in his eyes, I can see there's no doubt in his mind.



Os du Randt always feels the need to prove himself.

PHOTO: LEE WARREN/GALLO IMAGES

32. TEAM AVERAGES:

U15A RUGBY PLAYERS' AVERAGES										
Surname	Year	Pos 1	Pos 2	Pos 3	Weight	Height	Push Ups	Sit Ups	Pull Ups	3km
ANDREWS	**2006**	6	7	8	65	1.63	24	35	7	14.3
BOWLES	**2006**	9	11	14	61.7		45	49	12	
CLOETE	**2006**	7	6	8	73.8	1.71	**61**	53	**19**	12.28
DLOVA	**2006**	15	13	11	55.6	1.69	45	47	16	
KEWANA	**2006**	13	14	12	61.3	1.69	45	31	13	13.47
KING	**2006**	9	13	10	57.1	1.64	48	44	11	14.15
MCFARLANE	**2006**	6	7	2	69.3	1.69	34	45	10	12.41
MDLANKOMO	**2006**	3	2	1	92					
MINYA	**2006**	11	14	15	67.8	**1.86**	34	51	4	13.42
MJEKEVU	**2006**	12	13	15	75.3	1.92	43	**59**	14	14.02
MYBURGH	**2006**	8	7	6	70.1	1.77	57	48	8	14.28
NTSALUBA	**2006**	13	15	11	61	1.69	50	38	11	
NTUNGWA	**2006**	13	14	11	58.4	1.68	30	53	11	12.26
SABBAGH	**2006**	10	15	12	69.6	1.8	37	54	10	**12.17**
SEPTEMBER	**2006**	1	2	6	**98.8**	1.7	30	49	4	18.3
STEYN	**2006**	4	8	5	96.5	**1.86**	20	30	2	16.21
THERON	**2006**	15	12	10	71.6	1.85	39	47	10	13.43
VARNFIELD	**2006**	8	7	6	85	1.77	28	37		
VORSTER	**2006**	5	4	8	71	1.83	25	34	10	14.3
WALKER	**2006**	3	1	11	85.1	1.65	40	54	3	
WILLIAMS	**2006**	2	6	8	77.9	1.78	50	48	10	
ZEISBERGER	**2006**	4	5	6	75					
ALLDERMAN	**2007**	9	10		62.3	1.71	47	44	11	13.36
ARTHUR	**2007**	2	6	3	81.3	1.59	40	56		
BOLOKO	**2007**	13	14	11	73.8	1.74	53	47	18	14.02
CHIODI	**2007**	6	7		60.5	1.67	45	58	13	13.25
CHRISTENSEN	**2007**	11	10		61.3	1.59	40	43	6	15.52
DAVIS	**2007**	15	12	10	67.1	1.81	49	50	10	13.12
DAWSON	**2007**	1	3		**105**	**1.82**	**18**	43	0	
DE KLERK	**2007**	4	1	3	94.6	1.79	22	40		21.08
GERMISHUYS	**2007**	10	15		54	1.72	55	62	17	**12.42**
GUEST	**2007**	9	10		51.6	1.71	18	49		
HAMMOND	**2007**	6	9	10	58.1	1.69	49	**74**	**19**	12.52
JANSE VAN RENSBURG	**2007**	4	2	6	74	1.75	50	57	2	13.19
JOBODWANA	**2007**	11	14		52.3	1.79				
KRETZMANN	**2007**	12	14	7	66	1.75	**70**	65	17	14.12
LINDE	**2007**	4	5		73	1.82	25	44	6	16.52
LOMBARD	**2007**	2					20	38		21.38
LONGBOTTOM	**2007**	13	14	15	55	1.69	40	48	16	13.13
LUITERS	**2007**	9	10		52.3	1.6	60	46	13	13.22
MONA	**2007**	8	4	6	87.5	1.76	41	57	12	DNF
MORISON	**2007**	1	3		90	1.72	41	36	1	21.38
RANDALL	**2007**	6	7	2	77.5	1.7	37	50	4	
SEMANE	**2007**	15	12	10	55	1.72	15	40		13.05
VENTER	**2007**	4	8		79	1.81	47	53	14	
WYLIE	**2007**	13	14	7	67.4	1.7	50	51	16	
	AVERAGES				**71**	**1.74**	**40**	**48**	**10**	**14.54**

33. GENERAL DATA FORM:

U15 RUGBY



SELBORNE COLLEGE

NAME:					
POSITION: 1st Choice	**2nd Choice**		**3rd Choice**		
TEAM:					
EVALUATION:					
TERM:					
MORPHOLOGY					
Stature (m)					
Mass (kg)					
Body Mass Index					
Frame Size					
ANTHROPOMET					
% Body Fat					
Lean Body Mass					
Fat Mass					
Muscle Mass					
Sum of skin folds					
Waist					
Hip					
Fore Arm					
Thigh					
Calf					
STRENGTH					
Pull Ups					
MUSCLE ENDURANCE					
Push Ups					
Sit Ups					
AEROBIC ENDURANCE					
3km Time Trial					
Bleep Test					
ANAEROBIC ENDURANCE					
Sprint Repeatability					
AGILITY TEST					
Illinois Test					

34. POWER UP THE BRAIN AND GET INTO THE ZONE:

We're hard wired at birth to react to stress in certain physical ways. Now our ancient instincts, honed over millennia to survive the attack of a sabre-toothed tiger or fight off raiders from another tribe, could be managed to produce better rugby players according to Colquhoun, A. (2007). We are born with an unlimited amount of brain potential. The main functions of the brain are thinking, learning and creativity. "This makes brain power the number one determiner for success" Rugby News Annual (2005). The sports person who has the ability to out-think, out-wit, out-learn, out-create and out-play the competition will have a definite advantage.

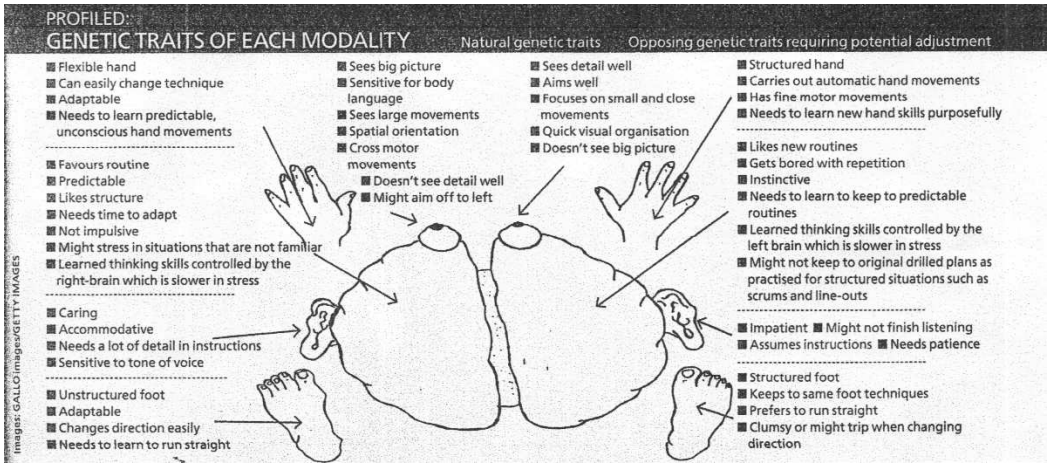
Brain Fitness:
We are all born with two brain hemispheres, but we don't automatically use both of them. This is referred to as **homolateral**, which means we only utilise one hemisphere of the brain at a time in alternating fashion. Homolaterality slows people's learning, thinking and creative capacity down, resulting in them being more frustrated, having to work longer and harder, rather than faster and smarter according to Vermeulen, A. (2005). Utilising both hemispheres comes through constant development and stimulation. The good news however is that all people can be **bilaterial**, engaging both brain hemispheres simultaneously provided people are exposed to brain-based development interventions and brain integrated techniques and activities. Using both the left and right brain hemispheres will enable you to work faster and smarter and therefore make learning easier.

The level of brain fitness is a very important aspect impacting the performance of rugby players, because utilising both brain hemispheres simultaneously will be a vital pre-requisite to out-think, out-wit, out-learn, out-create and out-play their competition on the rugby field according to Vermeulen (2005). Research indicates that the brain can become unfit in a period of as short as five days without any stimulation. According to Rugby News Annual (2005), players who study or practice other professional careers perform better than professional rugby players who do nothing else. "It is clear that new challenges and brain-based stimulation grows balanced rugby players who perform better on the sports field" Vermeulen (2005).

Brain Profiling:
Brain profiling predicts where our mental and physical strengths and weaknesses lie and, most importantly, how we will function under stress. According to Colquhoun (2007), we are genetically programmed at conception to have five dominant sensory perceptions: Brain hemisphere, eye, ear, hand and foot. This is why we instinctively favour one hand over the other or step on or off with a certain foot. It is the same with our eyes and ears; we're either **left-brain dominant** (predisposed to routine and structure) or **right-brain dominant** (bored by repetition). The scary thing is that one can actually find out which players have big match temperament and who don't.

Genetic brain profiling plays an important role in predicting what happens to a player when he gets tired and put under pressure. According to Lotter, "in simple terms, what happens when we're under stress or tired is that we begin to lose access to the non-dominant hemisphere and the modalities functioning from it". It is further stated that if this stress intensifies we start to see the same loss in the dominant hemisphere. For example, if it is the **right hemisphere**, the ability to plan and forward think would be impaired, and if it is in the **left hemisphere**, the ability to perform repetitive functions would suffer.

Right-brain players might be best suited for to the decision-making positions whereas those positions with more repetitive techniques may be better suited to **left-brain** dominances according to Lotter.



<u>Warming up the brain</u>:
As much as the body has to be warmed up to ensure peak physical performance, so the brain should be "switched on" and warmed up if a rugby player wants to out-play the opposition according to Rugby News Annual (2005). This is mandatory, but something that is very seldomly done by sports teams, because they do not know how to switch on the brain, how to activate their senses and how to switch on their neurological system for peak performance.

When a rugby player experiences too much stress, he may secrete inhibiting chemicals like **cortisol** and **morphine** that slow down electrical transmission between brain cells and may even shut down certain areas of the brain according to Rugby News Annual 2005. Vermeulen (2005), states that this is why many rugby players make stereo type mistakes under stress.

The good news is that many physical and mental actions can be taken to ensure that rugby players do not "switch off" certain brain areas under pressure. Players need to stay in the "zone" where they can optimise their brain power, concentration and physical performance.

When a rugby player thinks **negative thoughts** and experiences negative emotions he will secrete more inhibiting chemicals like **cortisol**, which will inhibit and slow down electrical transmissions between cells according to Rugby News Annual (2005). This will have a direct impact on the rugby players' performance resulting in him making mistakes or wrong tactical decisions. These inhibitors also weaken the immune system, drain energy levels, thus leading to ill health and bad physical performance.

If a player thinks **positive thoughts** and experiences constructive emotions he will secrete facilitating chemicals like **seratonin** and **endorphins** that will transmit electrical messages between cells, strengthening their immune system, enhancing mental activity and increasing their performance. All rugby players should be equipped with mental re-patterning skills to ensure that they replace negative mindsets with positive ones according to Rugby News Annual (2005). To help ensure the success of a team the players must have confidence and a constructive approach.

Getting in the Zone:

The brain goes into different states. Every brain state has a different function. When a rugby player runs onto the field, it does not mean that his brain will just automatically be in the right state for peak performance, if he did not take action to activate the desired brain state according to Rugby News Annual (2005). The ideal brain state is a state of relaxed alertness, a state where he can think and perform well. According to Rugby News Annual (2005) this is referred to being in the "zone" where rugby players can be focussed, highly motivated and think on their feet well without stress letting them lose control.

One of the most powerful terms in world sport today is the mental state called "the zone" according to Townsend, C. (2007). This is the mental state that produces super-human performances, amazing times and winning streaks. "An unusual feeling of effortless power, allowing them to feel as if their body is powered by a turbo-charged engine, and they find their body moving with maximum result but minimum energy" Townsend (2007). When an athlete reaches this state they often feel that they are not controlling it themselves and that they are not responsible for the performance. A common question by an athlete would be "how did I do that?" So, what exactly is it? This powerful force which guides the body during this period comes from the subconscious mind. The source of all our bodily movement and past sporting memories and experience come from our subconscious.

When a player is in the "zone" their conscious mind becomes quiet and this allows the more powerful subconscious mind to take over. The athlete is then in "automatic pilot", in the way a computer runs software. This allows their movements to flow much easier, effortlessly increasing speed and power in a way that could never be matched by the conscious thought. "This means that when you in the zone, you have virtually no thought going through your mind whatsoever, your body is just moving on instinct and automatic-pilot, powered by your subconscious mind" Townsend (2007).

Every person is unique and they have their own unique way of getting into the zone. Being in the "zone" is a state of where you are focused, relaxed, and self-trusting according to Rana, S (2007). The superego referred to as the "inner voice" prevents you from getting into the "zone" because it works on you by making you doubt anything and everything and in turn reducing your self-worth. Rana (2007) states that to get into the "zone" you have to shut off the Critical Advisor (super ego) which has a critical mentality. In a team sport like rugby the player needs to learn to forget about the result, but focus more on their own performance. A person in the "zone" only focuses on the present and will not allow any negative emotions from the past or future effect their performance.

Unique brain-based strengths:
Rugby players also need to know what their unique brain-based strengths and talents are. According to Rugby News Annual (2005) there are four categories of intelligence and eleven different forms of intelligence. All people are smart but, in different ways. If a player knows how he is smart it will help him outplay the opposition.

A good captain should have strong **emotional intelligence** which implies that he can control himself well under pressure and will still be able to healthily interact with team mates and make smart decisions on the field. Also being strong language smart will contribute to increased effectiveness of communication on the sports field according to Rugby News Annual (2005).

A "game breaker" will have strong **creative intelligence** as this capacity will enable him to make a quick strategic analysis of the game and take actions to out-wit his opposition. Creative intelligence is normally a prerequisite for back line players and some loose forwards according to Rugby Annual News (2005).

People become successful at what they do when they primarily focus on enhancing and utilising their strengths. Knowing one's strengths will give you an indication of the gifts and talents you have to be able to out-play the competition.

If a player is **right brain dominant** it would make that person a conceptual and strategic thinker on the field. This player would be able to grasp the bigger picture of the situation on the field at once, making a creative decision on how to out-play their opponents. The right brain dominant player will also see links between other sports and rugby.

Another area to look at is the players **learning receptivity**. If this is high the player will learn from other people and experiences easily, be mentally flexible to change, and adapt easily to new situations like rules that change or new environments.

If a player is **logical / mathematical intelligent** they will focus on acquiring and practicing the specific techniques required for their position and analyse the details of the technique.

A strong **visual / spatial intelligence** allows a player to use the space that he has on the field more creatively because they can picture and use the space instantly.

Strong **intrapersonal intelligence** makes a player accurately aware of his own strengths and weaknesses and allows him to manage himself well. A player with this strength will not lose focus easily or be easily intimidated.

Some players may also show a strong preference for **physical intelligence**, which implies that they enjoy acquiring and executing physical skills.

Strong **spiritual intelligence** will make a player very purpose driven and passionate.

Linguistic intelligence allows a player to efficiently and clearly communicate with his players.

A player who shows a greater **intrapersonal (self) intelligence** may be more individualistic than a player who shows a greater **interpersonal (people) intelligence**. A player with stronger interpersonal intelligence will be a far better team player.

Having poor **musical intelligence** may cause a player to lose rhythm when under pressure. For example a hooker or kicker may lose rhythm under pressure if his musical intelligence was poor.

Conclusion:
Everyone is unique and has been genetically programmed to react to different situations in their own way, in order to reach their full potential. There is substantial evidence from this article that your performance will increase from knowing who you are and what your strengths or weaknesses are. If the individual in a team can learn how to reach their optimal performance level, collectively the team's performance will be unrivalled by a team who has not been able to. Get rid of that "inner voice" let your subconscious take control and get into the "zone"!

References:

Colquhoun, A. (2007). GENETIC IMPERATIVES. Popular Mechanics, September 2007.

Rana, S. (2007). HOW TO GET INTO THE ZONE. www.ezinearticles.com

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Vermeulen, A. (2005). BRAIN POWER. Rugby News Annual 2005.

35. MULTIPLE INTELLIGENCES:

Some of the ways of exploring and solving problems listed in this study may feel uncomfortable to you while others seem comfortable. That's because you do have a preferred, personal learning style. Everyone in the team has their own strengths. This is why it is important to know what they are. Some players may be suited to specific positions more than others. This is the aim of this exercise.

Think of these intelligences as members of your team, various approaches will be most suitable in specific areas. Look to maximise your team's performance by being open to various intelligences.

Here is a brief summary of some of the different types of intelligences:

1. **LINGUISTIC**: Good with language; can debate effectively; able to write easily; avid reader… A good captain in a rugby team should score high in this intelligence. **Linguistic intelligence** allows a player to efficiently and clearly communicate with his players.
1. **MATHEMATICAL LOGIC**: Effective in describing patterns; can generate mathematical formulae; able to design / conduct an experiment… If a player is **logical / mathematical intelligent** they will focus on acquiring and practicing the specific techniques required for their position and analyse the details of the technique.
2. **BODILY / PHYSICAL**: Enjoy building / constructing; enjoy hands-on opportunities; enjoy the outdoors… Some players may also show a strong preference for **physical intelligence**, which implies that they enjoy acquiring and executing physical skills.
3. **VISUAL / SPATIAL**: Invent board games; can draw illustrate, sketch etc.; able to use a map effectively; effectively use maps, graphs, diagrams… A strong **visual / spatial intelligence** allows a player to use the space that he has on the field more creatively because they can picture and use the space instantly.
4. **MUSICAL**: Naturally pick up rhythms; enjoy whistling / singing; enjoy explaining how song is made up with various instruments…If this is poor it may cause a player to lose rhythm when under pressure e.g. a hooker or kicker.
5. **INTER-PERSONAL**: Gifted with social skills; able to impart your knowledge; able to conduct meetings / discussions; socially gregarious…A player with stronger **interpersonal (people) intelligence** will be a far better team player.
6. **INTRA-PERSONAL**: Able to describe your strengths, set & pursue a goal; describe your personal values… Strong **intrapersonal (self) intelligence** makes a player accurately aware of his own strengths and weaknesses and allows him to manage himself well. A player with this strength will not lose focus easily or be easily intimidated.
7. **NATURALIST**: Cares for pets, insects…; use microscopes, telescopes…; notice the natural environment; keen observation skills…

Multiple Intelligence Self Inventory

Read the statements listed below. Decide how strongly you agree / disagree that each statement best represents you. Use the scale:

1 = strongly disagree 2 = disagree 3 = uncertain 4 = agree 5 = strongly agree

1	Books are important to me.	1	2	3	4	5
2	I can easily compute numbers in my head.	1	2	3	4	5
3	I am sensitive to colour.	1	2	3	4	5
4	I engage in at least one sport or physical activity on a regular basis.	1	2	3	4	5
5	I have a pleasant singing voice.	1	2	3	4	5
6	I am the sort of person people come to for advice and counsel.	1	2	3	4	5
7	I regularly spend time alone meditating, reflecting or thinking about important life questions.	1	2	3	4	5
8	I enjoy being outdoors.	1	2	3	4	5
9	When I drive on the freeway, I pay attention to the words on the advertising boards than the scenery.	1	2	3	4	5
10	I enjoy playing games or solving brain teasers that require logical thinking.	1	2	3	4	5
11	I prefer looking at reading material that is heavily illustrated.	1	2	3	4	5
12	I find it difficult to sit still for long periods of time.	1	2	3	4	5
13	I know the tunes to many different songs or musical pieces.	1	2	3	4	5
14	I consider myself as a leader.	1	2	3	4	5
15	I am able to respond to setbacks with resilience.	1	2	3	4	5
16	I enjoy classifying rocks or plants or animals.	1	2	3	4	5
17	I enjoy word games like Scrabble and cross-words.	1	2	3	4	5
18	I believe that almost everything has a rational explanation.	1	2	3	4	5
19	I have vivid dreams at night.	1	2	3	4	5
20	I can mimic and imitate others well.	1	2	3	4	5
21	I ‘hear’ melodies, rhythms and harmonies in my mind.	1	2	3	4	5
22	I would rather spend my evenings at a lively party than stay at home alone.	1	2	3	4	5
23	I have a special hobby or interest that pretty much keeps me to myself.	1	2	3	4	5
24	I accept the effectiveness of homeopathy.	1	2	3	4	5
25	My conversation includes frequent reference to things that I have read or heard.	1	2	3	4	5
26	I like finding logical flaws in things that people say and do at home and work.	1	2	3	4	5
27	I like to draw or doodle.	1	2	3	4	5
28	I need to touch things in order to learn more about them.	1	2	3	4	5
29	I can tell when a musical note is off-key.	1	2	3	4	5
30	I touch others while talking to them.	1	2	3	4	5
31	I consider myself to be strong-willed or independent minded.	1	2	3	4	5
32	I look for patterns in nature.	1	2	3	4	5
33	I can persuade and convince others with words.	1	2	3	4	5
34	I feel content when testing hypotheses using measurements.	1	2	3	4	5
35	I can ‘picture’ where all the furniture will fit in a new place.	1	2	3	4	5
36	I would describe myself as well co-ordinated.	1	2	3	4	5
37	I often make tapping sounds or sing little melodies while working.	1	2	3	4	5
38	I enjoy performing tasks with other people.	1	2	3	4	5
39	I can detect and express complex feelings in myself.	1	2	3	4	5
40	I am fascinated by the weather.	1	2	3	4	5

Self Inventory – Score Sheet

	L	ML	VS	BP	M	Inter	Intra	N
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24
	24	26	27	28	29	30	31	32
	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40
Totals:								

These intelligences can be used as a guideline for position specific characteristics. A coach could use this test to help him make a decision on which player to select.

MIND OVER MATTER

For many years, sports physiologists were convinced that no-one could run a mile in less than four minutes. However, a talented runner, Roger Bannister, was determined to prove them wrong. He trained his body so that he could run his fastest—but he also trained his mind, focusing on the idea that he could break the four-minute barrier. On 6 May, 1954, he did just that. Once Bannister had shown that the four-minute barrier could be broken, other runners found that they could break it too. The barrier had been as much a mental as a physical one. The following year more than 300 runners ran the mile in under four minutes.

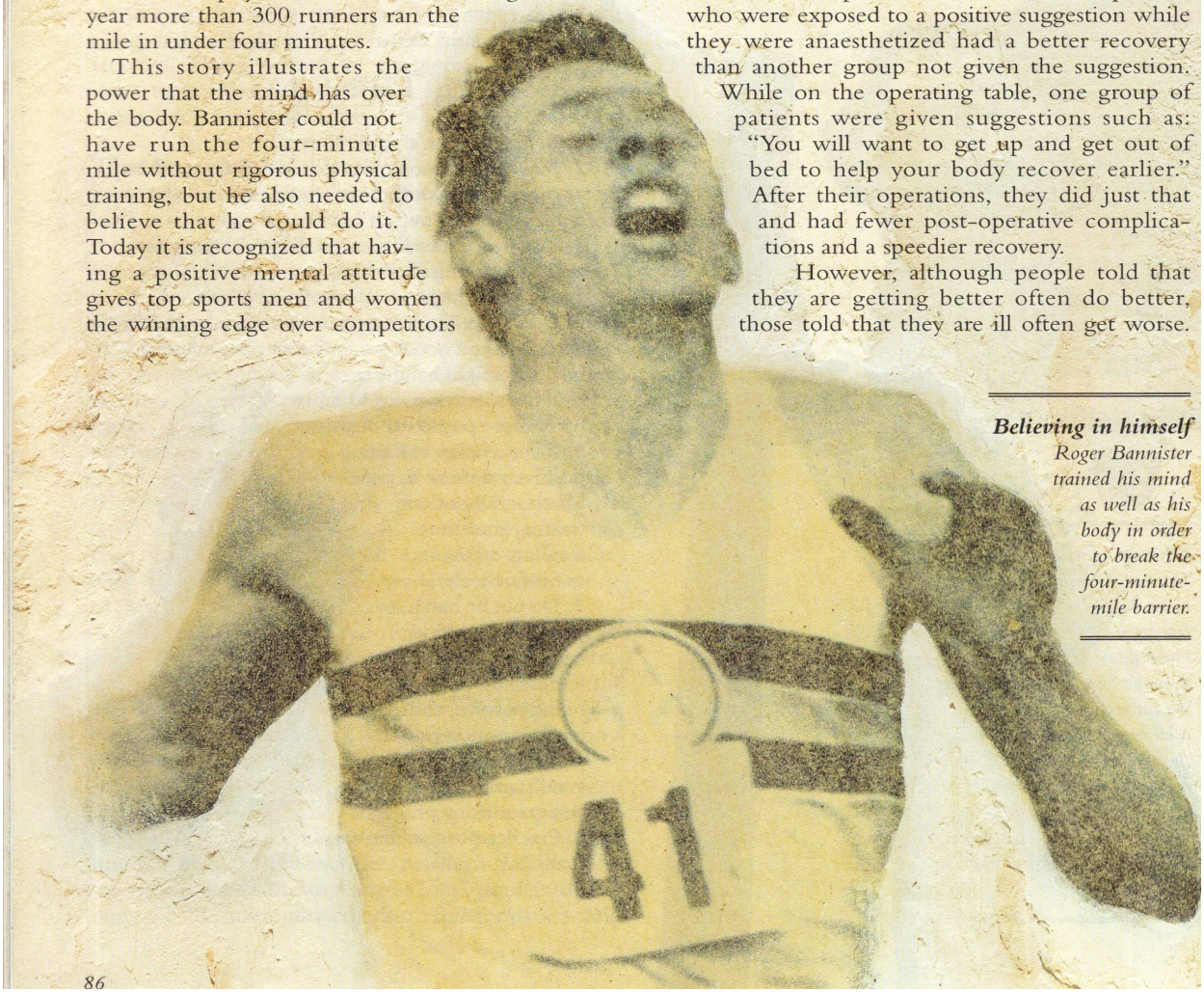
This story illustrates the power that the mind has over the body. Bannister could not have run the four-minute mile without rigorous physical training, but he also needed to believe that he could do it. Today it is recognized that having a positive mental attitude gives top sports men and women the winning edge over competitors with equal physical skills, and many competitors practice relaxation and visualization techniques before competing.

Believing that you can do something is important in many fields other than sports. For people in all walks of life and all states of physical fitness, the mind has a powerful impact on the body.

Healthy mind, healthy body

In one study reported in the influential British medical journal, *The Lancet*, Dr. Carlton Evans of St. Thomas's Hospital, London found that patients who were exposed to a positive suggestion while they were anaesthetized had a better recovery than another group not given the suggestion. While on the operating table, one group of patients were given suggestions such as: "You will want to get up and get out of bed to help your body recover earlier." After their operations, they did just that and had fewer post-operative complications and a speedier recovery.

However, although people told that they are getting better often do better, those told that they are ill often get worse.



Believing in himself
Roger Bannister trained his mind as well as his body in order to break the four-minute-mile barrier.

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Reference:

Mind Power, **Maximise your Performance**. Time-Life Books, Europe Edition (1995).

37. RUGBY BRAIN PROFILE:

Name	Surname	Team	Position 1	Position 2	Position 3

In the next section we are going to determine the unique thought preferences that formed you as rugby player by determining your rugby brain profile. It is an important starting-point because if you are able to understand your own brain preference, you will not only obtain insight into your own behaviour, but also into that of your team-mates which may differ a great deal from yours.

It is very important not to rush through this section and to read the questions carefully and answer them in total honesty. **Remember, there are no right or wrong answers. Everybody eventually ends with a grant total of 150. Therefore, although our profiles differ which indicates our uniqueness, it has nothing to do with right or wrong, good or bad. When working through the questionnaire, remember the following:**

- Read every question closely and react according to your preference (not as you think others want you to react).
- Allocate your marks accurately every time.
- When you have answered all the questions, write down the marks accurately on the score-card at the end of the specific section.
- Add the marks in each column carefully (there are 4 columns) and to make sure that you have added correctly, add your four totals at the end of each column.

  The four totals must give you a grand total of 150.
- Now make a dot on the circle, more or less where your mark must be and link the dots. (There is a completed example to help you drawing the profile.)
- Do not rush! There is no time limit – enjoy it!

Now determine your own rugby brain profile

Allocate marks at every question as follows:

- 4 for your first choice
- 3 for your second choice
- 2 for your third choice
- 1 for your last choice

Fill your choice into the block next to the question. After completing the questionnaire, fill in your marks on the score-card at the end of the questionnaire.

1. If I think about a rugby match that I must play I prefer to ...
   a. develop a positive attitude about the match ☐
   b. think very specifically about the match ☐
   c. think of the match in general ☐
   d. remember the plans for the match that we have practised ☐

2. I prefer a captain who ...
   a. is realistic and objective ☐
   b. wants to listen ☐
   c. has an open mind ☐
   d. is well-organised ☐

3. I prefer team situations ...
   a. that are friendly and relaxed ☐
   b. where advanced skills are appreciated ☐
   c. that are exciting and not always the same ☐
   d. where everybody is well-prepared ☐

4. If the coach discusses tactics for the match with the team, I prefer him to ...
   a. do it in a focussed manner without flippancy ☐
   b. do it quickly so that we can get to the field ☐
   c. do it systematically, step by step ☐
   d. make the team members part of the discussion ☐

5. I prefer a coach who ...
   a. plans efficiently ☐
   b. focusses strongly on team spirit ☐
   c. exchanges ideas freely ☐
   d. can analyse the match well ☐

6. If I change to another club (province, school, etc.) I will ...
   a. objectively study and analyse the advantages of the change ☐
   b. try to determine how the change fits into my future rugby plans ☐
   c. wonder how I will fit in with my new team-mates ☐
   d. wonder how the change will influence my familiar circumstances ☐

7. While practising on the field, I prefer ...
   a. to practise in a relaxed atmosphere ☐
   b. to practise the movements in a dedicated manner ☐
   c. to get clearly formulated instructions ☐
   d. many variations in the training programme ☐

8. I prefer my team-mates to describe me as somebody who ...
   a. does not say unpleasant things about them ☐
   b. speaks plainly ☐
   c. practises with dedication and diligence ☐
   d. always makes plans on the field ☐

9. I prefer the game tactics to be ...
   a. analysed thoroughly ☐
   b. applied unchanged during the match ☐
   c. discussed by al the team members ☐
   d. only a starting-point that leaves room for deviation ☐

10. I enjoy the company of team-mates who ...
   a. know what they want ☐
   b. are imaginative and always try new things ☐
   c. are punctual and do not make their team-mates wait ☐
   d. are friendly and easy-going ☐

11. If I play in a match, I prefer ...
   a. that we will make no mistakes ☐
   b. the team spirit to be very positive ☐
   c. that we stick to the plan for the match ☐
   d. to do things on the spur of the moment ☐

12. In the change-room before the match, I prefer to ...
   a. summon my passion for the match ☐
   b. concentrate on the match without being disturbed ☐
   c. go over the match in my mind for the last time ☐
   d. wait in a relaxed mood for the beginning of the match ☐

13. When the ball is kicked directly at me, my first reaction is to ...
   a. start playing according to a practised movement ☐
   b. look for support ☐
   c. start with a counter-attack ☐
   d. keep my focus ☐

14. As a new member of the team, I will give preference to ...
   a. a well-organised rugby environment ☐
   b. acceptance by the players and coaches ☐
   c. very specific guidelines about what is expected of me ☐
   d. opportunities ☐

15. When I play rugby ...
   a. I am constantly on the lookout for new possibilities and options ☐
   b. I am calculated and do not allow my feelings to play a role ☐
   c. I am always thoroughly prepared ☐
   d. I am a team player and not an individual ☐

Completion of your profile score-card

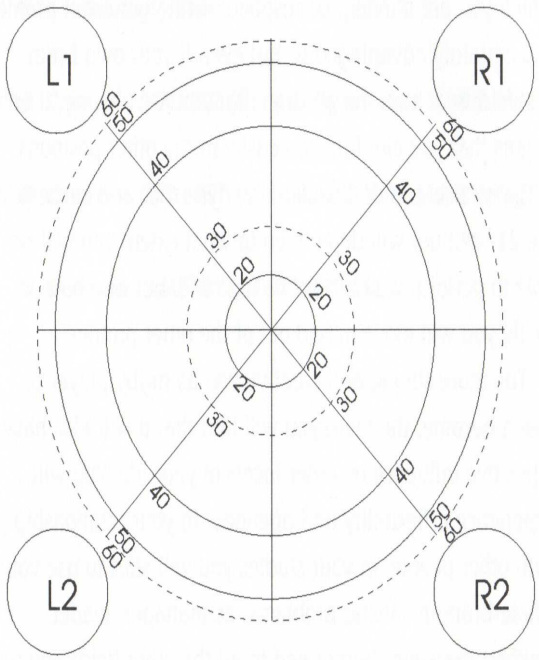
It may appear time consuming but it is important to complete the following score-card very accurately. Note that the a, b, c and d do not appear at the same place every time.

- Write down the marks that you have allocated for every question accurately and then add up every column separately.
- When you add up your FOUR totals at the bottom of the page, your grand total must be 150.

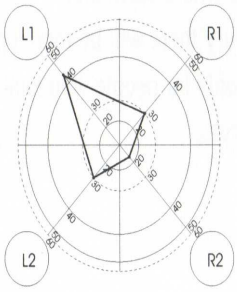
1	b	d	a	c	
2	a	d	b	c	
3	b	d	a	c	
4	a	c	d	b	
5	d	a	b	c	
6	a	d	c	b	
7	c	b	a	d	
8	b	c	a	d	
9	a	b	c	d	
10	a	c	d	b	
11	a	c	b	d	
12	b	c	a	d	
13	d	a	b	c	
14	c	a	b	d	
15	b	c	d	a	
TOTAL					= 150
	L1	L2	R2	R1	

Now fill in your totals in the small circles and then make a dot more or less where your score lies. Then link the dots

to determine your parent brain profile. (Take a look at the example below if you experience any problems.)



Example



BRAIN PROFILE:

L1: Left Quadrant (Top Left) **Logic:**
Focus
Think Logically
Dedicated and focused
Think concretely and rationally and to utilise specific knowledge in the process
To operate from memory
To make logical conclusions
To act in line with definite training methods

R1: Right Quadrant (Top Right) **Creativity:**
Individualism
Imagination
Being different
Renewal
Unusualness
Intuition
Looking at the big picture
Experimenting and acting on the spur of the moment

L2: Left Quadrant (Bottom Left) **Systematic Approach:**
Preference for systematic, step by step approach
Discipline and order
Learnt patterns
Rules and regulations
Systematic approach
Thorough planning

R2: Right Quadrant (Bottom Right) **Emotional Intelligence:**
Group cohesion
Teamwork
Unity
Mutual support
Strong passion
The development of feeling and emotion
Communication and interaction

Reference:

Botha, N. and Neethling, K. (1999). CREATIVE RUGBY, Don't just sweat it, think it! Carpe diem. First Edition.

38. POSITION SPECIFIC TRAINING:

"Don't be good at it, be the best at it!"

Props: "The Beasts"

- They have to be big and strong.
- Their ability to scrum well and to get around the field for support is also vital.
- They must possess correct scrumming techniques and be able to apply them consistently.
- Often the success of the lineout depends on their consistent lifting and timing with the jumper.
- Rucking skills are important (cleaning out).
- Need to use their strength in power plays to turn over ball (counter ruck) or disrupt the opposition's defences by a powerful ball carry.

Special Individual Practice:

The success of any scrum is on the hit during the engagement. The front row must remember to keep their knees in front of their toes while squatting, remember to bar up. During the scrum they must bend their knees, this helps them get a straight back. Everyone must have their heads up and be bound tightly.

The individual practice that I have chosen for props can be beneficial for the entire team. Two players face each other an equal distance from a line. They squat by bending at the knees and concentrate on their knees being in front of their toes. If they are correctly in this position they should slowly be falling forward. On the call they engage. On the engagement they must see who can engage first and who can knock their opponent away from the line from the hit. It is important that all the proper techniques are followed; knees bent, straight back and head up.

When practicing the correct scrumming techniques they can start off with each of them having a hand on the ground to keep them up, but eventually they should be able to balance without any hands on the ground.

Hooker: “The Middle Man”

- Ability to find his jumper and to hook the ball is of utmost importance.
- Must throw in consistently and accurately.
- Must also possess lots of skill and pace.
- He must be able to act as an extra loose forward.
- Perfect cross between a prop (strength) and a loose forward (mobility).
- Team leader in the scrums.
- Needs to be fearless in everything he does (aggressive).
- Must be a great communicator.
- Applies pressure on opposing halves from the lineout.

Special Individual Practice:

The most important thing about a hooker is his hooking and throwing in ability. I have chosen two special individual practices for him.

Firstly is his hooking in a scrum. The hooker leans against a pole with his right shoulder in a scrumming position. The coach puts the ball in and the hooker must strike as quickly as possible while hooking the ball.

Secondly is the hooker’s throwing. This can be practiced on any wall or on the cross bar of the poles. A hooker must decide what technique he is using, throwing with one hand or with two. Good practice for the hooker if he is throwing with two hands is throwing straight into the air above him. This will help him to see whether the ball is spinning properly.

Locks: “The Twin Towers”

- They must be tall and have good jumping skills.
- Must also possess good ball handling skills and ability to scrum.
- Ability to catch the ball from the kick off is important.
- Rucking skills are important (cleaning out).
- Fulfils a similar role as the props but should possess similar characteristics as a loose forward.
- Must always be on the look out for a lineout steal by reading the opponents lineout.

Special Individual Practice:

Even though we are allowed lifting in the lineout the lock must still jump. A lock must be able to beat his opponent off the ground. To improve this, the lock needs to work on his explosiveness.

The first individual practice is standing under the cross bar, jumping and touching it. The lock can start off touching the cross bar with either hand and then with both hands at the same time. A rule of thump when it comes to lineout play is if the lock can touch the ball he can catch it.

Brilliant explosive exercises for the whole team is hopping, jumping, squats and squat jumps. A lock can stand side on to a tackling bag and can jump off both feet over the bag for 2 minutes.

Jumping and Timing Drill:



Set up two pods. The first pod jumps with the ball, when the lock is in the air he throws it to the next pod, which jumps and catches it. The first pod then jumps again to receive it again (repeat). This is a great exercise, but will take time.

Loose forwards: "The Predators"

- Extremely skilful and have lots of pace.
- Must be good defenders.
- They must have good running off ability (ball carry) and skill to link with support.
- Rucking skills, in particular at the breakdown (turnovers).
- Act as link between backs and forwards.
- Apply pressure.
- Play as a unit.

Special Individual Practice:

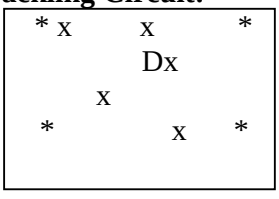
In today's game, these players still have to be the fittest players on the field. They are the perfect cross between a back and a tight forward. Any fitness exercises will be extremely beneficial to them. The loose forwards make some of the highest tackle counts during a game. This is why for their special practice I have chosen tackling drills, which are obviously beneficial to the entire team.

Tackling is an area of the game where players have to build up confidence. They have to be coached properly on all the different tackling techniques. A good way to start is from scratch. Player's facing each other, the defenders on their knees and the attackers jogging at them. Tackling with either shoulder is practiced. This is eventually built up into full on contact. A player must be able to tackle equally with either shoulder. Tackling head on, the defender must choose which shoulder to use and get his head out of the way. If a defender tackles with his left shoulder, his left leg must also carry most of his own weight. The clamping of the arms is the next thing. The right arm must lift the attacker's leg and then twist the defender to the ground. Like tackling head on, from the side the defender must get his head out of the way and then the same steps are followed. If a defender can get both his feet off the ground, like a missile, he will be certain to take down an opponent.

Tackling can be broken up into three stages; the first being shutting down the attackers space, then the American football zone where the defender's weight is being passed to either foot, and then finally the launching stage when the defender decides which shoulder to use. It is important to get your feet up and to keep your studs on the ground for as long as possible. Like all contact situations you must always have your eyes open.

If the attacking player has not had much space to move the defender can tackle the ball i.e. above the waist. This is often referred to as a smother tackle. The defender must make sure that he has players on his inside and outside.

Tackling Circuit:



Demarcate an area with cones. The defender has 2 minutes to tackle as many times as possible, while the tackled players try and evade (great fitness drill). All the tackling techniques can be practiced.

Scrumhalf: "The Playmaker"

- They need brilliant vision and possess amazing distributing skills.
- Creativity is important.
- Communicates well with the forwards and backs (vital link between them).
- Should always be close to the ball, within 5 metres at all times.
- Must quickly sum up the different situations on the field.
- Needs to execute all skills quickly and well under pressure.
- Defensively must be capable to tackle a forward.
- Plays a covering role on defence watching for any grubbers, chips or line breaks.
- Must be able to read oppositions play.
- Often has to keep the pressure off the flyhalf and his team.
- General kicking skills are important, especially kicking from the base.

Special Individual Practice:

This player's pass is the most important thing to the team. He must learn to pass accurately off the ground and dive pass either way. Reverse passing is another pass the scrumhalf should practice.

When passing off the ground his rear foot must be close to the ball and his feet should be well spread apart. This should prevent him from having to wind-up.

A good practice for the scrumhalf; is placing a whole lot of balls in line and a man standing about ten meters away. The scrumhalf passes the balls to him; the receiver shouldn't have to move while he places them down again in a line. Passing off the ground and dive passing can be practiced. Another man can be introduced to pop the balls to the scrumhalf or roll them, before he passes (simulating a ball off the top from the lineout or a ball bouncing on the ground).

His ability to kick from the base of a scrum, ruck or maul is also vital to relieve the pressure off the flyhalf. The timing for a box kick can be practiced with the wing/chaser. It is important that the timing is right to prevent an offside situation during a game (chaser in front of the kicker).

Fly-half: “The General”

- Needs brilliant vision and must posses amazing distributing skills.
- Good communicator on attack and defence.
- Creative.
- Great kicking skills and ability to kick of either foot is important.
- Good feet i.e. stepping.
- Dictates how the game needs to be played therefore must be able to quickly sum up where the strengths or weaknesses are on attack or defence.
- Consistently makes quick decisions under pressure.
- Must be able to react quickly to rectify his own mistakes or of his team-mates.
- Create space for outside backs by drawing opposing loose forwards.
- Keep the forwards in the game.

Special Individual Practice:

This is the position in the team where the player puts himself under pressure to create space for the team. Like the scrumhalf his distributing skills are important and equally are his boot.

Special practice for the flyhalf would be his line kicking which can be practiced with the fullback. Introducing a defender preferably a loose forward to apply pressure would be advantageous.

Another good practice is running onto the ball and receiving it at different positions from the scrumhalf. Their communication is very important.

Passing drills and drills that apply pressure are good.

Kicking Accuracy Drill:



Set up demarcated areas with 4 cones and the kicker practices kicking the ball to the area. All kicking skills can be practiced e.g. grubber, chip, line kick etc. Vary the distance of the areas.

Centres: “The Line Breakers and Off-Loaders”

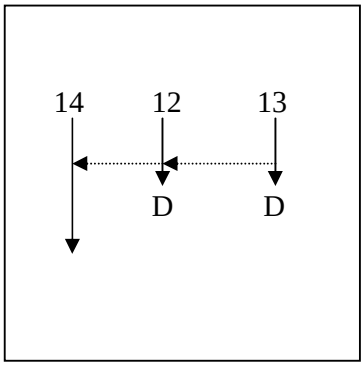
- Possesses brilliant skill and pace (explosive).
- Vision to link with wingers, fullback and support play is also important.
- Great defensive abilities.
- Good feet i.e. can step off either foot.
- Sound tactical kicking ability and must be able to execute basic kicking techniques quickly and correctly.
- Reacts quickly.
- Creative.

Special Individual Practice:

The two centres plus a wing run the ball at two defenders. The centres practice drawing the defenders and put the wing away. Here the centres can practice how long they hold on for, preferably as long as possible without being tackled in possession. Their ability to run off one another can also be practised. One handed passing is a vital skill to learn.

These two players have to remember to run straight during a match to create space. Their defence is also important.

Draw and Pass Drill:



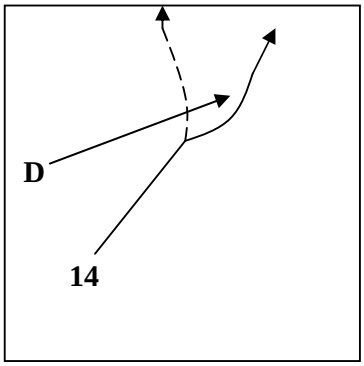
Wings: "The Finishers"

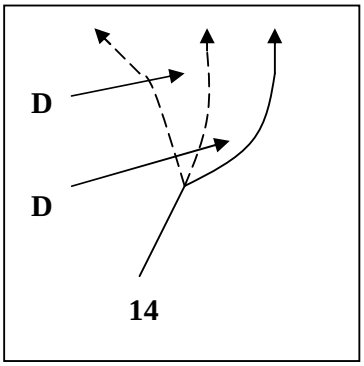
- Need to be good finishers and must posses enough pace to beat their opponent on the outside.
- Must always be aware of where the opponents and his team-mates are.
- If given room must be able to score.
- Reacts very quickly under pressure.
- Fearless ball carriers.
- Kicking skills are important e.g. chip kick and line kicking.
- Good hands.
- Supports the fullback (1/3 and 2/3 split).
- Must be able to create space by moving into a gap before taking a pass.
- Solid defender and uses the touchline to his advantage.
- Ability to score in the corner is imperative i.e. dive.

Special Individual Practice:

The wing in possession runs for the corner where one defender (fullback) tries to stop him. The defender varies his pace that he cross covers giving the winger different options, inside or outside. Another defender can be introduced which will make it even more challenging for the wing.

Beating your man Drill:





Fullback: “The Safe Keeper and Breaker”

- Needs good timing and vision to hit the line with pace.
- Must possess enough speed to join the line.
- He is often the last line of defence so he must be able to defend.
- Needs to be good at recognising where there are open spaces or gaps on the field on both attack and defence.
- Must sum up crisis situations quickly and make decisions while remaining focused.
- Retain concentration and composure when under pressure.
- General kicking ability is important i.e. line kicking and up and under.
- Catching of the high ball and positional play imperative.
- Creative
- Shows courage in defence.
- Good communicator.
- Can step off either foot.

Special Individual Practice:

The fullbacks kicking, defence and ability to catch the high ball are important and can be practiced.

For practicing the catching of the high ball one can use the flyhalf, to kick and a defender with a hit shield to apply pressure on the fullback. The fullback can practice catching the ball side on or front on, in the air or on the ground. Another supporter and defender can be introduced. The fullback can practice jumping up into the shield when he practices catching the high ball. It is important that in a game the fullback must never let the ball bounce.